CLAUDE x GOOGLE ADS

THE AI GUIDE TO GOOGLE ADS

100 Claude Skills to Audit, Optimize, Scale, and Run a High-Performance Google Ads Account

A practical operating system for turning Claude into your Google Ads strategy, optimization, and profitability copilot.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

The 8 Skill Categories

PART 1

Foundation

“ROAS tells you what happened. It rarely tells you what it cost you to not notice.”

1. Introduction

Most Google Ads accounts do not lose money because of one catastrophic mistake. There is rarely a single smoking gun — no one bid that bankrupted the quarter, no one campaign that explains a bad month. Instead, money leaks out in a hundred small places at once: a search term that should have been excluded five months ago, a product that was never properly segmented from the catalog around it, a creative that fatigued weeks ago but is still eating budget, a landing page that answers a different question than the one the visitor actually asked.

Each leak, on its own, looks trivial. A few hundred dollars here. A slightly-off product title there. An ad group nobody has opened since it launched. None of these show up as a red flag in a weekly dashboard. Individually, they are rounding errors. Collectively, across a full account, across a full year, they are very often the difference between an account that is genuinely profitable and one that only looks profitable.

That distinction matters more than it might seem. Return on ad spend (ROAS) is the number most teams report on, and it is also the number most capable of hiding a problem. A blended account ROAS of 4.0x can be entirely explained by a brand campaign capturing demand the business would have gotten close to free, while every non-brand campaign underneath it quietly loses money. A "strong" Shopping campaign can be driven almost entirely by a handful of thin-margin products that generate impressive revenue and unimpressive profit. A campaign that hit its Target ROAS this month may have done so by suppressing volume so aggressively that real, profitable growth was left on the table. None of this shows up if the only question being asked is "is ROAS acceptable." It only shows up when someone asks the harder, more specific questions underneath it — and asks them consistently, not just when something visibly breaks.

This is where Claude changes the economics of running a Google Ads account well. The traditional constraint on this kind of rigor has always been time. A thorough search term review, a full account audit, a landing page diagnostic across every ad group, a profit-adjusted product ranking — these are all things a good account manager knows how to do. Very few have the hours in a week to do them every week, for every account, at the level of depth this guide describes. Claude removes that constraint. It can hold an entire account's context, apply a consistent diagnostic framework to every part of it, and produce a specific, prioritized, evidence-based output in minutes rather than days — provided it is given the right data and the right instructions.

That last clause is the whole point of this guide. Claude is not a magic fix for a poorly run account, and it does not replace judgment. Handed a vague prompt like "analyze my Google Ads account," it will produce a vague, generic answer — the kind of AI output that gives AI-assisted marketing a bad name. Handed a specific export, a clear question, and a detailed instruction for exactly what to calculate, what to flag, and how to prioritize it, Claude becomes something closer to a full analytical team on call: an auditor, a search term analyst, a feed optimizer, a copywriter, a CRO reviewer, a bidding strategist, and a financial analyst, all working from the same consistent playbook every single week.

That is the promise of this guide: not a list of clever prompts, but a complete, repeatable operating system — one folder, one structure, used every week — for running a Google Ads account the way the best-managed accounts are actually run.

2. How to Use This Guide

This guide is built to be used, not read once and shelved. Here is the practical path from opening this document to running your first real analysis.

Step 1 — Build your permanent workspace. Before running a single Skill, set up the ten context files described in the next section (Build Your Claude Google Ads Operating System). These files are what separate a one-off prompt from a real system: they give Claude permanent, reusable knowledge about your business, your account, your margins, and your brand, so you are never starting from zero. Create a dedicated Claude Project (or an equivalent persistent folder) and load all ten files into it.

Step 2 — Export the data your first analysis needs. Part 1's Data Checklist lists every useful Google Ads and Merchant Center export, what it's for, and where to find it. You do not need every export for every Skill — each Skill in Part 2 states exactly which files it needs. Start with the exports needed for Skill 1 (Full Account Audit) and Skill 91 (Conversion Tracking Audit); together they give you an honest baseline and confirm your data can be trusted.

Step 3 — Run your first audit. Use Skill 1 as your entry point regardless of account size or maturity. It will surface a prioritized list of findings using the P0–P3 system described in Part 3. Treat P0 findings as this week's work.

Step 4 — Establish the weekly rhythm. Part 4 lays out a complete weekly operating system, with 15-minute, 30-minute, 60-minute, and agency-scale versions. Pick the version that matches your available time and commit to it as a fixed weekly habit, not something you do when you remember to.

Step 5 — Validate before you implement. Every Skill's output is a recommendation, not an instruction to execute blindly. Claude works from the data you give it; it cannot see your Merchant Center account directly, verify a live page rendered correctly, or know about a business decision that hasn't been written into your context files yet. Read the Validation Checklist included with every Skill before acting on its output, and treat anything touching live bidding, budget, or a major structural change with the phased, monitored rollout discipline described throughout Category 6.

Step 6 — Keep the loop closed. Log what you test and what you learn in 10-TESTING-LOG.md (Skill 100 exists specifically for this). This is what turns a single good audit into a compounding system — each month's work should make the next month's work faster and better-informed, not start over from scratch.

3. Data Claude Needs — The Export Checklist

Every Skill in Part 2 states exactly which of these exports it needs. This is the full reference list.

Campaign Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Campaigns → Segment by day/week; or via Google Ads API / Google Ads Editor
Why it matters	The foundational dataset for nearly every Skill in this guide — spend, clicks, conversions, revenue, and impression share by campaign over time.
Useful columns	Campaign, Campaign Type, Spend, Clicks, Impressions, CTR, Avg. CPC, Conversions, Conv. Value, CPA, ROAS, Impr. Share, Impr. Share Lost (Budget), Impr. Share Lost (Rank)
Claude uses it for	Full account audits, budget allocation, scaling decisions, anomaly detection, executive reporting.

Ad Group Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Ad groups tab, same segmentation as above
Why it matters	Reveals structural issues invisible at the campaign level — cannibalization, over-fragmentation, mismatched intent within a campaign.
Useful columns	Campaign, Ad Group, Spend, Conversions, CPA, CTR, Quality Score components if available
Claude uses it for	Campaign architecture review, complexity audit, ad group structure recommendations.

Keyword Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Keywords tab, segmented by match type
Why it matters	The basis for match type strategy, cannibalization checks, and portfolio pruning.
Useful columns	Keyword, Match Type, Ad Group, Spend, Conversions, CPA, Quality Score, Impressions
Claude uses it for	Match type audit, cannibalization check, keyword pruning, query-to-keyword mapping.

Search Term Report

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Insights and reports → Search terms, or Keywords → Search terms tab
Why it matters	The single most important export in this entire guide — the ground truth of what real users typed.
Useful columns	Search Term, Matched Keyword, Match Type, Campaign, Ad Group, Spend, Clicks, Conversions
Claude uses it for	Search term waste audit, negative keyword creation, keyword expansion, intent classification, long-tail discovery.

Auction Insights

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Auction insights tab, at campaign, ad group, or keyword level
Why it matters	Reveals competitive dynamics not visible in your own performance data alone — who else is competing, and how your share is trending.
Useful columns	Domain, Impression Share, Overlap Rate, Position Above Rate, Top of Page Rate, Outranking Share
Claude uses it for	Brand traffic leakage detection, competitor keyword analysis, scaling risk assessment.

Device Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Segment → Device
Why it matters	Surfaces mobile-specific experience problems that a blended report hides.
Useful columns	Device, Spend, Conversions, CPA, CVR, CTR
Claude uses it for	Device segmentation audit, mobile UX diagnostic.

Geographic Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Segment → Location, or the Locations report
Why it matters	Identifies performance variance across regions that a single campaign can mask.
Useful columns	Location, Spend, Conversions, CPA, ROAS
Claude uses it for	Geographic segmentation audit.

Audience Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Audiences tab
Why it matters	Shows how remarketing, in-market, and custom audience segments are actually performing versus cold traffic.
Useful columns	Audience, Spend, Conversions, CPA
Claude uses it for	PMax structure review, budget allocation.

Asset (Ad Copy) Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Ads & assets → Assets, with per-asset performance labels
Why it matters	Shows which individual headlines/descriptions Google is rating best/good/low within your RSAs.
Useful columns	Asset text, Performance label, Impressions
Claude uses it for	RSA diagnostic, ad fatigue detection.

Shopping Product Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Products tab (Shopping/PMax campaigns)
Why it matters	Product-level spend, revenue, and conversion data — essential for ecommerce accounts.
Useful columns	Product Title, Product ID, Spend, Conversions, Conv. Value, Impressions
Claude uses it for	Shopping structure review, product-level profit analysis, zombie product detection.

Merchant Center Feed & Diagnostics

Where to get it	Merchant Center → Products → Diagnostics, and the raw feed file/URL
Why it matters	The source of feed disapprovals, warnings, and the actual attribute data driving Shopping matching.
Useful columns	Item ID, Title, Description, GTIN, Product Type, Google Product Category, Issue, Severity
Claude uses it for	Feed audit, title optimization, taxonomy review, disapproval fixes.

Conversion Actions Settings

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Goals → Conversions → Summary, click into each action
Why it matters	Reveals counting method, attribution model, and primary/secondary status — critical for trust in every other number.
Useful columns	Conversion Action, Category, Counting (One/Every), Value, Attribution Model, Primary/Secondary
Claude uses it for	Conversion tracking audit, primary/secondary review, duplicate detection.

Landing Page Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Landing pages report (under Insights and reports)
Why it matters	Connects ad spend directly to specific destination URLs, exposing which pages are actually converting traffic.
Useful columns	Landing Page, Spend, Conversions, CVR, Mobile-friendly click rate
Claude uses it for	Message match audit, landing page conversion readiness scoring.

Time/Day Performance

Where to get it	Google Ads UI → Segment → Hour of day / Day of week
Why it matters	Occasionally reveals dayparting inefficiencies, though usually a lower-priority export than the others above.
Useful columns	Hour/Day, Spend, Conversions, CPA
Claude uses it for	Scaling readiness, minor bid adjustment opportunities.

4. Google Ads Economics

Every Skill in Category 6 and 7 of this guide rests on a small set of financial formulas. Get these right once, keep them current in 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md, and every downstream bidding target, budget decision, and profitability report inherits accurate numbers instead of guesses.

CPC (Cost Per Click) — total spend divided by total clicks. The base unit of paid search cost.

CTR (Click-Through Rate) — clicks divided by impressions. A relevance and creative quality signal, not a profitability signal on its own.

CVR (Conversion Rate) — conversions divided by clicks. The bridge between traffic and revenue.

CPA (Cost Per Acquisition) — spend divided by conversions. Equivalently, CPC divided by CVR.

ROAS (Return on Ad Spend) — conversion value divided by spend. A ratio, not a dollar figure — a high ROAS on a small budget can matter less to the business than a moderate ROAS on a large one.

MER (Marketing Efficiency Ratio) — total revenue divided by total marketing spend across all channels, not just Google Ads. Useful for sanity-checking whether Google Ads' own ROAS is being propped up or cannibalized by other channels.

CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost) — total spend divided by new customers acquired (distinct from CPA, which may count repeat-purchase conversions too).

AOV (Average Order Value) — total revenue divided by number of orders.

LTV (Customer Lifetime Value) — total expected revenue (or profit) from a customer over the full relationship, not just the first transaction. Critical context for deciding how aggressively to bid on new-customer acquisition, since a CAC that looks unprofitable on a first purchase alone can be very profitable against LTV.

Gross Margin — (Revenue – Cost of Goods Sold) / Revenue, expressed as a percentage.

Contribution Margin — Revenue minus all variable costs (COGS, payment processing, fulfillment, ad spend itself) — what's left to contribute toward fixed costs and profit.

Break-Even ROAS — the minimum ROAS at which ad spend is not losing money, calculated as 1 divided by Gross Margin percentage. Example: at a 40% gross margin, break-even ROAS is 1 / 0.40 = 2.5x. Below 2.5x ROAS, this product is losing money on every ad-driven sale before accounting for any other cost.

Break-Even CPA — the maximum cost per acquisition before a conversion stops being profitable, calculated as Average Order Value multiplied by Gross Margin percentage. Example: a $100 AOV product at 40% gross margin has a break-even CPA of $40.

Payback Period — how long it takes for the gross profit from a customer to cover their acquisition cost, relevant for subscription or repeat-purchase businesses where a single transaction's margin doesn't cover

CAC but the relationship does over time.

The critical distinction this guide returns to constantly: Revenue ROAS is not the same as profitability. A campaign reporting a healthy 5.0x ROAS on a product line with 15% gross margin is losing money on every sale — break-even ROAS at 15% margin is 6.67x. The same 5.0x ROAS on a 60% margin product line is comfortably profitable, since break-even there is only 1.67x. No optimization decision in this guide should be made from ROAS alone without checking it against the specific product or campaign's real margin.

Build Your Claude Google Ads Operating System

The reader should never start from zero. Before running any Skill in Part 2, build a dedicated Claude Project (or persistent folder) containing these ten files. Load all ten at the start of every session so Claude has permanent, reusable context instead of relying on what fits in a single prompt.

01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

Purpose: Gives Claude the business-level facts no Google Ads export can provide: what the company sells, its stage, its priorities, and any constraint (inventory, sales capacity, seasonality) that should shape ad decisions.

What to include: Business name and one-line description; business model (ecommerce/lead-gen/SaaS/services); current growth stage and priorities for the next quarter; known capacity constraints (inventory, sales team bandwidth, support capacity); key dates (launches, sales, seasonal peaks); anything Claude should never recommend without checking (e.g., 'never recommend increasing spend on Product X — limited inventory until March').

How Claude uses it: Referenced any time a recommendation needs to be checked against real-world capacity (Skill 74, Scaling Readiness Assessment) or business priority (Skill 78, Portfolio-Level Budget Prioritization).

```
# 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

## Business Overview
- Business name:
- One-line description:
- Business model: [Ecommerce / Lead Generation / SaaS / Services / Marketplace]
- Website:

## Current Priorities (this quarter)
1.
2.
3.

## Capacity Constraints
- Inventory constraints:
- Sales team capacity:
- Support/fulfillment capacity:

## Key Dates
- Seasonal peaks:
- Planned launches/promotions:

## Guardrails for Claude
- Never recommend:
- Always flag before recommending:
```

02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md

Purpose: A living record of how the account is actually structured and why — including intentional decisions that would otherwise get incorrectly flagged as errors in every audit.

What to include: Campaign architecture overview and the logic behind it; naming convention in use; custom label schema (if applicable); any intentional duplication or non-standard structure and its reason; account history notes (major past changes, known issues, prior restructures).

How Claude uses it: Prevents repeated false-positive findings in Skills 1, 3, 13, and 22 by distinguishing deliberate structure from accidental drift.

```
# 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md

## Account Structure Overview
- Campaign architecture logic:
- Naming convention:

## Custom Label Schema (if applicable)
- custom_label_0:
- custom_label_1:
- custom_label_2:
- custom_label_3:
- custom_label_4:

## Intentional Non-Standard Structures
(Document anything an audit might otherwise flag as an error)
-

## Account History Notes
-
```

03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

Purpose: The product/service catalog with the attributes Claude needs for feed work, keyword mapping, and margin-aware decisions.

What to include: Product/service list with category, key attributes, use cases; margin tier or actual margin percentage per product/line; current offers, guarantees, and promotions; anything explicitly NOT to claim (unverified certifications, discontinued guarantees).

How Claude uses it: Central input for Category 3 (feed/titles), Category 4 (ad copy factual grounding), and margin-aware Skills throughout Category 6/7.

```
# 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

## Product / Service Catalog
| Product/Line | Category | Key Attributes | Margin Tier | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|

## Current Offers
-

## Claims We Can Make
-

## Claims We Cannot Make
-
```

04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md

Purpose: Describes who the business is actually trying to reach, so ad copy, creative angles, and landing page recommendations target the real audience rather than a generic one.

What to include: ICP description(s) if more than one segment exists; primary pain points and priorities per segment; language/tone the audience responds to; any audience the business explicitly does NOT want to target.

How Claude uses it: Feeds directly into Category 4 (headline angles, benefit translation) and Category 5 (message-market fit).

```
# 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md

## Primary ICP
- Description:
- Primary pain points:
- What they care about most:
- Language/tone that resonates:

## Secondary ICP (if applicable)
-

## Explicitly Not Our Audience
-
```

05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

Purpose: The single source of truth for every financial calculation in this guide — margins, break-even figures, target CPA/ROAS.

What to include: Gross margin by product line; AOV/deal size; break-even CPA and ROAS (calculated, with formula shown); target CPA/ROAS including desired profit margin; any non-COGS costs that should factor into break-even (payment processing, fulfillment, returns).

How Claude uses it: Referenced in nearly every Category 6 and 7 Skill; this is the file to keep most rigorously current.

```
# 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

## Margin Data
| Product/Line | Gross Margin % | AOV | Break-Even CPA | Break-Even ROAS |
|---|---|---|---|---|

## Non-COGS Costs to Factor In
- Payment processing:
- Fulfillment:
- Returns rate:

## Target CPA / ROAS (includes desired profit margin)
| Product/Line | Target CPA | Target ROAS |
|---|---|---|

## LTV Reference (if applicable)
-
```

06-BRAND-VOICE.md

Purpose: Keeps ad copy and creative consistent with how the brand actually sounds, rather than defaulting to generic ad-speak.

What to include: Tone description with examples; words/phrases to use; words/phrases to avoid; example headlines that nail the voice; example headlines that miss it and why.

How Claude uses it: Referenced in every Category 4 copywriting Skill.

```
# 06-BRAND-VOICE.md

## Tone
- Description:
- Examples of our tone done well:

## Vocabulary
- Words/phrases we use:
- Words/phrases we avoid:

## Good Examples
-

## Bad Examples (and why)
-
```

07-COMPETITORS.md

Purpose: Documents real, stated competitive differentiation so ad copy and competitor-term strategy are grounded in fact, not invention.

What to include: Named competitors; how each compares on price, features, and positioning; our genuine, substantiated differentiators; areas where we are NOT differentiated (honesty here prevents Claude from manufacturing false claims).

How Claude uses it: Referenced in Skills 24 (competitor keyword analysis) and 45 (competitive differentiation copy audit).

```
# 07-COMPETITORS.md

## Named Competitors
| Competitor | How They Position | Their Strengths | Their Weaknesses |
|---|---|---|---|

## Our Genuine Differentiators
-

## Where We Are NOT Differentiated
(Important — prevents fabricated claims)
-
```

08-LANDING-PAGES.md

Purpose: A running inventory of landing pages, known issues, and mobile-specific notes so Category 5 diagnostics build on existing knowledge instead of starting fresh each time.

What to include: Landing page inventory mapped to campaigns/ad groups; known UX issues (especially mobile); any technical constraints (page speed, CMS limitations); prior test results on this page.

How Claude uses it: Referenced throughout Category 5, especially Skills 53 (message match) and 61 (mobile UX).

```
# 08-LANDING-PAGES.md

## Landing Page Inventory
| URL | Maps to Campaign/Ad Group | Known Issues | Mobile Notes |
|---|---|---|---|

## Technical Constraints
-

## Prior Test Results
-
```

09-PERFORMANCE-BENCHMARKS.md

Purpose: Historical performance ranges so Claude can distinguish a genuine anomaly from normal account variance, rather than flagging every fluctuation.

What to include: Typical CPA/ROAS/CVR ranges by campaign type; known seasonal patterns; historical volatility ranges for key metrics.

How Claude uses it: Referenced in Skill 83 (anomaly detection) and Skill 26 (search term trend analysis) to distinguish signal from noise.

```
# 09-PERFORMANCE-BENCHMARKS.md

## Typical Ranges by Campaign Type
| Campaign Type | Typical CPA Range | Typical ROAS Range | Typical CVR Range |
|---|---|---|---|

## Known Seasonal Patterns
-

## Historical Volatility Notes
-
```

10-TESTING-LOG.md

Purpose: The account's institutional memory — every test run, its hypothesis, and its outcome, so learning compounds instead of evaporating.

What to include: A running, dated log of every test: hypothesis, design, result, and what it changed going forward; a backlog section for pending test ideas awaiting prioritization.

How Claude uses it: Central to Skills 77 (pause decisions), 98 (experiment prioritization), and 100 (postmortems) — keep this file current every week.

```
# 10-TESTING-LOG.md

## Pending Test Backlog
| Idea | Source Skill | Expected Impact | Status |
|---|---|---|---|

## Completed Tests
### [Date] — [Test Name]
- Hypothesis:
- Design:
- Result:
- What this changes going forward:
```

PART 2

The 100 Claude Skills

Organized into 8 categories. Every Skill is a complete, deployable workflow.

CATEGORY 1

Account Audit and Structure

Before you can fix a Google Ads account, you have to see it clearly. Most accounts are not broken because of one bad decision — they are broken because of a hundred small structural decisions made over years, by different people, with no single person accountable for the architecture. This category gives Claude the exports it needs to reconstruct a complete, honest picture of how the account is built, where it overlaps with itself, and where structure is silently taxing performance.

---

1 Full Account Audit

OBJECTIVE

Produce a single, prioritized diagnostic of the entire Google Ads account — structure, spend distribution, performance, and risk — in one pass, so you know where to focus first.

WHEN TO USE IT

Day 1 of taking over an account, quarterly health checks, or any time performance has drifted and you don't know why.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign performance (90 days, daily)
- Ad group performance (90 days)
- Account change history export
- Conversion action list with attribution settings

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md
- 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md
- Campaign performance CSV
- Ad group performance CSV

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export campaign performance for the last 90 days at the daily level, plus a 12-month campaign-level summary.
2. Export ad group performance and conversion action settings.
3. Load 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md and 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md so Claude has margin, target CPA/ROAS, and account history.
4. Run the Claude Prompt below with all exports attached.
5. Have Claude rank findings by financial impact, not by how interesting they are.
6. Convert the top 5 findings into a one-week action list before touching anything else.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *You are a senior Google Ads auditor reviewing this account for the first time. You have campaign performance (90-day daily and 12-month summary), ad group performance, and account context attached. Do not assume the account is well-structured — verify it. Analyze in this order: (1) spend concentration — what % of spend sits in the top 5 campaigns, and does that match where conversions/revenue actually come from; (2) performance trend — is CPA/ROAS improving, flat, or degrading over the 90-day window, broken out by week; (3) structural red flags — campaigns with overlapping keywords or audiences, campaigns below $10/day that can't exit the Learning Phase, conversion actions that look duplicated or mislabeled; (4) waste signals — campaigns spending with zero or near-zero conversions over 30+ days. For each finding, state the estimated monthly dollar impact, not just a description. Output a ranked list (P0–P3, using the priority system: P0 = immediate financial risk, P1 = high-impact optimization, P2 = medium-term opportunity, P3 = testing opportunity) with one recommended next action per finding. Do not recommend pausing anything without showing the data that justifies it. Flag any conclusion you are making with incomplete data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked findings table (Finding / Evidence / Est. Monthly Impact / Priority / Recommended Action) plus a 2-3 sentence account-level summary.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Treat P0 items as this week's work, not this quarter's. If more than 3 findings are P0, the account has been unmanaged for a while — expect the first month to be mostly cleanup, not scaling.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Assign an owner and a deadline to every P0 finding
- Re-run this Skill monthly and diff the findings list against the prior run
- Feed confirmed findings into 10-TESTING-LOG.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every dollar-impact estimate traces back to a real number in the export, not a guess
- [ ] No recommendation contradicts 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md break-even figures
- [ ] P0 list is short enough to actually execute this week

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating this as a one-time exercise instead of a recurring baseline
- Acting on findings before checking conversion tracking is trustworthy (see Skill 91)
- Letting 'interesting' findings crowd out 'expensive' ones

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The single biggest predictor of whether an audit gets acted on is whether the output is short. A 40-item list gets ignored; a 5-item P0 list gets fixed. Force Claude to cut the list, even if it means holding P2/P3 items for next month.

---

2 Campaign Architecture Review

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether the current campaign structure (Search, Shopping, Performance Max, Display, Video) actually maps to the business's product/service lines, margins, and priorities.

WHEN TO USE IT

When campaigns have accumulated organically over time with no single architecture decision behind them, or before a restructure.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Full campaign list with type, budget, and objective
- Product/service catalog
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign list export
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export a full list of every campaign, its type, daily budget, and stated objective.
2. Map each campaign against the product/offer list in 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md.
3. Identify campaigns with no clear product/margin logic behind their grouping.
4. Ask Claude to propose a target architecture built around margin tiers, not just product categories.
5. Compare current vs. target architecture and estimate the migration effort.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Act as a Google Ads account architect. I've attached the full campaign list (type, budget, objective) and our product/offer catalog with margins. Evaluate whether the current campaign structure is organized around anything defensible — margin tier, product priority, funnel stage — or whether it has just accumulated. Specifically check: are high-margin products competing for budget in the same campaign as low-margin ones with no separation; are there campaigns whose only distinguishing feature is a naming convention, not a real targeting or budget difference; is Performance Max cannibalizing Search campaigns for the same products. Propose a target architecture that groups by margin tier first, then by product category, and explain in one paragraph why. List what would need to change to get there, in the order that minimizes disruption to current performance. Do not propose a rebuild unless the current structure is actively costing money — architecture changes for their own sake are a cost, not a benefit.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A current-vs-target architecture diagram (as a table), plus a migration sequence ordered by risk.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

If the target architecture looks radically different from current, migrate in phases over 4-6 weeks, never in one day — Performance Max and Smart Bidding both need to relearn after structural changes.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Pilot the new structure on one product line before rolling out account-wide
- Update 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md with the new architecture once live

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Target architecture is traceable to margin/priority data, not aesthetic preference
- [ ] Migration plan accounts for Smart Bidding learning-phase disruption

COMMON MISTAKES

- Restructuring right before a peak season
- Copying a 'best practice' structure from a different vertical without checking it fits this catalog

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Campaign structure is a proxy for budget control. The real question behind every architecture review is: can I move budget to the highest-margin product fast enough when it's converting well? If the answer is no, that's the finding.

---

3 Account Complexity Audit

OBJECTIVE

Quantify how many campaigns, ad groups, and keywords the account is running relative to its spend and traffic — and flag when complexity has outgrown the data available to support it.

WHEN TO USE IT

When an account 'feels' hard to manage, or before deciding whether to consolidate into fewer, more efficient campaigns.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign/ad group/keyword counts
- Monthly spend by campaign
- Monthly conversions by campaign

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Account structure export (counts)
- Campaign performance CSV

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export counts of active campaigns, ad groups, and keywords/asset groups.
2. Export monthly spend and conversion volume per campaign.
3. Calculate conversions-per-campaign and spend-per-ad-group ratios.
4. Ask Claude to flag any unit (campaign, ad group, keyword) that is statistically too small to generate a reliable Smart Bidding signal.
5. Propose a consolidation target based on a minimum viable conversion volume per unit.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *You are auditing this account for structural complexity relative to its data volume. I've attached counts of campaigns/ad groups/keywords and their monthly spend and conversion figures. Smart Bidding needs roughly 30 conversions per campaign per month to bid reliably — use that as your reference threshold, and say explicitly when a unit falls below it. Identify: (1) campaigns and ad groups generating fewer than 15 conversions/month that are still on automated bidding; (2) any campaign whose spend is too small to ever generate a meaningful signal (under a threshold you calculate from the account's own average CPA); (3) duplicate or near-duplicate ad groups targeting the same intent. For each, recommend consolidate, keep separate for a stated strategic reason, or pause. Output a table: Unit / Monthly Conversions / Recommendation / Reasoning. Then give one summary sentence on whether this account is over-segmented, under-segmented, or roughly right for its spend level.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A table of underpowered units with a consolidate/keep/pause recommendation for each, plus one summary verdict.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

An account with many campaigns each getting <15 conversions/month is fighting its own bidding algorithm. Consolidation almost always beats fragmentation once spend crosses a modest threshold.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Consolidate flagged ad groups into higher-volume parents before changing bid strategy
- Re-check this quarterly as spend grows

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Threshold used for 'underpowered' is stated and tied to the account's own CPA, not a generic rule of thumb

COMMON MISTAKES

- Splitting campaigns for organizational neatness without checking conversion volume per split
- Consolidating campaigns that are intentionally separated for a real business reason (e.g., different margin or geography)

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Complexity is not inherently bad — undocumented complexity is. If a fragmented structure exists for a real reason, keep it and write the reason into 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md so the next audit doesn't flag it again.

---

4 Campaign Objective Alignment Check

OBJECTIVE

Verify that each campaign's stated Google Ads objective (Sales, Leads, Traffic, Awareness) matches what the business actually needs from it, and that bidding is configured accordingly.

WHEN TO USE IT

When campaigns were set up by someone no longer on the team, or when performance goals feel disconnected from campaign settings.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign objective and bid strategy settings
- Business goals from 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign settings export
- 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export each campaign's declared objective, bid strategy, and primary conversion goal.
2. Cross-reference against the stated business priority for that product/service in 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md.
3. Flag mismatches — e.g., a 'Traffic' objective on a campaign the business considers a revenue driver.
4. Ask Claude to recommend the correct objective/bid strategy pairing for each flagged campaign.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached campaign objective and bid strategy settings against our business goals (attached). For each campaign, tell me whether the Google-declared objective (Sales, Leads, Traffic, Awareness, App Promotion) and the bid strategy actually serve what the business needs from that campaign — not just whether the settings are internally consistent. Flag specifically: any revenue-critical campaign running on a Traffic or Awareness objective; any campaign optimizing to a secondary/soft conversion action instead of the primary revenue action; any Maximize Clicks or Manual CPC campaign that should be on a conversion-based strategy given its data volume. For each mismatch, state the likely performance cost of leaving it as-is and the recommended correct configuration.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A table of Campaign / Current Objective / Recommended Objective / Why It Matters.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Objective mismatches are usually legacy — nobody actively chose them, they just never got updated after the campaign's role in the business changed.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix bid-strategy/objective mismatches on revenue-critical campaigns first
- Document the correct objective per campaign in 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every flagged mismatch is tied to a stated business priority, not a generic best practice

COMMON MISTAKES

- Changing objective and bid strategy simultaneously on a high-spend campaign without a controlled rollout

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill catches a specific, common failure: an account manager years ago set a campaign to 'Traffic' because leads weren't tracked yet. The tracking got fixed later, but the objective never did.

---

5 Search Campaign Structure Review

OBJECTIVE

Diagnose whether Search campaigns are segmented in a way that lets bidding, budget, and messaging operate independently where they need to, without unnecessary fragmentation.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before restructuring Search, or when Search CPA is inconsistent across what should be similar traffic.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search campaign and ad group list
- Keyword list with match types
- Search term report

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search campaign export
- Keyword performance CSV
- Search term report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the full Search campaign/ad group/keyword hierarchy with match types.
2. Export the search term report for the same period.
3. Ask Claude to map how closely ad groups match single, tight themes versus broad, mixed-intent groupings.
4. Identify ad groups where the search terms triggered span multiple distinct user intents.
5. Recommend splits or merges based on intent clustering, not keyword count alone.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review this Search campaign structure (campaign/ad group/keyword hierarchy with match types) alongside the search term report for the same period. For each ad group, assess whether the search terms it's actually triggering on represent one coherent user intent or several different ones bundled together. Flag ad groups that are too broad (mixed intents forcing generic ad copy) and ad groups that are needlessly fragmented (same intent split across multiple ad groups for no targeting reason). For each flagged ad group, propose the specific split or merge, and explain what ad copy or landing page benefit it unlocks — a structural change with no downstream benefit isn't worth making. Rank recommendations by estimated CTR/CVR uplift, highest first.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A list of ad groups to split or merge, each with the intent rationale and expected uplift.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Every split should earn its keep by enabling more relevant ad copy or a different landing page — splitting without a downstream change just adds management overhead.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Implement top 3 splits/merges first and monitor CTR for 2 weeks before continuing

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every recommended split is backed by actual search term evidence, not assumed intent

COMMON MISTAKES

- Over-fragmenting into single-keyword ad groups when volume can't support it (see Skill 3)

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

SKAGs (single keyword ad groups) went out of favor for a reason — with broad/phrase match and Smart Bidding, tight thematic ad groups of 5-15 closely related terms usually outperform either extreme.

---

6 Performance Max Structure Review

OBJECTIVE

Assess whether Performance Max asset groups, listing groups, and audience signals are structured to give the algorithm useful direction rather than operating as an unstructured black box.

WHEN TO USE IT

When PMax spend is growing but you can't explain what's driving results, or before adding new asset groups.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- PMax campaign settings
- Asset group performance
- Listing group / product feed segmentation
- Audience signal configuration

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- PMax asset group performance CSV
- Search category insights report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export asset group performance and listing group segmentation within each PMax campaign.
2. Export the Search category/Insights report to see what queries are actually being matched.
3. Ask Claude to assess whether asset groups map to distinct product/margin segments or are one undifferentiated group.
4. Check whether audience signals reflect actual first-party data (customer lists, high-intent site visitors) or are left at defaults.
5. Recommend a segmentation approach and specific audience signals to add.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Audit this Performance Max structure. I've attached asset group performance, listing group segmentation, and the Search category insights report. Determine: (1) whether asset groups are segmented by anything meaningful (margin tier, product category, new vs. returning customer) or whether everything sits in one undifferentiated group; (2) whether the Search category insights show queries that make sense for our business, or reveal the campaign is being matched to low-relevance traffic; (3) whether audience signals are configured with real first-party data or left at Google's defaults. For each gap, give a specific fix — e.g., 'split asset group X into two by margin tier, add customer-match audience signal.' Do not recommend adding negative keywords unless you can point to specific evidence in the category insights, since PMax negative control is limited and account-level brand exclusions can be costly.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A segmentation recommendation per asset group, an audience-signal gap list, and any category-insight red flags.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

PMax rewards structure, not neglect. An account with one giant asset group and default signals is giving the algorithm nothing to optimize toward beyond raw conversion volume.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add first-party audience signals before making any other PMax change — it's the highest-leverage, lowest-risk fix
- Segment asset groups by margin tier next

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every recommendation is grounded in the category insights or asset group data, not generic PMax advice

COMMON MISTAKES

- Adding account-level negative keywords to PMax reactively without confirming the query is actually a pattern, not a one-off

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The category insights report is the closest thing PMax gives you to a search term report — treat it as mandatory reading, not optional. It's also the primary evidence base for Skill 88 (PMax product grouping).

---

7 Shopping Campaign Structure Review

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether Shopping campaigns are segmented by priority, margin, and performance tier so budget flows to the products that deserve it.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before a Shopping restructure, or when a handful of products seem to be starving the rest of the catalog of budget.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Shopping campaign settings and priorities
- Product-level performance from Shopping
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Shopping product performance export
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export product-level performance from Shopping campaigns (impressions, clicks, cost, conversions, revenue).
2. Cross-reference against margin data in 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md.
3. Ask Claude to segment products into tiers (bestseller/high-margin, steady, long-tail, low-margin/liability).
4. Recommend a campaign priority and budget structure per tier.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Segment our Shopping catalog using the attached product-level performance data and margin data. Create four tiers: (1) bestsellers with strong margin — deserve dedicated budget and high priority; (2) steady performers — acceptable ROAS, moderate margin; (3) long-tail — low volume but not necessarily bad, worth a small always-on budget; (4) low-margin or negative-margin liabilities — spending budget the account can't afford to lose to break-even or losing products. For each tier, recommend a Shopping campaign structure (priority level, budget share, bidding approach) and name the specific products that belong in tier 4 so they can be reviewed for exclusion. Show your tier assignment logic, not just the final list, so it can be validated against the raw numbers.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A four-tier product segmentation with a recommended campaign/priority/budget structure per tier, and a named list of tier-4 products.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Tier 4 products aren't necessarily bad products — they may need a pricing, feed, or bidding fix rather than exclusion. Treat the tier as a flag for review, not an automatic pause list.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Move confirmed tier-1 products into a dedicated high-priority campaign with protected budget
- Review tier-4 products against Skill 34 (low-margin product exclusion) before excluding anything

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Margin data used matches 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md, not an assumed average margin

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using revenue alone to define 'bestseller' without checking margin — a high-revenue, low-margin product can be a liability

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Shopping campaign priority is a blunt instrument — 'High' priority campaigns win the auction over 'Low' priority ones for the same product even with a lower bid. Use it deliberately, not as a default on every campaign.

8 Brand vs. Non-Brand Separation Audit

OBJECTIVE

Confirm brand and non-brand traffic are cleanly separated so blended ROAS doesn't mask non-brand's real, weaker performance.

WHEN TO USE IT

Any time account-level ROAS looks strong but you suspect brand search is doing the heavy lifting.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign/keyword list flagged brand vs. non-brand
- Search term report
- Performance by campaign

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report
- Campaign performance CSV

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Classify all keywords and campaigns as brand or non-brand using the business's brand terms.
2. Export performance split by that classification.
3. Ask Claude to recompute account ROAS/CPA with and without brand.
4. Check the search term report for brand queries leaking into non-brand campaigns (or vice versa).

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using the brand term list [insert brand names/variations here] against the attached search term report and campaign performance, split all traffic into brand and non-brand. Recalculate ROAS, CPA, and spend share for each segment separately, and show the blended account number alongside them so the gap is visible. Then check the search term report for brand queries appearing in non-brand campaigns (wasted spend bidding on your own branded searches in a generic campaign) and non-brand queries appearing in brand campaigns (mislabeled traffic inflating brand's apparent efficiency). Quantify the dollar size of any leakage found. Close with one sentence stating what non-brand's real, standalone ROAS is — this is the number that should drive scaling decisions, not the blended one.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Brand vs. non-brand performance table, blended vs. unblended ROAS comparison, and a leakage dollar estimate.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

If non-brand ROAS alone is below break-even (from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md) while blended ROAS looks fine, the account is being propped up by brand demand it would likely get for free or near-free.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Ensure brand and non-brand always live in separate campaigns with separate budgets going forward
- Use non-brand-only ROAS for all scaling decisions

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Brand term list is complete, including common misspellings and product-name variants

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reporting blended ROAS to stakeholders as the headline number when brand and non-brand aren't separated

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is one of the most common ways an account 'looks' profitable while quietly losing money on the traffic that actually required paid acquisition to earn.

---

9 Match Type Strategy Audit

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether the account's mix of broad, phrase, and exact match is deliberate and monitored, or a default that's letting broad match run unchecked.

WHEN TO USE IT

Quarterly, and any time non-brand CPA rises without an obvious cause.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Keyword list with match types
- Search term report
- Performance by match type

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Keyword performance CSV segmented by match type
- Search term report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export keyword performance segmented by match type across all non-brand campaigns.
2. Export the search term report for the same window.
3. Ask Claude to compare CPA and conversion rate by match type.
4. Identify broad-match keywords whose triggered search terms have drifted from intent.
5. Recommend match type adjustments per keyword group, not account-wide.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Compare CPA, CVR, and spend share by match type (broad, phrase, exact) across the attached keyword performance data, and cross-reference against the search term report to see what broad match is actually triggering on. For every broad-match keyword group with meaningful spend, tell me whether the triggered search terms stayed on-intent or drifted. Where drift is costing money, recommend either tightening to phrase/exact or adding specific negatives — be precise about which is more appropriate given the volume at stake. Where broad match combined with Smart Bidding is clearly outperforming tighter match types (this does happen and is not automatically wrong), say so explicitly rather than defaulting to 'tighten everything.' Summarize with a recommended match type mix target for this account, given its current bidding strategy and conversion volume.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A match-type performance comparison table plus per-keyword-group recommendations, and one summary target mix.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Broad match isn't inherently bad — it's under-monitored broad match that's expensive. The finding that matters is whether search term review is happening often enough to keep it on a leash.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Tighten only the specific keyword groups with evidence of drift, not the whole account

- Set a recurring cadence (see Part 4 weekly workflow) for search term review on any broad-match group

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No recommendation to 'switch everything to exact match' without a data-backed reason — that trades relevance control for reach and often raises CPA

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating match type as a one-time setting instead of something that needs the same ongoing review as bids

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The real lever isn't match type in isolation — it's match type paired with negative keyword discipline (Category 2). Loose match type with tight negatives is a legitimate, often effective strategy.

---

10 Budget Fragmentation Audit

OBJECTIVE

Identify campaigns whose budgets are so small they can't compete for enough auctions to gather a useful performance signal, fragmenting total spend into ineffective pieces.

WHEN TO USE IT

When total account spend seems reasonable but nothing seems to be scaling, or impression share is chronically low across many campaigns.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign budget and impression share (lost to budget) report

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance CSV with Impr. Share (budget) column

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export campaign performance including 'Search/Content Impr. Share Lost (Budget)'.
2. Flag campaigns consistently losing significant impression share to budget.
3. Ask Claude to model the impact of consolidating small budgets into fewer, better-funded campaigns.
4. Recommend a consolidation or reallocation plan.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using the attached campaign performance data including impression share lost to budget, identify every campaign that is meaningfully budget-constrained (losing more than 20% of available impression share to budget) alongside its current CPA/ROAS. For the best-performing constrained campaigns, estimate the incremental conversions/revenue available if budget were fully unlocked, using the campaign's own recent conversion rate and CPC as the basis — show the math. Separately, list any campaign with a small budget AND weak performance, where the right move is reallocating that budget elsewhere rather than increasing it. Output two lists: 'fund me — proven demand, capped by budget' and 'don't fund me — small budget isn't the problem.' For the first list, rank by estimated incremental profit, not just incremental revenue.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Two ranked lists: budget-constrained campaigns worth funding (with modeled upside) vs. small campaigns not worth funding.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Impression share lost to budget is one of the few Google Ads metrics that translates almost directly into 'money left on the table' — but only for campaigns already proving efficient.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Move budget from underperforming small campaigns into proven, constrained ones before requesting net-new budget

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Upside estimates use the campaign's own historical CVR/CPC, not an account average

COMMON MISTAKES

- Increasing budget on every impression-share-constrained campaign regardless of whether its underlying performance justifies it

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This audit routinely finds free money — budget sitting on a strong campaign that's been capped for months because nobody checked the impression share column. It's usually the fastest win in the whole audit.

---

11 Geographic Segmentation Audit

OBJECTIVE

Determine whether performance varies enough by geography that the account should be bidding, budgeting, or messaging differently by location.

WHEN TO USE IT

When targeting a broad geography (country/region) as a single campaign and suspecting some areas outperform others.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Performance by geographic location (city/region/DMA level)

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Geographic performance report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export performance by location at the most granular level available.
2. Ask Claude to identify locations with statistically meaningful CPA/ROAS differences from the account average.
3. Determine whether the spread justifies geographic bid adjustments, separate campaigns, or no change.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Analyze the attached geographic performance report. Identify locations whose CPA or ROAS differs meaningfully from the account average, filtering out locations with too little spend/conversion volume to be reliable (state the minimum volume threshold you're using). For locations that clearly outperform, recommend a bid adjustment or, if the volume justifies it, a dedicated campaign with its own budget. For locations that clearly underperform, check whether the issue looks like poor product-market fit (a real business reason to reduce investment there) or something fixable, like a landing page/offer mismatch, and say which. Do not recommend bid adjustments smaller than what would produce a meaningful CPC change — trivial adjustments (±5%) rarely justify the added complexity.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A location performance table with a bid-adjustment or campaign-split recommendation per flagged location.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Geographic differences often correlate with shipping cost, delivery time, or local competition — treat this as a starting point for investigation, not a final verdict.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Apply bid adjustments to top and bottom outlier locations first
- Investigate whether underperforming regions have a fixable cause before excluding them

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Minimum volume threshold is stated and reasonable given account size

COMMON MISTAKES

- Making location bid adjustments based on a handful of conversions

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Geographic performance interacts heavily with device and time-of-day — before locking in a location strategy, sanity-check it against Skill 12 to make sure you're not really looking at a device effect that correlates with region.

---

12 Device Segmentation Audit

OBJECTIVE

Determine whether mobile, desktop, and tablet traffic convert differently enough to warrant separate bid strategies or landing page treatment.

WHEN TO USE IT

Quarterly, or when overall CVR feels lower than expected for the traffic quality.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Performance by device
- Landing page mobile experience notes from 08-LANDING-PAGES.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Device performance report
- 08-LANDING-PAGES.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export CPA/CVR/ROAS by device across campaigns.
2. Cross-reference against known landing page mobile UX issues in 08-LANDING-PAGES.md.
3. Ask Claude to separate 'this device converts worse because of a fixable page issue' from 'this device genuinely has lower intent for this offer.'
4. Recommend bid adjustments or a mobile-specific landing page fix.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached device performance report alongside our landing page notes. For each device, compare CVR against the account average and flag meaningful gaps. Your job is to distinguish two different explanations for a weak-converting device: (1) a fixable experience problem — e.g., mobile CVR is low and our landing page notes mention slow load time or a clunky mobile checkout; (2) a genuine intent difference — e.g., tablet traffic is mostly casual browsing for this product category, and no landing page fix will close that gap. For category (1), recommend the specific fix and treat it as higher priority than a bid adjustment. For category (2), recommend a bid adjustment instead. Be explicit about which explanation you believe applies to each device and why.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A device performance table with a fixable-vs-inherent classification and a matching recommendation for each device.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Bid adjustments treat a symptom; fixing a broken mobile experience treats the cause and usually has a bigger, more durable impact.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Prioritize any flagged mobile experience fix before applying device bid adjustments
- Re-test device bid adjustments after any landing page fix ships

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation ties back to a specific piece of evidence from 08-LANDING-PAGES.md, not a generic 'mobile UX is probably bad'

COMMON MISTAKES

- Permanently down-weighting mobile bids as a substitute for actually fixing the mobile page

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Mobile now drives the majority of clicks in most verticals — treating it as a lesser channel to bid down, rather than the primary experience to optimize, is one of the most common and costly blind spots in account management.

---

13 Naming Convention Audit

OBJECTIVE

Check whether campaign, ad group, and label naming is consistent enough to support reliable filtering, reporting, and automation.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before setting up automated rules, scripts, or Performance Max asset group tagging, or when reporting keeps requiring manual cleanup.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Full campaign and ad group name list

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign and ad group name export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export all campaign and ad group names.

2. Ask Claude to detect inconsistent naming patterns (mixed delimiters, missing product/geo/type tags, ad hoc names).
3. Propose a single naming convention that encodes the fields actually needed for filtering (type, product line, geo, funnel stage).
4. Estimate the cleanup effort.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached campaign and ad group names for consistency. Identify how many distinct naming patterns are currently in use, and which fields (campaign type, product line, geography, funnel stage, match type) are inconsistently included or missing entirely. Propose one naming convention template that would let someone filter the account reliably by any of those fields using text search alone, without opening each campaign. Show the template applied to five real example campaign names from the export so the change is concrete, not abstract. Note which existing campaigns would require renaming and flag if any naming inconsistency is actively breaking a specific reporting or automation use case, versus just being untidy.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A proposed naming convention template, five before/after examples, and a rename count.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Naming convention is not cosmetic — it's the foundation every automated rule, script, and saved report filter relies on.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Adopt the convention for all new campaigns immediately
- Batch-rename existing campaigns during the next planned maintenance window

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Template encodes only fields that are actually used for filtering — don't over-engineer it

COMMON MISTAKES

- Designing an elaborate naming taxonomy nobody will maintain consistently

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Keep it boring and enforce it. The best naming convention is the one the whole team will actually follow, not the most complete one on paper.

---

14 Account Restructuring Plan

OBJECTIVE

Turn the findings from Skills 1-13 into a single, sequenced restructuring plan that minimizes performance disruption.

WHEN TO USE IT

After a full account audit has surfaced multiple structural issues that need to be fixed together, not piecemeal.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Outputs from prior audit Skills in this category
- Current campaign performance baseline

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- All Category 1 Skill outputs
- 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather the findings and recommendations from every audit run in this category.
2. Ask Claude to sequence them into phases that avoid changing bid strategy, budget, and structure simultaneously.
3. Assign a rollback plan to each phase.
4. Set a monitoring checkpoint between phases before proceeding.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *I'm attaching the findings from our account audit, campaign architecture review, complexity audit, and related structural reviews. Synthesize these into a single sequenced restructuring plan. Group changes into phases such that no phase simultaneously changes bid strategy AND budget AND campaign structure for the same campaign — Smart Bidding needs a stable signal to relearn from, and stacking changes makes it impossible to attribute results afterward. For each phase, state: what changes, the expected disruption window (how many days of noisy data to expect), the rollback plan if performance degrades beyond a stated threshold, and the checkpoint metric to review before starting the next phase. Order phases by a combination of financial impact and implementation risk, doing the highest-impact, lowest-risk changes first.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A phased restructuring roadmap (Phase / Changes / Expected Disruption / Rollback Plan / Checkpoint Metric).

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

If the plan has more than 4-5 phases, the account needs more time, not more speed — rushing a restructure is how good audits produce bad quarters.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Get sign-off on the full phased plan before starting Phase 1
- Log the plan and actual results in 10-TESTING-LOG.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No phase stacks a bid strategy change with a budget change on the same campaign
- [ ] Every phase has a stated rollback trigger

COMMON MISTAKES

- Executing all audit recommendations at once because they're all 'ready'
- Skipping the checkpoint pause between phases under deadline pressure

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The plan is worth more than the audit. Anyone can list problems; the value Claude adds here is sequencing fixes so you can actually tell what worked.

CATEGORY 2

Keyword and Search Term Mining

The search term report is the most honest document in Google Ads. It shows exactly what real people typed before your ad showed up — not what you hoped they'd type. Most accounts review it sporadically, if at all, which means months of irrelevant clicks accumulate before anyone notices. This category turns search term review into a repeatable weekly discipline: separating relevant-but-unprofitable traffic from genuinely irrelevant traffic, finding the queries worth turning into new keywords, and keeping the keyword portfolio itself honest over time.

---

15 Search Term Waste Audit

OBJECTIVE

Find every search term that spent money without converting over a meaningful window, and classify why.

WHEN TO USE IT

Weekly, as the standing first pass on any account with active Search or Shopping spend.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term report (30-60 days)
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md break-even CPA

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report CSV
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the search term report for the last 30-60 days at the search-term level.
2. Filter for terms with spend above a meaningful threshold (e.g., 1.5x break-even CPA) and zero conversions.
3. Ask Claude to classify each into: irrelevant, relevant-but-unprofitable, or under-tested (too little spend to judge yet).
4. Convert 'irrelevant' terms into negative keyword candidates (feeds Skill 16).
5. Flag 'relevant-but-unprofitable' terms for a bid, landing page, or offer review instead of exclusion.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *You are reviewing our search term report for wasted spend. Attached is the term-level report for the last 30-60 days and our break-even CPA from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md. For every search term with spend greater than 1.5x break-even CPA and zero conversions, classify it into exactly one bucket: (a) IRRELEVANT — the term has nothing to do with what we sell and should be excluded outright; (b) RELEVANT BUT UNPROFITABLE — the term matches real buying intent for our products but isn't converting, which points to a landing page, price, or offer problem rather than a targeting problem; (c) UNDER-TESTED — spend is too low relative to our typical conversion rate to draw a conclusion yet, needs more data before any action. Output a table: Search Term / Spend / Clicks / Classification / Reasoning / Recommended Action. Sum total wasted spend for bucket (a) as a monthly estimate. Do not classify a term as irrelevant just because it didn't convert — intent and profitability are different questions.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A classified search term table plus a total monthly waste estimate for the irrelevant bucket.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The irrelevant bucket total is the most defensible 'quick win' number in the whole audit — it's money that can stop leaving tomorrow with a negative keyword list.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Push irrelevant terms into Skill 16 immediately
- Route relevant-but-unprofitable terms to Category 5 (landing page/offer diagnosis)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Spend threshold is stated and reasonable for account size
- [ ] No relevant-but-unprofitable term gets excluded outright — that's a different fix

COMMON MISTAKES

- Excluding every non-converting term regardless of relevance, which quietly narrows reach and can raise CPCs on remaining traffic

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the single highest-frequency Skill in the whole system. If you only run one Skill every week, run this one.

---

16 Negative Keyword List Creation

OBJECTIVE

Turn classified irrelevant search terms into a structured, reusable negative keyword list applied at the correct level (ad group, campaign, or shared list).

WHEN TO USE IT

Immediately after Skill 15, or whenever a batch of irrelevant terms has accumulated.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Classified irrelevant search terms from Skill 15
- Existing negative keyword lists

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 15 output
- Current shared negative list export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Take the irrelevant-term list from the waste audit.
2. Group terms into logical negative keyword themes (not one-by-one) so the list stays maintainable.
3. Ask Claude to recommend match type per negative and the correct application level.
4. Check the proposed list against existing negatives for duplicates.
5. Upload the finalized list.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using the attached list of irrelevant search terms, build a structured negative keyword list. Group related terms into themes (e.g., 'jobs/careers', 'free/DIY', 'unrelated brand names') rather than listing every term individually — themes are easier to maintain and audit later. For each theme, recommend: the negative match type (broad, phrase, or exact) that blocks the waste without risking legitimate traffic, and the correct application level — shared list at the account level (for terms irrelevant everywhere, like competitor job postings) versus campaign-level (for terms irrelevant only in specific campaigns, like a term relevant to one product line but not another). Cross-check against our existing negative list (attached) and flag any duplicates. Output a ready-to-upload table: Theme / Negative Terms / Match Type / Application Level.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ready-to-upload negative keyword list organized by theme, match type, and application level.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Campaign-level negatives that should be shared-list negatives (or vice versa) is one of the most common small errors — check the application level recommendation carefully before uploading.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Upload immediately for the irrelevant bucket
- Re-run Skill 15 in 2 weeks to confirm the leak stopped

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No negative term risks blocking a legitimate high-value query — spot-check the top 5 by potential reach impact

COMMON MISTAKES

- Adding broad-match negatives that accidentally block relevant long-tail queries containing the same root word

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Maintain a single master shared negative list per business unit rather than scattering negatives across dozens of campaign-level lists — it's the difference between a 10-minute weekly update and a 2-hour audit every quarter.

---

17 Keyword Expansion Discovery

OBJECTIVE

Find new keyword opportunities from search terms that are already converting but aren't yet added as their own keywords.

WHEN TO USE IT

Weekly alongside the waste audit — expansion and pruning are two sides of the same search term review.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term report
- Current keyword list

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report CSV
- Keyword list export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the search term report and current keyword list.
2. Ask Claude to find converting search terms not already present as exact-match keywords.

3. Filter for terms with enough volume to be worth managing independently.
4. Recommend match type and starting bid for each new keyword.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Compare the attached search term report against our current keyword list. Identify search terms that have generated at least [2] conversions but are not yet added as their own exact-match keyword — these are proven queries currently being caught incidentally by broader match types, with no dedicated bid control. For each, recommend: the exact-match keyword to add, which ad group it belongs in based on existing structure, and a starting bid based on the term's own historical CPC and conversion rate. Rank the list by total conversions generated, highest first, so the highest-value additions get implemented first. Exclude any term that's a near-duplicate of an existing keyword.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked table of new exact-match keyword candidates with recommended ad group and starting bid.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Adding proven terms as exact-match keywords gives you independent bid control over your best-performing queries instead of leaving them at the mercy of a broader match type's average bid.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add the top 10 by conversion volume this week
- Set starting bids slightly below the term's historical CPC and let Smart Bidding adjust

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No proposed keyword duplicates an existing one at a different match type in the same ad group (causes internal competition)

COMMON MISTAKES

- Adding every converting term as exact match, fragmenting the account with low-volume duplicates (revisit Skill 3's threshold logic)

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill and Skill 15 should run together every week — one prunes waste, the other captures proven demand. Skipping either leaves value on the table.

---

18 High-Intent Keyword Discovery

OBJECTIVE

Identify and prioritize keyword opportunities that signal strong purchase or lead intent, even before they have Google Ads performance data.

WHEN TO USE IT

When expanding into a new product line or when non-brand growth has plateaued on the current keyword set.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current keyword list
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- Search term report for intent-signal patterns

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Current keyword list
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- Search term report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Provide Claude with the product/offer catalog and current keyword coverage.
2. Ask Claude to generate a candidate keyword list built around commercial-intent modifiers relevant to the vertical.
3. Cross-check candidates against the search term report for any existing signal.
4. Prioritize candidates by estimated intent strength and coverage gap.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using our product/offer catalog and current keyword list, generate a prioritized list of high-commercial-intent keyword candidates we are not yet targeting. Focus on modifiers that signal someone is close to a buying or lead decision for our specific products (e.g., pricing, comparison, 'near me', model/SKU-specific, 'best X for Y' where Y matches our actual ICP use case) rather than generic category terms we likely already cover. For each candidate, state which product/offer it maps to and why you expect commercial intent, and cross-check whether any variant of it already appears in the search term report as a signal it's real, not theoretical. Rank by estimated intent strength, and flag any candidate that overlaps with a competitor's brand name for legal/policy review before use.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked, evidence-linked list of new high-intent keyword candidates mapped to products.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Candidates with existing search term evidence are safer bets than pure hypotheses — start there before testing purely speculative terms.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Launch evidence-backed candidates in a controlled test campaign with a capped budget
- Track results in 10-TESTING-LOG.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No candidate uses a competitor trademark without a policy check

COMMON MISTAKES

- Confusing high search volume with high intent — volume and intent are different axes

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The best high-intent keyword sources are usually hiding in your own search term report as low-spend, high-conversion-rate outliers — mine your own data before reaching for generic keyword-research heuristics.

---

19 Low-Intent Traffic Detection

OBJECTIVE

Systematically identify keyword themes and search term patterns that attract browsers, researchers, or bargain-hunters rather than buyers.

WHEN TO USE IT

When CTR is healthy but CVR is weak across a broad set of keywords, suggesting a traffic quality problem rather than a landing page problem.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term report
- Keyword performance by CVR

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report
- Keyword performance CSV

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export search terms and keyword-level CVR.
2. Ask Claude to identify recurring linguistic patterns (free, DIY, how to, cheap, jobs, definitions) correlated with low conversion.
3. Quantify spend tied to each pattern.
4. Recommend negatives or bid adjustments per pattern.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Analyze the attached search term report for linguistic patterns associated with low purchase intent — for example terms containing 'free', 'DIY', 'how to', 'definition', 'jobs', 'salary', 'cheap' (only if we don't compete on price), or informational question phrasing not aligned with a buying moment. For each pattern found in our data, report how much spend it's associated with, its conversion rate versus the account average, and whether it should be excluded outright or just bid down (bid down if the pattern still contains some genuine buyers mixed in, exclude if it's essentially always low-intent for our specific business). Do not use a generic low-intent word list — derive the patterns from what's actually present and underperforming in our own search term data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A pattern-level table (Pattern / Spend / CVR vs. Average / Exclude or Bid Down) grounded in the account's own data.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Low-intent patterns are vertical-specific — 'free' matters enormously for a paid SaaS tool and barely at all for a company that already offers a free tier.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Feed exclusion-worthy patterns into Skill 16
- Feed bid-down patterns into bid adjustment planning

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every pattern is backed by this account's actual data, not a generic negative keyword list copied from elsewhere

COMMON MISTAKES

- Applying a generic 'bad word' negative list without checking whether it matches this specific business's buyer language

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Query-to-keyword mapping (Skill 21) and this Skill work best in sequence — first find the bad patterns here, then use the mapping exercise to make sure the fix doesn't collaterally block good queries that happen to share a word.

---

20 Informational vs. Commercial Intent Classifier

OBJECTIVE

Segment the keyword and search term portfolio by funnel stage so budget, bidding, and messaging can be matched to the right intent.

WHEN TO USE IT

When building a full-funnel keyword strategy, or when top-of-funnel and bottom-of-funnel keywords are being bid on identically.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Keyword list
- Search term report

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Keyword list export
- Search term report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export all active keywords and recent search terms.
2. Ask Claude to classify each into informational, commercial-investigation, or transactional intent.
3. Compare current bid strategy and budget share against that classification.
4. Recommend a differentiated approach per intent tier.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Classify every keyword in the attached list, plus the top search terms by volume, into one of three funnel stages: INFORMATIONAL (learning, no near-term purchase signal), COMMERCIAL INVESTIGATION (comparing options, reading reviews, evaluating), or TRANSACTIONAL (ready to buy or convert now). Then show current spend and bid strategy broken out by these three tiers. Flag any mismatch — for example, informational keywords being bid on with the same Target CPA as transactional ones, or a disproportionate share of budget sitting in informational terms relative to how much revenue they generate. Recommend a differentiated approach per tier: which tier deserves aggressive bidding toward the primary conversion action, and which (if any) is worth keeping only for a softer, secondary conversion goal like newsletter signup or content engagement.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A three-tier intent classification of the keyword portfolio with a budget/bid-strategy mismatch flag and tier-specific recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Informational keywords aren't automatically worth cutting — they can be valuable for remarketing pools or brand building — but they should almost never share a Target CPA with transactional terms.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Separate informational keywords into their own campaign with a distinct, softer goal
- Protect budget for the transactional tier first in any reallocation

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Classification logic is explained per keyword, not just asserted, so it can be spot-checked

COMMON MISTAKES

- Cutting all informational traffic without checking its remarketing or assisted-conversion value first

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This classification becomes the backbone for Category 4 (message-market fit) — informational-stage traffic needs education-first ad copy, transactional traffic needs offer-first ad copy.

---

21 Query-to-Keyword Mapping

OBJECTIVE

Verify that the keyword actually triggering each high-spend search term is the most relevant, tightest match available — not an accidental broad catch.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, for the top 20-30 search terms by spend.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term report with triggering keyword and match type

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report including 'Keyword' and 'Match type' columns

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the search term report with the triggering keyword and match type shown per term.
2. Filter to the top search terms by spend.
3. Ask Claude to check whether each term is being matched by the most relevant available keyword or by a looser, less relevant one.
4. Recommend adding a tighter exact-match keyword where a mismatch is found.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *For each of the top 20-30 search terms by spend in the attached report, check which keyword and match type actually triggered the ad. Determine whether that's the tightest, most relevant match available given our full keyword list, or whether the term is being caught by a looser broad/phrase match keyword when a more specific exact-match keyword either already exists elsewhere in the account or should be created. Flag every case where a high-spend term is relying on a loose match when a tighter one is available or warranted — this matters because the triggering keyword's Quality Score and ad relevance settings apply, not the search term's. List the fix per flagged term: point to existing tighter keyword, or create new exact-match keyword.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A table of high-spend search terms with their current triggering keyword/match type and a specific tightening recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This is a Quality Score lever as much as a relevance lever — the wrong triggering keyword can mean the ad and landing page shown were optimized for a different query than the one the user typed.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add tighter exact-match keywords for every flagged high-spend term

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation checks the account's full keyword list, not just the current ad group, before proposing a new keyword

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming the keyword shown as 'triggering' in campaign settings is automatically the best available match without checking alternatives

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is a quieter, more surgical version of Skill 17 — it's about matching precision on already-important terms, not discovery of new ones.

---

22 Keyword Cannibalization Check

OBJECTIVE

Detect keywords across different ad groups or campaigns that are competing against each other in the same auction.

WHEN TO USE IT

When a campaign restructure is planned, or when CPCs seem higher than expected for the competitive landscape.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Full keyword list with ad group/campaign mapping

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Keyword list export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the full keyword list across all campaigns.
2. Ask Claude to find identical or near-identical keywords (including different match types) appearing in more than one ad group or campaign.
3. For each instance, determine whether the duplication is intentional (different geo, different bid strategy) or accidental.
4. Recommend consolidation or explicit exclusion rules to stop self-competition.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Scan the attached keyword list across all campaigns and ad groups for duplicate or near-duplicate keywords (same root term, potentially different match types) that could be competing against each other in the same auction. For each instance found, state which campaigns/ad groups are involved and ask: is there a clear intentional reason for the duplication (e.g., separate geographic campaigns, a deliberate brand-defense campaign, different Shopping vs. Search treatment), or does it look accidental? For accidental duplication, recommend either consolidating into one ad group or adding campaign-level negatives to force each keyword to serve from only one place. Quantify the likely CPC inflation from self-competition where you can estimate it from the data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A table of duplicate/overlapping keywords with an intentional-vs-accidental judgment and a fix recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Self-competition doesn't just waste money — it also fragments the conversion data Smart Bidding needs, making both duplicated instances less efficient than one consolidated one would be.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix accidental duplications first via campaign-level negatives or consolidation
- Document any intentional duplication in 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md so future audits don't re-flag it

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every 'accidental' judgment is checked against known intentional structures (geo split, brand defense) before recommending a change

COMMON MISTAKES

- Consolidating a deliberately duplicated brand-defense keyword structure that exists for a real competitive reason

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Performance Max is a common source of hidden cannibalization against Search brand campaigns — always check PMax search category insights against brand Search performance when running this Skill.

---

23 Brand Traffic Leakage Detection

OBJECTIVE

Identify where competitors or affiliates are bidding on your brand terms, and where your own non-brand campaigns are wastefully bidding on your brand terms.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, or immediately if brand CPC rises unexpectedly.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Auction insights for brand campaigns
- Search term report

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Auction insights export (brand campaign)
- Search term report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export auction insights for brand campaigns to see which competitors are appearing.
2. Export the search term report to check for brand-term matches inside non-brand campaigns.
3. Ask Claude to quantify both forms of leakage and prioritize a response.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached brand campaign auction insights and search term report. Identify: (1) which competitors or third parties are showing impression share on our brand terms, and whether that share has grown recently; (2) any instance of our own non-brand campaigns bidding on and spending against our own brand terms, which wastes budget we'd likely capture anyway at a much lower defensive-only cost. For competitor bidding on brand terms, recommend whether it justifies a trademark complaint, a defensive bid increase, or no action (some competitor presence on brand terms is normal and not worth fighting). For internal leakage, recommend the specific negative keyword fix. Quantify the estimated monthly cost of each issue found.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A two-part leakage report (external competitor presence, internal brand-term leakage) with quantified cost and a recommended response per issue.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Not all competitor presence on brand terms warrants action — a persistent, growing share from one specific competitor is a different situation than sporadic, low-share appearances from many.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix internal leakage immediately via negatives — it's pure waste with no upside
- Escalate persistent competitor brand-bidding through Google's trademark complaint process if policy-eligible

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Distinguish competitor bidding (external) from misconfigured internal campaigns (internal) clearly — they require different fixes

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reacting to every competitor appearing in auction insights instead of tracking the trend over time

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Internal brand leakage is the easier, cheaper fix and should always be checked first — it's within your control and has zero legal or competitive complexity.

---

24 Competitor Keyword Analysis

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether bidding on competitor brand terms is worth the cost, using this account's own conversion data rather than assumption.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before starting or continuing a competitor-conquesting campaign, or during a quarterly non-brand review.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Performance of existing competitor-term campaigns (if running)
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Competitor campaign performance CSV (if applicable)
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export performance for any existing competitor-conquesting campaigns.
2. Ask Claude to evaluate their CPA/ROAS against break-even, separately from the rest of non-brand.
3. If no competitor campaign exists yet, ask Claude to assess readiness based on differentiation strength in 07-COMPETITORS.md.
4. Recommend continue, adjust, pause, or don't launch.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Evaluate our competitor-brand-term campaign performance in isolation — do not blend it with general non-brand numbers. Using the attached performance data and our break-even CPA from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md, tell me whether this specific campaign is profitable on its own, and how its CPA/CVR compares to our non-brand and brand campaigns as reference points (competitor-term traffic typically converts lower than brand but higher than generic non-brand — flag if this account's numbers don't fit that pattern and consider why). If we're not currently running competitor terms, assess based on our stated differentiation in 07-COMPETITORS.md whether we have a clear enough advantage to make the pitch land on a competitor's own audience, or whether launching would likely just generate expensive, unconvinced clicks. Give a clear continue/adjust/pause/don't-launch recommendation with the reasoning stated.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A standalone profitability assessment of competitor-term activity with a clear recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Competitor-term campaigns should be judged on their own break-even math, never blended into overall non-brand ROAS where they can hide.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- If continuing, ensure ad copy explicitly names the differentiation angle rather than generic messaging
- Review policy compliance for any competitor name usage in ad copy

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation is based on this account's own CPA/CVR data, not a generic industry assumption

COMMON MISTAKES

- Running competitor campaigns indefinitely without ever isolating their standalone economics

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Competitor-term traffic needs its own landing page making the comparison explicit — sending it to a generic homepage is one of the most common reasons these campaigns underperform even when the keyword idea is sound.

---

25 Long-Tail Opportunity Discovery

OBJECTIVE

Surface low-competition, high-relevance long-tail query patterns that are cheap to win but easy to miss without close search term review.

WHEN TO USE IT

When CPCs on head terms are rising and budget efficiency is under pressure.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term report
- Keyword list

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report
- Keyword list export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the search term report over a longer window (60-90 days) to catch lower-frequency terms.
2. Ask Claude to find recurring 4+ word query patterns with decent conversion signal and low current bid competition.
3. Cluster related long-tail terms into themes.
4. Recommend which clusters are worth dedicated ad groups.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached 60-90 day search term report for long-tail query patterns — specific, longer (typically 4+ word) queries that show a conversion signal, even a small one, and are not already well-represented as dedicated keywords. Cluster related long-tail terms into themes rather than listing them individually. For each theme, estimate the combined monthly volume and conversion signal, and note that long-tail CPCs are usually meaningfully lower than head-term CPCs for the same product — flag if that pattern holds in our data. Recommend which theme clusters have enough combined volume to justify a dedicated ad group with tailored ad copy, versus which are worth capturing passively through existing broader match keywords.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A clustered list of long-tail opportunity themes with volume/conversion estimates and a dedicated-ad-group recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Long-tail value comes from CPC efficiency more than raw volume — a cluster with modest volume but a sizeable CPC discount can still be worth a dedicated push.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Build dedicated ad groups for the top 2-3 clusters by combined value
- Write ad copy specific to the long-tail intent rather than reusing head-term ads

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Clustering groups genuinely related queries, not just superficially similar strings

COMMON MISTAKES

- Creating one ad group per individual long-tail term instead of clustering, leading straight back into the over-fragmentation problem from Skill 3

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Long-tail discovery pairs naturally with Category 3 (product titles) for ecommerce accounts — long-tail queries often mirror the exact attribute language (color, size, model, use case) that should appear in product titles.

---

26 Search Term Trend Analysis

OBJECTIVE

Detect emerging or declining search term patterns early, before they show up as a major shift in account-level performance.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, to catch seasonality shifts, new competitor entrants, or changing customer language before they become a problem or a missed opportunity.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term report for the current period

- Search term report for the same period last year or last quarter

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Two search term report exports for comparison periods

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export search term reports for two comparable periods.
2. Ask Claude to identify terms/themes with the largest volume increase and decrease between periods.
3. Separate genuine trend shifts from normal noise.
4. Recommend action for meaningful emerging or declining themes.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Compare the two attached search term reports (current period vs. comparison period). Identify search term themes — not individual low-volume terms, which are noisy — with the largest genuine increase or decrease in volume and spend between the two periods. For rising themes, assess whether this looks like a seasonal pattern, a new customer language trend (e.g., a new use case or feature people are searching for), or a competitor/market shift, and recommend whether to lean into it with dedicated keywords and ad copy. For declining themes, assess whether it's seasonal (expected to return) or a genuine demand drop (worth reallocating budget away from). Rank findings by the size of the volume/spend shift.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked list of rising and declining search term themes with a seasonal-vs-structural judgment and a recommended action per theme.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The value here is catching shifts 4-6 weeks before they'd otherwise show up as an unexplained account-level performance change.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Build out keyword/ad copy support for confirmed rising themes
- Reduce budget allocation ahead of confirmed structural declines rather than reacting after the fact

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Comparison periods are genuinely comparable (same length, adjusted for known seasonality)

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reacting to a single month's noise as if it were a durable trend

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is most valuable run alongside a company's own product roadmap and marketing calendar — a rising search theme often correlates with a launch, a press mention, or a competitor's move worth knowing about independently.

---

27 Keyword Portfolio Pruning

OBJECTIVE

Periodically clean the keyword list of paused, redundant, or chronically zero-impression keywords that add clutter without adding performance.

WHEN TO USE IT

Quarterly, as account hygiene maintenance.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Full keyword list with status and impression history

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Keyword list export with 90-day impression/click/conversion history

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the full keyword list with recent impression history.
2. Ask Claude to flag keywords with near-zero impressions over 90 days (Quality Score or bid too low to compete), long-paused keywords, and redundant near-duplicates.
3. Recommend removal, bid increase (for genuinely relevant but under-competing terms), or keep-as-is with a stated reason.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached keyword list with 90-day impression history. Flag three categories: (1) keywords with near-zero impressions despite being active and relevant — likely losing every auction on bid or Quality Score, worth either a bid increase or removal if low-priority; (2) keywords paused for an extended period with no plan to reactivate — candidates for outright deletion to reduce clutter; (3) redundant near-duplicate keywords already covered by Skill 22's cannibalization logic. For category (1), recommend bid increase only for keywords tied to genuinely important themes per 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md — otherwise recommend removal. Output a clean, portfolio-wide pruning list with a reason per keyword.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A pruning list (Keyword / Category / Recommendation / Reason) covering dormant, redundant, and non-competing keywords.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A pruned portfolio isn't just tidier — it makes every subsequent audit (search term review, cannibalization checks) faster and more accurate.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Delete or pause flagged dormant keywords in a single batch
- Revisit bid strategy for flagged low-impression, high-importance keywords

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No keyword tied to a core product/offer gets removed without a bid-increase option considered first

COMMON MISTAKES

- Deleting low-impression keywords for a genuinely important seasonal product right before its season starts

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is maintenance, not strategy — keep it quarterly and lightweight. If it's surfacing major findings every time, something upstream (Skill 1, Skill 14) needs deeper attention instead.

CATEGORY 3

Shopping Feed and Product Titles

For ecommerce accounts, the product feed is the real ad copy. Google matches search queries to your Merchant Center feed before a Shopping or Performance Max ad ever shows — which means a mediocre title or a missing attribute silently costs you impressions you never even see in a report. This category treats the feed as a live, optimizable asset rather than a one-time upload, and connects feed quality directly to the search query relevance, CTR, and conversion rate it drives downstream.

---

28 Merchant Center Feed Audit

OBJECTIVE

Identify structural feed problems — missing fields, disapprovals, warnings — that are actively suppressing product visibility.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, or immediately if Shopping impressions drop unexpectedly.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Merchant Center diagnostics export
- Product feed file

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Merchant Center diagnostics report
- Feed export (CSV/XML)

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export Merchant Center diagnostics (disapprovals, warnings, item-level issues).
2. Export the current product feed.
3. Ask Claude to categorize issues by severity and estimate the number of products/revenue affected.
4. Prioritize fixes by products impacted, not issue count.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached Merchant Center diagnostics and product feed. Categorize every issue into: DISAPPROVED (product not showing at all), WARNING (showing but with reduced performance risk), and INFORMATIONAL. For each category, group issues by root cause (e.g., missing GTIN, image policy violation, price mismatch with landing page, missing required attribute) rather than listing every affected SKU individually. Estimate how many products and what share of typical revenue (if performance data is available) each root cause affects. Prioritize the fix list by revenue impact, not by how many issues exist — one disapproval on a bestseller matters more than fifty warnings on long-tail products. Give a specific fix instruction per root cause, not just a description of the problem.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A severity-ranked list of feed issues by root cause, with estimated products/revenue affected and a specific fix per issue.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Disapprovals are silent revenue loss — a disapproved bestseller generates zero Shopping impressions with no error visible in campaign reporting, only in Merchant Center.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix all disapprovals on top-tier products (see Skill 7 tiering) within 48 hours
- Schedule a recurring monthly diagnostics check going forward

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Root-cause grouping is accurate — spot-check a few individual SKUs against the stated cause

COMMON MISTAKES

- Only checking Merchant Center reactively after a performance drop instead of proactively on a schedule

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Disapprovals are one of the few Google Ads problems that can silently erase 100% of a product's visibility while every other metric in the campaign UI looks completely normal.

---

29 Product Title Optimization

OBJECTIVE

Rewrite product titles to front-load the attributes and language that match how customers actually search, based on real query data.

WHEN TO USE IT

When Shopping CTR is weak for products with otherwise reasonable images and pricing, or during a feed refresh cycle.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current product titles
- Search term report for Shopping
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md attributes

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Product feed titles
- Shopping search term report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export current product titles alongside their Shopping search term report.
2. Ask Claude to identify the gap between title language and actual query language.
3. Rewrite titles following a structure: brand + key attribute + product type + secondary attributes, prioritizing the words that match real queries.
4. Flag any title exceeding Google's effective display length.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached product titles alongside the Shopping search term report for those same products. For each product, identify which words in the actual customer search queries are missing or buried at the end of the current title — Google weighs the beginning of the title most heavily for matching and the visible portion is roughly the first 70 characters on most surfaces. Rewrite each title using this priority order: brand (if search-relevant), the single most important distinguishing attribute (e.g., material, size, model), core product type, then secondary attributes (color, use case). Do not invent attributes not present in our data — pull only from the product data provided. Keep titles under 150 characters total, with the most important information within the first 70. Output a before/after table with the specific query evidence that justifies each change.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A before/after title table with query-evidence justification for each rewrite.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Title changes typically take 1-2 weeks to fully reflect in matching and CTR — don't judge results before then.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- A/B test rewritten titles on a sample of 20-30 products before rolling out feed-wide
- Track CTR change per product for 2 weeks post-change

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No fabricated attributes — every word in a rewritten title traces to real product data
- [ ] Character limits respected

COMMON MISTAKES

- Keyword-stuffing titles with irrelevant terms in an attempt to match more queries — this typically hurts CTR by making titles less clear, not more

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Title optimization has a compounding effect with custom labels (Skill 33) — once titles are fixed, segmenting by performance becomes much easier to interpret because you're no longer also debugging title-driven mismatch.

---

30 Product Description Optimization

OBJECTIVE

Improve product description fields to support relevance matching and give Performance Max more useful signal, without duplicating title content wastefully.

WHEN TO USE IT

Alongside a title optimization pass, or when PMax category insights show mismatched query matching.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current product descriptions
- Product attributes and use cases

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Product feed descriptions
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export current product descriptions.
2. Ask Claude to check for generic, templated, or missing descriptions.
3. Rewrite to include specific use cases, materials, and differentiators not already covered in the title.
4. Ensure descriptions remain factual and free of unverifiable marketing claims.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached product descriptions. Flag any that are missing, generic boilerplate (identical or near-identical across many products), or purely promotional with no factual product detail. Rewrite flagged descriptions to include specific, factual detail not already present in the title: materials, dimensions, use cases, what makes this SKU different from adjacent SKUs in the same line, and any detail a real customer search might include (compatibility, occasion, intended user). Do not repeat the title verbatim in the description — describe additional information. Do not invent specifications, certifications, or claims not present in the source data. Flag any product where you don't have enough source information to write a genuinely useful description, rather than filling the gap with generic language.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Rewritten descriptions for flagged products, plus a list of products lacking enough source data to write a good one.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Descriptions matter more for Performance Max relevance matching than for Shopping CTR directly, since they're rarely visible to the shopper but are read by the matching system.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Prioritize rewriting descriptions for tier-1 products first (see Skill 7)
- Request missing source data from the product team for flagged gaps

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No invented specifications or unverifiable claims

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing purely promotional copy ('the best on the market!') instead of factual differentiators the matching system and the customer can both use

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Treat description quality as feed hygiene that compounds with PMax structure work (Skill 6) — a well-described catalog gives the algorithm far more to work with than audience signals alone.

---

31 Product Type Taxonomy Review

OBJECTIVE

Verify the custom product_type field forms a clean, logical hierarchy that supports campaign segmentation and reporting.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before a Shopping campaign restructure, or when product-level reporting feels inconsistent.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current product_type values across the feed
- Business's actual category structure

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Product feed with product_type field
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export all unique product_type values currently in use.

2. Compare against the business's real category structure.
3. Ask Claude to identify inconsistent depth, naming, or missing categorization.
4. Propose a clean taxonomy and a mapping from old to new values.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached list of unique product_type values in our feed against our actual business category structure. Identify inconsistencies: categories with inconsistent depth (some products categorized to 3 levels, others to 1), inconsistent naming for the same real category, or products with no meaningful categorization at all. Propose a clean, consistent taxonomy — using a '>' hierarchy separator — that matches how the business actually organizes its catalog, and provide an old-value-to-new-value mapping table so the change can be implemented in the feed. Keep the taxonomy only as deep as is useful for campaign segmentation and reporting — don't add depth for its own sake.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A clean proposed product_type taxonomy with an old-to-new mapping table.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A clean taxonomy is what makes Shopping campaign priority tiers (Skill 7) and listing group segmentation actually usable — messy product_type values undermine both.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Update the feed source (not just Google Ads listing groups) so the fix is durable
- Rebuild Shopping listing groups after the feed update propagates

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] New taxonomy maps 1:1 back to a real, current business category, not an aspirational one

COMMON MISTAKES

- Building an elaborate taxonomy that doesn't match how the catalog team will actually maintain product data going forward

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is foundational, low-glamour work, but nearly every downstream Shopping and PMax segmentation Skill in this guide assumes a clean product_type — it's worth doing early.

---

32 Google Product Category Review

OBJECTIVE

Confirm each product is mapped to the most specific, accurate Google Product Category (GPC) available, since it directly affects Shopping ranking and Smart Bidding benchmarks.

WHEN TO USE IT

During a feed audit, or when a product category seems to be getting outcompeted despite reasonable pricing.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current GPC assignments
- Google's product taxonomy

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Product feed with google_product_category field

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export current GPC assignments across the feed.
2. Ask Claude to flag products using an overly broad or generic GPC when a more specific one exists.
3. Recommend the correct specific GPC per flagged product.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached Google Product Category assignments. For each product, assess whether it's mapped to the most specific applicable category in Google's official product taxonomy, or a broader/generic one. Flag products using an overly generic category when a clearly more specific one exists for that product type. Recommend the correct, most specific category for each flagged product. Note that using an incorrect but adjacent category (rather than just too-broad) can actively hurt relevance matching and should be flagged with higher priority than mere over-breadth.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A table of products with incorrect or overly broad GPC assignments and the recommended specific replacement.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

GPC affects which Smart Bidding benchmark data Google uses and how tightly your product competes in category-specific auctions — it's a quiet but real lever.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix incorrect (not just broad) categories first, then broaden the pass to under-specified ones

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommended categories are verified against the actual current Google taxonomy, not an outdated version

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming GPC accuracy doesn't matter because it's not customer-visible — it directly affects auction eligibility and benchmarking

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

GPC and product_type (Skill 31) serve different purposes — GPC is Google's standardized taxonomy for auction/benchmark purposes, product_type is your own business taxonomy for campaign structure. Both need to be right independently.

---

33 Custom Label Strategy

OBJECTIVE

Design a custom label (0-4) strategy that captures the segmentation dimensions actually needed for campaign structure and bidding — margin, seasonality, bestseller status, inventory.

WHEN TO USE IT

When setting up or revisiting Shopping/PMax segmentation, especially after the product tiering exercise in Skill 7.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current custom label usage (if any)
- Margin, seasonality, and bestseller data

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Product feed

- Margin/inventory data from 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Review current custom label usage, if any.
2. Ask Claude to design a 5-label schema (custom_label_0 through 4) covering the highest-value segmentation dimensions.
3. Map real product data into each label value.
4. Recommend how each label will be used in campaign/listing group structure.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Design a custom label strategy for our Shopping feed using the five available slots (custom_label_0 through custom_label_4). Base the schema on our actual margin, seasonality, and bestseller data, attached. Recommend one clear segmentation dimension per label — for example: label_0 = margin tier (from Skill 7's tiering), label_1 = bestseller status, label_2 = seasonality (evergreen/seasonal + which season), label_3 = inventory/clearance status, label_4 reserved for a testing dimension we can repurpose campaign by campaign. For each label, specify the exact value set (e.g., label_0: high/medium/low/liability) and how it should be populated from existing product data. Explain how this schema would be used to build listing groups in Shopping/PMax campaigns.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A five-label schema with value sets, population logic, and a listing-group usage explanation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Custom labels are the primary lever for segmenting Shopping/PMax by anything other than product_type or brand — they're worth designing deliberately, not filling ad hoc.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Populate labels in the feed source system, not manually in Google Ads
- Rebuild listing groups using the new labels once populated

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every label maps to real, maintainable source data — a label nobody updates becomes stale and misleading within a quarter

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using custom labels for a one-time campaign need without documenting them, so a future audit can't tell what they mean

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Document the finalized label schema in 02-GOOGLE-ADS-ACCOUNT-CONTEXT.md — undocumented custom labels are one of the most common sources of confusion when an account changes hands.

---

34 Low-Margin Product Exclusion Review

OBJECTIVE

Confirm which specific products from the tier-4 liability list (Skill 7) genuinely warrant exclusion from paid traffic versus a pricing or bidding fix.

WHEN TO USE IT

After Skill 7 tiering identifies liability products, before excluding anything.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Tier-4 liability product list from Skill 7
- Product-level margin and ad spend

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 7 output
- Product-level performance and margin data

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Take the tier-4 list from the Shopping structure review.
2. Ask Claude to separate products that are unprofitable due to ad spend inefficiency (fixable) from those unprofitable at any efficient spend level given current pricing/margin (structural).
3. Recommend exclusion only for the structural cases.
4. Flag fixable cases for a bidding or pricing conversation instead.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using the attached tier-4 liability product list and product-level margin/spend data, determine for each product whether its unprofitability is: (a) FIXABLE — the product has adequate margin in principle, but current CPC/CVR performance is inefficient, meaning a bid or targeting fix could bring it to break-even; or (b) STRUCTURAL — even at the account's best achievable CPC for this category, the margin is too thin or negative to ever break even in paid search. Recommend exclusion from Shopping/PMax only for structural cases. For fixable cases, state specifically what would need to improve (CPC needs to drop by X%, or CVR needs to rise by Y%) and route to the appropriate bidding or landing page Skill instead of excluding.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structural-vs-fixable classification of every tier-4 product with a specific improvement target for fixable ones.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Exclusion should be the last resort, not the first response to a flagged low-margin product — excluding a fixable product just hides the underlying problem rather than solving it.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Exclude only confirmed structural cases from paid campaigns
- Route fixable cases into bidding review (Category 6) with a specific target

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every structural classification shows the break-even math, not just an assertion

COMMON MISTAKES

- Excluding a product from paid because it's currently unprofitable without checking whether a realistic CPC/CVR improvement would fix it

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Structural exclusions are also worth flagging to the business side — a product that can never be profitable in paid search at current pricing may be a pricing problem worth solving beyond the ads account.

---

35 Feed Gap Detection

OBJECTIVE

Find products in the catalog that are missing from the Google Ads feed entirely, or present but with incomplete required data preventing them from serving.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, or after any product catalog sync/update.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Full product catalog (source of truth)
- Current Merchant Center feed

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Product catalog export
- Merchant Center feed export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the full product catalog from the source system.
2. Export the current Merchant Center feed.
3. Ask Claude to identify catalog products missing from the feed entirely, and feed products missing required fields.
4. Prioritize gaps by the product's sales/traffic potential.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Compare the attached full product catalog against the current Merchant Center feed. Identify: (1) active, sellable products present in the catalog but entirely absent from the feed — these are generating zero Shopping/PMax visibility; (2) products present in the feed but missing required fields (price, availability, GTIN, image) that would prevent them from serving. For each gap, note the product and, if available, its recent sales/traffic performance on other channels as a proxy for its potential Shopping value, so gaps can be prioritized by opportunity size rather than treated equally.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A prioritized list of missing/incomplete products with an opportunity-size estimate where data allows.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A feed gap on a genuinely popular product is pure missed revenue — it's often the single highest-ROI fix available in the whole feed audit.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix the highest-opportunity gaps first, ideally via the automated feed sync rather than manual patching

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Comparison uses the true source-of-truth catalog, not a stale export

COMMON MISTAKES

- Only reviewing the feed in isolation without ever comparing it back to the full catalog, missing complete absences entirely

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is one of the few Skills that requires a second data source beyond Google Ads/Merchant Center — insist on the real catalog export, since 'everything active is in the feed' is often assumed rather than verified.

36 Search-Query-to-Product Mapping

OBJECTIVE

Verify that Shopping search terms are matching to the right specific product, not a loosely related one, which affects both relevance and conversion rate.

WHEN TO USE IT

When Shopping CVR is weaker than expected for products with strong titles and pricing.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Shopping search term report with matched product
- Product catalog

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Shopping search term report (product-level)
- Product feed

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the Shopping search term report showing which product each query matched to.
2. Ask Claude to identify queries matching to a product that isn't the best available option in the catalog for that query.
3. Recommend title/attribute changes to correct the mismatch.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached Shopping search term report, which shows the specific product each query matched to. For high-spend queries, check whether the matched product is genuinely the best match available in our catalog (attached), or whether a more relevant product exists that should be winning that query instead. Where a mismatch is found, diagnose the likely cause — usually a title/attribute gap in the correct product's feed data — and recommend the specific fix. Flag any pattern where an entire category of queries is consistently matching to the wrong tier of product (e.g., budget queries matching to premium SKUs or vice versa), since that suggests a systemic feed issue rather than an isolated one.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A list of query-to-product mismatches with a diagnosed cause and specific feed fix per case.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Systemic mismatches (whole categories, not isolated SKUs) point to a taxonomy or title-language problem worth fixing at the pattern level rather than product by product.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix isolated mismatches via targeted title edits
- Escalate systemic mismatches to the title optimization (Skill 29) or taxonomy (Skill 31) Skills

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Mismatch judgment considers price tier and use case, not just superficial keyword overlap

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating every match as correct simply because it technically relates to the query, without checking if it's the best available match

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is the Shopping-feed equivalent of Skill 21's keyword-to-query mapping — same underlying question, different mechanism (feed attributes instead of keyword match type).

---

37 Product Title A/B Test Design

OBJECTIVE

Turn title optimization hypotheses into a structured, measurable test rather than a blanket rewrite with no way to isolate what worked.

WHEN TO USE IT

After Skill 29 generates rewrite recommendations, before rolling them out account-wide.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Rewritten title candidates from Skill 29
- Current baseline performance per product

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 29 output
- Current product-level Shopping performance

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Take the rewritten title candidates.
2. Ask Claude to select a representative test sample with enough baseline volume to detect a meaningful CTR/CVR change.
3. Define the test duration and the specific metrics to track.
4. Set a decision rule for rolling out, reverting, or extending the test.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Design an A/B test to validate our new product title recommendations before rolling them out account-wide. From the attached list of rewritten titles and current baseline performance, select a sample of 20-30 products with enough baseline impression/click volume to realistically detect a CTR change within 2-3 weeks. Define: the test duration, the primary metric (CTR) and secondary metric (CVR, since title changes can shift traffic quality as well as volume), and a clear decision rule — e.g., 'roll out broadly if CTR improves by at least X% with no CVR decline; revert if CTR is flat or CVR drops by more than Y%; extend the test if results are inconclusive at the halfway point.' Flag any risk of the test being confounded by seasonality or a concurrent promotion.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structured test plan: sample selection, duration, metrics, and a pre-committed decision rule.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Committing to the decision rule before seeing results is what prevents post-hoc rationalization of a change that didn't actually work.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Log the test in 10-TESTING-LOG.md before launch
- Apply the decision rule mechanically at the review checkpoint, not selectively

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Sample size is large enough to plausibly detect the hypothesized effect, not just a token handful of products

COMMON MISTAKES

- Changing other feed attributes at the same time as the title test, making it impossible to attribute results

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Shopping title tests are inherently noisier than Search ad copy tests because Google's matching also shifts — expect to need a longer window and a larger sample than a typical RSA test.

---

38 Performance Max Product Grouping

OBJECTIVE

Design listing group segmentation within Performance Max asset groups so budget and bidding can differentiate between product tiers, not treat the whole catalog uniformly.

WHEN TO USE IT

When setting up or revisiting PMax asset groups for a Shopping-heavy account.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Product tier data from Skill 7
- Custom label schema from Skill 33
- Current PMax listing group structure

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 7 output
- Skill 33 output
- Current PMax asset group/listing group export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Combine the product tiering and custom label outputs.
2. Ask Claude to propose a listing group structure within PMax asset groups that separates tiers.
3. Recommend whether tiers need separate asset groups (for different creative/audience signals) or just separate listing groups within one.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using our product tiering (attached, from the Shopping structure review) and custom label schema (attached), design a Performance Max listing group structure that lets us control budget and bidding differently by product tier. Recommend, for each tier, whether it needs its own dedicated asset group (justified if the tier also needs different creative assets or audience signals) or can simply be a separate listing group within a shared asset group (sufficient if creative/audience needs are the same and only bid/budget differentiation is needed). Provide the specific listing group hierarchy (e.g., filter by custom_label_0) ready to implement, and note any tier too small in volume to warrant its own group per the complexity threshold from Skill 3.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A recommended PMax listing group hierarchy with an asset-group-split judgment per tier.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Splitting into a new asset group is a bigger structural decision than a listing group split — reserve it for cases with a genuine creative or audience difference.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Implement listing group segmentation before adding new audience signals
- Monitor tier-level performance separately post-launch

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every recommended split ties back to a real business reason (margin, creative need), not segmentation for its own sake

COMMON MISTAKES

- Creating a separate asset group per tier by default, fragmenting PMax's learning data unnecessarily (see Skill 3's volume threshold logic)

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill sits at the intersection of Category 1 (Skill 6) and Category 3 — treat feed segmentation and PMax structure as one connected decision, not two separate audits.

---

39 Zombie Product Detection

OBJECTIVE

Find products that are technically active and eligible in the feed but generating no meaningful impressions, and diagnose why.

WHEN TO USE IT

Quarterly, as feed hygiene maintenance.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Product-level impression data over 60-90 days
- Feed status per product

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Shopping product performance report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export product-level impressions over 60-90 days.
2. Ask Claude to flag products with near-zero impressions despite active, approved status.
3. Diagnose likely cause per flagged product: low search demand, price non-competitiveness, weak title, or bid/priority too low.
4. Recommend a fix or a conscious decision to deprioritize.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached 60-90 day product-level Shopping impression data. Flag products that are active and approved in the feed but generating near-zero impressions — these are 'zombie' products taking up feed space without competing in any auctions. For each, diagnose the most likely cause: genuinely low search demand for this exact SKU (check against similar products' performance as a benchmark), price positioned well above competitive market rate, a weak or generic title suppressing matching, or Shopping campaign priority/bid set too low relative to the product's category competitiveness. Recommend a specific fix per likely cause, or a conscious 'accept low visibility' decision if the product is genuinely low-demand and not worth further investment.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A zombie product list with a diagnosed likely cause and fix recommendation per product.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Not every zombie product needs to be revived — some genuinely have low demand, and the right outcome is simply confirming that and moving on.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix title/pricing issues for zombie products tied to important categories
- Accept low visibility consciously for genuinely low-demand long-tail SKUs

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Diagnosis is checked against comparable products, not asserted in isolation

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming every zero-impression product is a feed error when it may simply reflect real low demand

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Run this alongside Skill 28 (disapprovals) — a product can be 'zombie' either because Merchant Center is silently suppressing it or because it's genuinely non-competitive, and the fix is completely different depending on which.

---

40 Feed Prioritization Framework

OBJECTIVE

Turn all feed-related findings (titles, descriptions, taxonomy, gaps, disapprovals) into a single sequenced action plan ranked by revenue impact.

WHEN TO USE IT

After running multiple Skills in this category, to avoid tackling feed work in a scattered, low-impact order.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Outputs from Skills 28-39 relevant to this account
- Product tiering from Skill 7

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- All prior Category 3 Skill outputs run for this account
- Skill 7 tiering

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather findings from every feed-related Skill run so far.

2. Ask Claude to weight each finding by the tier of products it affects (tier 1 first) and the estimated revenue at stake.
3. Sequence into a prioritized, resourced action plan.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *I'm attaching findings from our Merchant Center audit, title optimization, description review, taxonomy review, and gap detection work. Synthesize these into one prioritized feed action plan. Weight each finding by two factors: which product tier it affects (tier-1 bestsellers first, per our tiering) and the estimated revenue or visibility at stake. Sequence the plan so that fixes affecting the most valuable products, with the clearest expected impact, come first — even if a lower-impact fix would be technically easier to implement. Output a single ranked action list (Action / Products Affected / Tier / Estimated Impact / Effort) that could be handed directly to whoever owns the feed.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

One consolidated, ranked feed action plan combining all prior findings.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Feed work competes for the same engineering/catalog-team time as everything else in the business — a single prioritized list is far more likely to get resourced than five separate audit reports.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Present the top 5 items to whoever owns the feed pipeline as this month's priority
- Re-run this synthesis quarterly as new Category 3 findings accumulate

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Ranking genuinely reflects revenue impact, not just the order findings happened to be discovered in

COMMON MISTAKES

- Handing over every individual audit separately, leaving prioritization to whoever implements it

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill mirrors Skill 14's role for Category 1 — every category with multiple diagnostic Skills benefits from one closing synthesis Skill that forces prioritization before action.

CATEGORY 4

Ad Copy and Creative Angles

Ad copy work usually starts in the wrong place: writing new headlines before understanding why the existing ones are underperforming. This category insists on diagnosis first — is the problem relevance, offer clarity, fatigue, or a missing objection-handling angle — before generating a single new line. Every Skill here produces copy grounded in real search intent and real brand voice, not generic persuasion templates.

---

41 Responsive Search Ad Diagnostic

OBJECTIVE

Assess whether existing RSAs are structurally sound — enough distinct headline angles, no pinning that undermines Google's combination testing, strong Ad Strength as a signal not a target.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before writing new copy, and quarterly as ad hygiene.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- RSA headline/description assets per ad group
- Ad Strength ratings
- Asset performance (best/good/low)

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- RSA asset-level performance export

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export all RSA headlines/descriptions with their per-asset performance rating.
2. Ask Claude to check for headline angle diversity versus redundant near-duplicate headlines.
3. Check pinning usage and whether it's unnecessarily restricting Google's combination testing.
4. Flag ad groups with structurally weak RSAs regardless of Ad Strength score.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Audit the attached RSA assets per ad group. For each ad group, check: (1) headline angle diversity — do the 10-15 headlines cover genuinely different angles (price, benefit, feature, urgency, social proof, brand, use case) or are many near-duplicates of each other; (2) pinning usage — is anything pinned to a specific position without a clear reason (legal requirement, brand mandate), unnecessarily limiting Google's combination testing; (3) the asset performance ratings (best/good/low/learning) — are there 'low' rated assets that have been left in for months dragging down the ad's overall serving. Flag ad groups with structural weaknesses regardless of what the Ad Strength label says, since Ad Strength rewards asset count and diversity more than actual persuasive quality. Recommend specific fixes per flagged ad group.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A per-ad-group structural diagnostic with specific fixes, independent of the Ad Strength label.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Treat Ad Strength as a checklist signal, not a quality signal — an ad can be 'Excellent' and still be persuasively weak, or 'Good' and be well-targeted and effective.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Remove long-standing 'low' rated assets
- Un-pin any headline without a real business reason to keep it fixed

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Diversity assessment checks actual angle content, not just headline count

COMMON MISTAKES

- Chasing an Ad Strength label improvement as the goal itself rather than as a byproduct of genuinely better copy

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This diagnostic should run before Skill 42 (headline generation) every time — writing new headlines into a structurally broken ad group (over-pinned, redundant) wastes the new copy's potential.

---

42 Headline Angle Generation

OBJECTIVE

Generate a full set of distinct, evidence-grounded headline angles for an ad group, mapped to specific search intents rather than generic persuasion.

WHEN TO USE IT

After Skill 41 flags weak angle diversity, or when launching a new ad group.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Search term/intent data for the ad group
- 06-BRAND-VOICE.md
- Product/offer specifics

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Search term report for the ad group
- 06-BRAND-VOICE.md
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Provide Claude with the ad group's search terms, brand voice guide, and product/offer specifics.
2. Ask for headlines mapped explicitly to distinct angles (benefit, feature, price, urgency, proof, use case).
3. Check every headline for brand voice fit and factual accuracy.
4. Finalize 12-15 headlines covering at least 5 distinct angles.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write Responsive Search Ad headlines for this ad group. Attached: the search terms this ad group is targeting, our brand voice guide, and the relevant product/offer details. Generate exactly 15 headlines (30 characters max each), covering at least 6 distinct angles: (1) direct benefit, (2) specific feature/attribute, (3) price/value framing [only if we compete on price — check the offer details], (4) urgency/timing [only if genuinely true — no fabricated scarcity], (5) social proof/credibility [only using real claims we can substantiate], (6) use-case/audience-specific framing that mirrors the actual search term language. Label each headline with its angle. Follow the brand voice guide's tone precisely — do not default to generic ad-speak ('Shop Now!', 'Limited Time Offer!') unless the brand voice guide specifically calls for that register. Flag any headline you're unsure is factually accurate given our data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

15 labeled headlines across at least 6 angles, flagged for any uncertain factual claims.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Angle diversity matters more than headline count — 15 headlines covering 2 angles is worse than 10 headlines covering 6.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Load into the RSA alongside 3-4 description lines built the same way (Skill 43)
- Pin only where legally or factually required

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No fabricated urgency, social proof numbers, or claims not backed by real data

COMMON MISTAKES

- Generating headlines that are stylistically varied but strategically redundant — five ways of saying the same benefit isn't angle diversity

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The search-term-mirroring angle (use-case-specific framing) is consistently the highest-CTR angle in most accounts because it echoes the user's own language back to them — never skip it.

---

43 Description Line Optimization

OBJECTIVE

Write RSA description lines that carry information headlines can't fit — specifics, objection handling, secondary CTAs — rather than restating headlines in longer form.

WHEN TO USE IT

Alongside Skill 42, or when descriptions are generic boilerplate reused across many ad groups.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Approved headlines from Skill 42
- Offer specifics
- Common objections from sales/support if available

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 42 output
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Provide Claude the finalized headlines to avoid redundancy.
2. Ask for 4 description lines (90 characters each) that add new information, not repetition.
3. Include one objection-handling line and one specific-detail line at minimum.
4. Check for redundancy against the headlines.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write 4 Responsive Search Ad description lines (90 characters max each) for this ad group, using the finalized headlines attached as context to avoid repeating them. Each description must add genuinely new information: one line addressing a likely objection a searcher at this intent stage would have (attached objection list if available, otherwise infer a plausible one from the offer and flag it as inferred), one line with a specific, concrete product/offer detail (not a vague benefit claim), and two lines covering any secondary value props not already used in headlines. Do not restate a headline's exact claim in longer sentence form — that wastes the description slot. Flag anything you're inferring rather than pulling from provided data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

4 non-redundant description lines with an objection-handling line clearly identified.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Descriptions are the most commonly wasted asset slot in RSAs — check whether current ones are adding real information before assuming new headlines alone will fix performance.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Load alongside Skill 42 headlines and re-run the Skill 41 diagnostic after launch

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No description is a restated headline

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing descriptions that sound different from headlines but convey the same single benefit, wasting the opportunity for real objection handling

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The objection-handling line is the one most accounts skip entirely — it's also usually the highest-leverage line for moving a hesitant, high-intent searcher to click.

---

44 Message-Market Fit Diagnostic

OBJECTIVE

Check whether current ad copy actually speaks to the intent stage and specific audience the ad group is targeting, based on real query and audience data.

WHEN TO USE IT

When CTR is acceptable but CVR is weak, suggesting the ad attracts clicks that aren't the right fit for the offer.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current ad copy
- Search term report
- Skill 20 intent classification if available

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Ad copy export
- Search term report
- Skill 20 output if available

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Compare current ad copy tone and content against the actual intent stage of the queries it's serving on.
2. Ask Claude to flag mismatches (e.g., transactional-stage copy serving on informational queries, or vice versa).
3. Recommend specific copy adjustments per mismatch.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached ad copy for this ad group alongside its actual search term report and, if available, the intent classification from our funnel-stage analysis. Assess whether the copy's tone and content match the intent stage of the queries it's actually serving on. Flag specific mismatches: transactional, offer-heavy copy showing on clearly informational/early-research queries (likely hurting CTR and wasting spend on clicks unlikely to convert this visit), or educational, soft-CTA copy showing on clearly ready-to-buy queries (likely under-converting relative to the traffic's real potential). For each mismatch, recommend the specific tonal or content shift needed, and note whether the fix belongs in this ad group's copy or whether the ad group itself needs to be split by intent first (cross-reference Skill 5).*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A message-market fit assessment with specific copy or structural recommendations.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A message-market mismatch often signals a structural problem (one ad group serving two intents) more than a pure copywriting problem — check that before rewriting.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Split the ad group by intent first if evidence supports it, then rewrite copy per intent stage

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Mismatch conclusions are grounded in actual search term evidence, not assumed from campaign name alone

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rewriting copy repeatedly without ever checking whether the underlying ad group is serving mixed intents that no single ad can satisfy well

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the ad-copy analog of Skill 20's funnel classification — always check funnel-stage alignment before diagnosing a copy problem as purely a writing-quality issue.

---

45 Competitive Differentiation Copy Audit

OBJECTIVE

Verify ad copy actually communicates what makes this business different from named competitors, rather than generic category claims any competitor could also make.

WHEN TO USE IT

When CTR is weak in a competitive auction (visible via auction insights), or during a quarterly copy refresh.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current ad copy
- 07-COMPETITORS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Ad copy export
- 07-COMPETITORS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Provide Claude the current ad copy and the competitor positioning file.
2. Ask Claude to identify which claims in current copy are generic (any competitor could say the same) versus genuinely differentiated.
3. Recommend copy revisions that lean into stated real differentiators.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached ad copy against our competitor positioning notes. For each headline and description, classify the claim as GENERIC (a competitor could plausibly make the identical claim — e.g., 'high quality', 'great service', 'trusted by thousands') or DIFFERENTIATED (specific to a real, stated advantage from our competitor positioning — a specific feature, guarantee, price structure, or capability competitors don't have). For ad groups dominated by generic claims, propose replacement copy built around our actual stated differentiators. Do not invent a differentiator not present in 07-COMPETITORS.md — if the account genuinely lacks a strong differentiator for a given product line, say so explicitly rather than manufacturing one, since we'd rather know that gap exists.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A generic-vs-differentiated audit of current copy with specific replacement recommendations, and an honest flag where no real differentiator exists.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A flagged 'no real differentiator' finding is itself valuable — it points to a positioning gap the business should address before more ad spend goes toward that product line.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Replace generic claims with substantiated differentiators first in the most competitive ad groups (highest auction overlap)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No fabricated differentiation claims

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing copy that sounds more specific without actually being more true — vague specificity ('engineered for performance') isn't real differentiation

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill and Skill 24 (competitor keyword analysis) work well together for any competitor-conquesting campaign — you need both the keyword targeting and the message to hold up.

---

46 Ad Fatigue Detection

OBJECTIVE

Identify ads whose performance is declining over time due to audience saturation, not a targeting or landing page issue, and flag them for refresh.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly for evergreen campaigns, or whenever CTR trends downward with no other explanation.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Ad-level performance trend over 60-90 days
- Ad launch/last-edit dates

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Ad performance CSV with weekly breakdown
- Ad creation/edit history

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export weekly ad-level performance for the last 60-90 days.
2. Ask Claude to identify ads with a sustained CTR decline that correlates with time-in-market rather than a seasonal or external factor.
3. Cross-check against audience size/frequency data if available.
4. Recommend refresh priority.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Analyze the attached weekly ad-level performance over the last 60-90 days. Identify ads showing a sustained CTR decline that correlates with how long the ad has been running, not with an external seasonal factor (check whether the decline is isolated to specific ads or affects the whole account equally, which would suggest a seasonal or market cause instead). For flagged fatigued ads, note the launch or last-edit date and how long they've been serving unchanged. Rank by combination of decline severity and spend volume, so the highest-cost fatigue gets addressed first. Distinguish fatigue (declining engagement from repeated exposure to the same audience) from simple underperformance from day one, which is a different problem requiring different Skills (Category 4's diagnostic Skills, not a refresh).*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked list of fatigued ads with time-in-market context and refresh priority.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Fatigue is a time-and-frequency phenomenon — a genuinely fatigued ad was performing well and has been declining; an ad that never performed well isn't fatigued, it's just weak.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Refresh headlines/creative for top-ranked fatigued ads via Skill 42
- Set a recurring refresh cadence for high-spend, always-on ad groups

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Decline pattern is isolated to specific ads/audiences, not explained by a broader account-wide or seasonal shift

COMMON MISTAKES

- Refreshing every ad on a fixed calendar schedule regardless of whether it's actually fatigued, which wastes creative effort on ads that didn't need it

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Fatigue detection matters even more for Performance Max and Display, where audience overlap and frequency are harder to see directly — treat a declining CTR trend with no other explanation as the primary signal.

47 Creative Fatigue Detection (Visual Assets)

OBJECTIVE

Identify image and video assets in Performance Max or Display whose engagement is declining due to visual fatigue, separate from copy fatigue.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly for PMax/Display-heavy accounts.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Asset-level performance for images/video within PMax or Display
- Asset launch dates

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- PMax/Display asset performance report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export asset-level performance (engagement rate, view-through rate for video) over time.
2. Ask Claude to identify visual assets with declining engagement correlated with time-in-market.
3. Distinguish from copy-driven decline where possible.
4. Recommend refresh priority.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached image and video asset-level performance within our Performance Max/Display campaigns over time. Identify visual assets showing declining engagement (CTR, view-through rate, or the platform's engagement rate metric) that correlates with how long the asset has been serving. Where possible, distinguish visual fatigue from copy-driven decline by checking whether assets sharing the same image but paired with different headlines show the same decline pattern (points to visual fatigue) or different patterns (points to copy). Rank flagged visual assets by decline severity and spend, and recommend which need new photography/video versus which could be refreshed with a new crop, format, or minor edit rather than a full reshoot.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked list of fatigued visual assets with a full-refresh vs. minor-edit recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Visual fatigue typically sets in faster than copy fatigue in high-frequency placements like Display and Video — expect shorter effective lifespans for image/video assets than for text.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Prioritize full refresh for high-spend, severely fatigued assets
- Request new creative production lead time based on this cadence, not reactively

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Decline is genuinely correlated with time-in-market, not a concurrent audience or bid change

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating creative refresh as a purely qualitative, subjective decision instead of grounding it in the actual engagement trend data

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Feed this Skill's cadence findings into a creative production calendar — visual fatigue is predictable enough in most accounts to plan refreshes proactively instead of always reacting after a decline shows up.

---

48 YouTube Ad Concept Development

OBJECTIVE

Develop YouTube/video ad concepts grounded in the same audience and offer data used elsewhere in the account, rather than generic video-ad tropes.

WHEN TO USE IT

When launching or refreshing a YouTube/video campaign.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- 06-BRAND-VOICE.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- 06-BRAND-VOICE.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Provide Claude the ICP, offer, and brand voice files.
2. Ask for 3-5 distinct video concept directions, each with a hook, structure, and CTA.
3. Specify format constraints (skippable in-stream, bumper, Shorts) per concept.
4. Review for factual accuracy and brand voice fit.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Develop 3-5 distinct YouTube ad concept directions for this campaign, using our ICP, product/offer, and brand voice files attached. For each concept, provide: the hook (first 5 seconds, since that's the skip-decision window), the overall structure (problem-agitate-solve, testimonial-style, demo-style, direct-offer, etc. — name the structure used), the core message, and the CTA. Tailor at least one concept specifically for a short, non-skippable or Shorts format (under 15 seconds) and at least one for a longer skippable in-stream format that can develop the message more fully. Ground every claim in our actual product/offer data — do not invent features, guarantees, or statistics. Flag which concept you'd prioritize testing first and why, based on our audience data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

3-5 labeled video concept briefs with hook, structure, message, CTA, and format fit, plus a testing priority recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The first 5 seconds carries almost all the weight in skippable formats — evaluate concepts primarily on hook strength before anything else.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Brief the strongest-rated concept to video production first

- Log all concepts in 10-TESTING-LOG.md for future reference even if not all are produced

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No fabricated claims or statistics in any concept

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing concepts optimized for engagement/entertainment value with no clear connection back to the actual offer and CTA

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Video concepts age faster than search ad copy — plan for a refresh cadence from the start rather than treating a video asset as a permanent, one-time production investment.

---

49 Display Creative Angle Development

OBJECTIVE

Generate Display/Demand Gen creative angles suited to a passive, lower-intent browsing context rather than reusing high-intent Search messaging.

WHEN TO USE IT

When launching or refreshing Display or Demand Gen campaigns.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md
- 06-BRAND-VOICE.md
- Existing high-performing Search angles for reference

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md
- 06-BRAND-VOICE.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Provide Claude the ICP and brand voice files, plus any top Search angles for reference (not for direct reuse).
2. Ask for Display-specific creative angles adapted for passive browsing context.
3. Ensure angles account for lower baseline intent than Search.
4. Review for brand voice and factual accuracy.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Develop creative angles for a Display/Demand Gen campaign, using our ICP and brand voice files attached, and our top-performing Search ad angles as directional reference only — do not simply copy Search messaging into Display, since the audience context is fundamentally different (passive browsing/content consumption vs. active search intent). Generate 4-5 angles suited to this lower-intent, interruption-based context: favor curiosity-driven or benefit-led hooks that work without an existing search query to anchor to, and consider that the CTA may need to be softer (learn more, see how it works) rather than a hard transactional ask, depending on our funnel goal for this campaign. For each angle, specify headline, primary text, and recommended visual direction. Ground every claim in real product data.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

4-5 Display/Demand Gen creative angle briefs adapted for passive-browsing context.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Display CTR benchmarks are inherently much lower than Search — judge Display creative against Display-specific benchmarks, not Search ones.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Pair top angles with the visual asset development from Skill 47's fatigue-aware production plan

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] CTA intensity matches the campaign's actual funnel goal, not defaulted to a hard sell

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reusing high-intent Search copy verbatim in Display, where the audience hasn't expressed the same active intent

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Demand Gen in particular rewards native-feeling creative that doesn't look like a traditional banner ad — brief this explicitly if the platform and placement support it.

---

50 Objection-Handling Copy Development

OBJECTIVE

Build a library of ad copy lines that directly address the specific objections a prospect has at each funnel stage, rather than relying on generic reassurance.

WHEN TO USE IT

When CVR is weak despite strong CTR and a reasonable landing page, suggesting unresolved hesitation is the blocker.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Known customer objections (from sales/support if available)
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- Skill 20 funnel classification

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Objection list if available
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather known objections, or ask Claude to infer plausible ones from the offer and flag them as inferred.
2. Ask Claude to write specific copy lines addressing each objection, mapped to the funnel stage where it's most relevant.
3. Prioritize objections by likely frequency/impact.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Build an objection-handling copy library for our ad account. If we have real customer objection data (attached), use it directly. Where we don't, infer the 3-5 most likely objections a prospect would have at each funnel stage (informational, investigation, transactional) given our product/offer, and clearly flag these as inferred rather than confirmed. For each objection, write 2 short ad copy lines (headline-length and description-length versions) that address it directly and factually — do not write vague reassurance ('trusted by many') when a specific, substantiated answer exists in our offer data (e.g., a real guarantee, a specific return policy, a real certification). Map each objection-handling line to the funnel stage and campaign type it's best suited for.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

An objection-handling copy library organized by objection and funnel stage, with inferred objections clearly flagged.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Confirmed objections (from real sales/support data) should always take priority over inferred ones in testing order.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add top objection-handling lines to Skill 43's description-line testing
- Validate inferred objections with the sales/support team when possible

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every substantiated claim (guarantee, policy, certification) is checked against real offer data before use

COMMON MISTAKES

- Writing generic reassurance copy when a specific, more persuasive factual answer already exists in the offer data

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This library becomes reusable across ad copy, landing page copy (Category 5), and sales enablement — build it once, deliberately, rather than reinventing objection responses ad hoc in every copywriting Skill.

---

51 Benefit vs. Feature Messaging Audit

OBJECTIVE

Check whether ad copy leans too heavily on feature lists without translating them into the outcome the customer actually cares about.

WHEN TO USE IT

During a copy quality review, especially for technical or B2B products.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current ad copy
- 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Ad copy export
- 04-TARGET-AUDIENCE-AND-ICP.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Review current copy against the ICP's actual stated priorities/pain points.
2. Ask Claude to classify each line as feature-only, benefit-only, or feature-with-translated-benefit.
3. Recommend rewrites for feature-only lines, translating into the specific outcome that matters to this ICP.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached ad copy against our ICP file. Classify each headline/description as: FEATURE-ONLY (states a product attribute with no stated outcome — e.g., '256-bit encryption'), BENEFIT-ONLY (states an outcome with no concrete backing — e.g., 'total peace of mind'), or FEATURE-WITH-TRANSLATED-BENEFIT (connects the attribute to the specific outcome this ICP cares about — e.g., '256-bit encryption keeps client data compliant'). For every feature-only line, rewrite it to translate into the outcome that matters most to our specific ICP, using their actual stated priorities from the ICP file rather than a generic benefit. For benefit-only lines with no concrete backing, recommend adding the specific feature/fact that substantiates the claim.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A classified copy audit with feature-only and unsubstantiated-benefit-only lines rewritten to combine both.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The strongest line almost always combines a concrete fact with the specific outcome it produces for this specific audience — pure feature or pure benefit copy each leave value on the table.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Prioritize rewriting feature-only lines in the highest-spend ad groups first

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Translated benefits are grounded in the ICP's actual stated priorities, not a generic assumption about what customers want

COMMON MISTAKES

- Translating a feature into a benefit that doesn't actually matter to this specific ICP, just to technically satisfy the checklist

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This audit is most valuable for technical and B2B accounts, where the temptation to list specs without translation is strongest and the audience is often specialized enough that a generic benefit rewrite would ring false.

---

52 Ad Variation Testing Plan

OBJECTIVE

Turn a set of new copy angles into a structured testing plan with clear hypotheses, so results can be attributed to a specific change.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before launching any batch of new ad copy generated by Category 4 Skills.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- New copy candidates
- Current baseline ad performance

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- New copy from relevant Skills
- Current ad performance baseline

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather the new copy candidates and the current baseline performance.
2. Ask Claude to structure a test: what's changing, what's the hypothesis, what's the success metric, what's the minimum runtime.
3. Ensure only one major variable changes at a time where possible.
4. Set a review checkpoint and decision rule.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Turn the attached new ad copy candidates into a structured testing plan against our current baseline ad performance. For each test, state: the specific hypothesis (e.g., 'objection-handling description lines will improve CVR without hurting CTR'), the primary and secondary metrics to track, the minimum runtime needed given current traffic volume to reach a meaningful read (estimate using the ad group's historical weekly conversion volume), and a pre-committed decision rule for what result would mean roll out, revert, or extend. Where multiple new angles are being tested in the same ad group, flag whether that risks confounding results, and recommend a cleaner sequential test structure if so.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structured testing plan per copy batch: hypothesis, metrics, minimum runtime, decision rule.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A test without a pre-committed decision rule almost always ends in a judgment call made after the fact, which defeats the purpose of testing.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Log every test in 10-TESTING-LOG.md before launch, and record the actual outcome against the pre-committed rule

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Minimum runtime estimate is based on this ad group's real historical volume, not a generic rule of thumb

COMMON MISTAKES

- Declaring a test result after too little data because early numbers looked promising or disappointing

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

RSAs make true controlled A/B testing hard since Google's own combination-serving algorithm introduces its own variability — treat RSA-level tests as directional evidence, and rely on Skill 41's asset performance ratings within the RSA for finer-grained reads.

CATEGORY 5

Landing Page and Offer Diagnosis

Traffic quality problems and landing page problems produce the same symptom — weak conversion rate — which is why they're so often confused. This category gives Claude a structured way to separate the two, and a repeatable scoring framework for diagnosing exactly where a page is losing the visitors it should be converting. None of these Skills replace a human CRO review of the live page — they replace guessing where to start one.

---

53 Message Match Audit

OBJECTIVE

Verify that the landing page headline and above-the-fold content directly reflect the ad copy and keyword that brought the visitor there.

WHEN TO USE IT

Whenever CVR is weak for a specific ad group despite strong CTR — the classic message-match failure signature.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Ad copy per ad group
- Landing page URL/screenshot per ad group
- Destination URL mapping

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Ad copy export
- Landing page screenshots or URLs
- 08-LANDING-PAGES.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Map each ad group's final URL and ad copy to its landing page.
2. Ask Claude to compare the ad's core promise/headline against the landing page's headline and above-the-fold content.
3. Score message match per ad group.
4. Flag any ad group sending traffic to a generic page (e.g., homepage) instead of a matched one.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *For each ad group listed, compare the ad copy's core headline/promise against the landing page it sends traffic to (URL and above-the-fold content described or screenshotted, attached). Score message match on a 1-5 scale: 5 = the page headline nearly restates the ad's specific promise and the visitor immediately recognizes they've landed in the right place; 1 = the page is generic (e.g., a homepage) with no connection to the specific ad clicked. Flag every ad group scoring 3 or below, and for each, state specifically what the landing page headline/hero section would need to say to match the ad's promise. Prioritize flagged ad groups by spend, highest first.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A message-match score per ad group with specific fix language for low scorers, prioritized by spend.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Sending high-intent ad clicks to a generic homepage is one of the single most common, highest-impact fixable CVR problems in paid search.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Build or request a dedicated landing page for the highest-spend, lowest-scoring ad groups first

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Score reflects the actual visible above-the-fold content, not the full page

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming a page 'about the right topic' counts as a match — message match requires echoing the specific promise, not just the general subject

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is usually the first Skill to run in Category 5 — it's the fastest way to distinguish a genuine landing page quality problem from a simple routing problem.

---

54 Intent Alignment Review

OBJECTIVE

Confirm the landing page content matches the funnel stage of the traffic it receives — an informational page for research-stage clicks, a transactional page for buy-ready clicks.

WHEN TO USE IT

After Skill 20's funnel classification, to check whether page content is aligned to intent stage, not just topic.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Skill 20 funnel classification per ad group
- Landing page content per ad group

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 20 output
- Landing page content/screenshots

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Take the funnel-stage classification per ad group/keyword theme.
2. Compare against what the destination page actually asks the visitor to do.
3. Flag mismatches — e.g., transactional traffic sent to a long-form educational article with no clear purchase path.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using the attached funnel-stage classification (informational, investigation, transactional) per ad group, review whether each destination landing page's content and primary CTA matches that intent stage. Flag mismatches: transactional-intent traffic landing on a page with no clear, prominent purchase/conversion path; informational-intent traffic landing on a hard-sell page with no educational content, which can feel pushy and premature to a visitor who's still researching. For each mismatch, recommend the specific content or CTA change needed to realign the page with the traffic's actual readiness to convert.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

An intent-alignment table (Ad Group / Funnel Stage / Page Fit / Recommended Fix).

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Intent misalignment often explains why a page with strong CRO fundamentals (fast, clear, trustworthy) can still underperform for a specific traffic source.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Route informational traffic to an education-first page with a softer secondary CTA
- Route transactional traffic to a streamlined, purchase-focused page

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Funnel classification used is current, not stale from a prior quarter

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming one landing page can serve all intent stages equally well

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is where Category 2's intent classification (Skill 20) and Category 5 connect directly — never diagnose a landing page in isolation from the intent of the traffic actually arriving on it.

---

55 Above-the-Fold Review

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether the visible content before scrolling gives a visitor everything needed to decide to continue: what it is, who it's for, and why to act.

WHEN TO USE IT

As part of any landing page diagnostic, especially for high-bounce-rate pages.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Above-the-fold screenshot or description (desktop and mobile)
- Ad promise being matched

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Landing page screenshots (desktop + mobile)

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Capture or describe the above-the-fold section on both desktop and mobile.
2. Ask Claude to evaluate it against three questions: what is this, who is it for, why act now.
3. Score each question and flag gaps.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Evaluate the attached above-the-fold section (desktop and mobile) against three questions a visitor needs answered within the first few seconds, without scrolling: (1) WHAT IS THIS — is it immediately clear what's being offered; (2) WHO IS IT FOR — does the visitor recognize themselves as the intended audience; (3) WHY ACT NOW — is there a clear reason to continue rather than bounce. Score each question 1-5 for both desktop and mobile separately, since layouts often differ significantly. Flag any question scoring 3 or below with a specific description of what's missing and a concrete content or layout suggestion to fix it — not a generic 'make it clearer' note.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 3-question, dual-device (desktop/mobile) above-the-fold scorecard with specific fixes for low scores.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Mobile and desktop often score differently for the same page — a common failure is a well-designed desktop hero section that collapses into an unclear, low-information mobile view.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix the lowest-scoring question first, since it's the most likely single point of visitor loss

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Mobile is evaluated as its own experience, not assumed to inherit the desktop score

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reviewing only the desktop version when the majority of traffic may be mobile (cross-check against Skill 12's device data)

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This maps directly onto the broader 10-dimension landing page scoring framework (see Skill 64) — treat this Skill as a deep dive on two of those ten dimensions (Clarity, CTA) specifically for the visible fold.

---

56 CTA Clarity Diagnostic

OBJECTIVE

Assess whether the primary call-to-action is singular, visible, and unambiguous — or competing with secondary CTAs that dilute the intended action.

WHEN TO USE IT

Whenever a page has multiple possible actions (buy, sign up, download, contact) and CVR on the primary goal is weak.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- All CTAs present on the landing page
- The intended primary conversion goal

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Landing page screenshot/content
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md primary conversion action

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. List every CTA present on the page.
2. Identify which one is meant to be primary per the stated conversion goal.
3. Ask Claude to assess whether the primary CTA is visually and hierarchically dominant, or competing with secondary CTAs.
4. Recommend specific hierarchy fixes.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached landing page for CTA clarity. List every distinct call-to-action present (buttons, links, forms). Our primary conversion goal for this page is [stated primary action]. Assess whether that primary CTA is the clear, visually dominant action on the page, or whether it's competing for attention with equal or more prominent secondary CTAs (e.g., a newsletter signup, a 'learn more' link, social media icons, navigation items) that could distract a visitor who was ready to take the primary action. Recommend specific changes to establish clear visual and hierarchical dominance for the primary CTA, and identify any secondary CTA that should be removed, de-emphasized, or moved below the primary conversion point rather than competing with it above the fold.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A CTA inventory with a primary-vs-secondary hierarchy assessment and specific dominance fixes.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Every additional prominent CTA is a decision point that can pull a visitor away from the action that actually matters to the business — fewer, clearer choices generally convert better.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Remove or de-emphasize competing CTAs above the fold first

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation reflects the actual stated primary conversion goal, not an assumed one

COMMON MISTAKES

- Adding more CTAs to 'give visitors options,' which usually reduces the primary conversion rate rather than improving overall value

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill matters especially for lead-gen pages that try to capture a visitor through multiple channels (form, phone number, chat) — decide which channel is actually primary and design toward it, don't present all as equal.

---

57 Trust Signal Audit

OBJECTIVE

Check whether the landing page includes the credibility signals this specific audience and price point need to feel comfortable converting.

WHEN TO USE IT

For higher-consideration purchases, new/unfamiliar brands, or when CVR is weak despite strong message match.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Landing page content
- Available real trust assets (reviews, certifications, guarantees, press mentions)

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Landing page content
- List of available real trust assets

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Inventory available real trust assets the business actually has.

2. Ask Claude to assess whether the page displays trust signals appropriate to the price point and consideration level.
3. Recommend which available assets to add and where.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached landing page's trust signals against our actual available trust assets (reviews, ratings, certifications, guarantees, press mentions, client logos — attached). Assess whether the page displays credibility signals appropriate to the price point and consideration level of this offer — a $30 impulse purchase needs less trust-building than a $3,000 B2B commitment. Identify gaps: real trust assets we have that aren't shown on the page, and placement issues (a trust signal present but buried below the point where the visitor needs reassurance to continue). Recommend only real assets we actually have — do not suggest generic trust badges or claims we can't substantiate.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A trust-signal gap analysis with specific, real-asset-based recommendations and placement guidance.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Trust signal need scales with price and consideration — don't apply a B2B enterprise trust framework to a low-cost, low-risk consumer purchase or vice versa.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add the highest-relevance missing trust asset near the primary CTA first

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every recommended trust signal is a real, available asset, never a fabricated badge or claim

COMMON MISTAKES

- Recommending generic trust badges with no real substantiation, which can undermine credibility rather than build it if visitors investigate

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Placement matters as much as presence — a real trust asset buried in a footer does almost nothing; the same asset near the CTA at the moment of hesitation can meaningfully move conversion rate.

---

58 Pricing Clarity Review

OBJECTIVE

Check whether pricing information is presented clearly enough, early enough, to avoid visitor confusion or perceived hidden costs.

WHEN TO USE IT

For any page where price is a factor in the decision and CVR seems weaker than message match/traffic quality would predict.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Landing page pricing presentation
- Actual pricing/fee structure

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Landing page content
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md pricing data

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Review how and where pricing is presented on the page.
2. Compare against the actual, complete pricing/fee structure.
3. Ask Claude to flag any ambiguity, hidden fees not disclosed until late in the funnel, or confusing pricing tiers.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review how pricing is presented on the attached landing page against our actual, complete pricing/fee structure. Flag: any fee or cost not disclosed until later in the funnel (checkout, a subsequent page) that could feel like a hidden cost and cause abandonment; pricing tiers or options presented in a confusing way that could make it hard for the visitor to know which applies to them; a lack of pricing information entirely on ad-driven traffic that arrived already comparing options (common for commercial-investigation intent per our funnel classification). Recommend specific changes to make total cost clear as early as is strategically appropriate, given our positioning — note if there's a legitimate strategic reason to delay price disclosure (e.g., a custom-quote B2B model) rather than assuming earlier is always better.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A pricing clarity assessment with specific disclosure and presentation fixes, respecting legitimate reasons for delayed pricing where applicable.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Hidden or late-disclosed costs are one of the most common causes of cart/form abandonment specifically among paid-traffic visitors, who are more price-comparison-aware than organic visitors.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Surface total cost earlier for products where competitors disclose pricing upfront (checked via 07-COMPETITORS.md)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation respects any real strategic reason for delayed pricing rather than assuming full transparency is always optimal

COMMON MISTAKES

- Recommending full price transparency on a genuinely custom-quote B2B offer where delayed pricing is a deliberate qualification strategy

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Cross-check this against 07-COMPETITORS.md — if every competitor discloses pricing upfront and we don't, that gap alone can explain a meaningful CVR difference on commercial-investigation traffic.

---

59 Offer Strength Assessment

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether the actual offer (not the page design) is compelling enough relative to what the visitor is being asked to give up (money, data, time).

WHEN TO USE IT

When a page scores well on design/clarity/trust but still underperforms — the offer itself may be the constraint.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current offer details
- 07-COMPETITORS.md competitor offers

- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md margin constraints

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md
- 07-COMPETITORS.md
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Compare the current offer against what competitors offer for a comparable ask.
2. Ask Claude to assess relative offer strength within our real margin constraints.
3. Propose offer adjustments that remain profitable per 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Assess the strength of our current offer relative to what the visitor is asked to give up (price, form fields, commitment level) and relative to competitor offers for a comparable ask (attached). This is a diagnostic of the offer itself, separate from how well the page communicates it — assume message match and clarity are already strong and focus purely on whether the underlying deal is competitive. If the offer is weak relative to competitors, propose 2-3 concrete adjustments (which could include pricing, bundling, guarantee terms, or reduced friction like fewer form fields) that would strengthen it, but every proposal must remain within our real margin constraints from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md — do not propose a discount or guarantee that would push the unit economics below break-even. If the offer is genuinely competitive already, say so and redirect focus to page execution instead.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A comparative offer-strength assessment with margin-constrained improvement proposals, or a clear 'offer is competitive' verdict.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This Skill exists specifically to catch the case where a beautifully designed, well-matched page still underperforms because the underlying deal simply isn't good enough — no amount of CRO fixes that.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- If offer is weak, escalate proposed adjustments to whoever owns pricing/promotions before spending further on page optimization

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every proposed adjustment is checked against real margin data before being recommended

COMMON MISTAKES

- Endlessly optimizing page design and copy when the real constraint is that the offer itself is uncompetitive

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the Skill most likely to surface an uncomfortable but valuable finding — that no amount of ad or landing page work will fix a fundamentally weak offer. Treat that as useful information, not a dead end.

---

60 Form Friction Audit

OBJECTIVE

Identify unnecessary friction in a lead-gen form that's suppressing completion rate without improving lead quality enough to justify it.

WHEN TO USE IT

For any lead-gen landing page, especially when form starts significantly exceed form completions.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current form fields
- Form start vs. completion data if available
- What sales actually needs from a lead

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Form field list
- Form analytics if available

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. List every field currently on the form.
2. Ask Claude to classify each as essential (sales genuinely can't qualify/follow up without it) or optional/nice-to-have.
3. Recommend which fields to cut, make optional, or move to a later step (progressive profiling).

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached lead-gen form field list. For each field, classify it as ESSENTIAL (our sales/fulfillment process genuinely cannot function without this at the point of initial capture) or NON-ESSENTIAL (useful eventually, but not required to start a qualified conversation). Every additional form field beyond what's essential typically reduces completion rate — recommend cutting or deferring non-essential fields to a later step (post-submission survey, sales call, progressive profiling on return visits) rather than requiring them upfront. If form start vs. completion data is attached, identify which specific field appears to correlate with the largest drop-off. Give a final recommended minimal field set.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A field-by-field essential/non-essential classification with a recommended minimal form and, if data allows, a specific drop-off culprit field.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Every field cut from a form is a direct, usually fast-acting lever on completion rate — this is often the single highest-leverage, lowest-effort landing page fix available.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Cut or defer non-essential fields immediately
- A/B test the reduced form against the current one before fully committing if lead quality concerns exist

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Essential classification reflects what sales genuinely needs at first contact, not what would be convenient to have

COMMON MISTAKES

- Keeping fields 'just in case' without checking whether they're actually used downstream in the sales process

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Push back respectfully if sales/marketing wants to keep a field for lead scoring purposes — ask whether the scoring value is worth the completion-rate cost, since that trade-off is rarely made explicit.

61 Mobile UX Diagnostic

OBJECTIVE

Assess the landing page's mobile experience as its own, standalone experience rather than an assumed-equivalent shrink of desktop.

WHEN TO USE IT

Whenever mobile CVR meaningfully underperforms desktop (cross-reference Skill 12).

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Mobile screenshots/recording of the full page flow
- Mobile-specific performance data

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Mobile page screenshots
- Device performance report (from Skill 12)

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Capture the full mobile experience from ad click through conversion.
2. Ask Claude to evaluate load experience, tap-target sizing, form usability, and checkout/conversion flow specifically on mobile.
3. Flag any step where mobile clearly degrades versus desktop.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Evaluate the attached mobile landing page experience (screenshots/flow from click to conversion) as its own standalone journey. Assess: whether critical content and the primary CTA are visible without excessive scrolling; whether tap targets (buttons, form fields, links) are appropriately sized and spaced for touch interaction, not just visually present; whether any form or checkout step appears to require pinch-zooming, horizontal scrolling, or an awkward keyboard interaction (e.g., wrong input type triggering the desktop keyboard instead of a numeric pad for a phone field); whether any element visible on desktop appears to be missing or broken on mobile. Flag each issue found with the specific step in the flow where it occurs, and prioritize by how early in the flow the issue appears — earlier issues cost more completed conversions.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A step-by-step mobile UX issue list, prioritized by position in the funnel.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Issues earlier in the mobile flow compound — a friction point at step 1 costs more total conversions than the same friction point at step 4, even if both are equally 'bad' in isolation.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix the earliest flagged issue in the flow first regardless of how 'small' it seems

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Evaluation is based on the actual rendered mobile experience, not an assumption that responsive design automatically handles it well

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming a responsive desktop design is automatically a good mobile experience without checking the rendered result directly

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Combine this with Skill 12's device performance data — a mobile UX issue found here should show up as a corresponding CVR gap there; if it doesn't, the diagnosis may be wrong or a different factor may be dominating.

---

62 Ecommerce Product Detail Page (PDP) Review

OBJECTIVE

Apply the landing page scoring framework specifically to ecommerce PDPs, accounting for the unique elements (images, reviews, shipping info, sizing) that drive PDP conversion.

WHEN TO USE IT

For Shopping/PMax traffic landing on individual product pages.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- PDP content for top-spend products
- Reviews/ratings availability
- Shipping/return policy

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- PDP screenshots for top products
- Shipping/return policy details

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Select PDPs for top-spend products.
2. Ask Claude to review against ecommerce-specific PDP factors: image quality/count, review visibility, size/variant clarity, shipping/return info visibility, stock urgency (if real).
3. Recommend specific PDP improvements per product or as a template-level fix.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached product detail pages against ecommerce-specific conversion factors: (1) image quality and count — enough angles/context to replace an in-person look; (2) review/rating visibility — are they prominent, or buried below the fold; (3) size/variant selection clarity — is it obvious and error-resistant; (4) shipping cost and delivery timeframe visibility — disclosed before checkout, not hidden; (5) return policy visibility; (6) any stock/urgency indicator — only flag as an issue if it's either missing when real scarcity exists, or present but not genuinely true (never recommend fabricated urgency). Distinguish issues that are template-level (affecting every PDP the same way, worth fixing once) from product-specific issues (affecting only certain SKUs, like missing images). Prioritize template-level fixes first since they scale across the whole catalog.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A PDP review with a template-level vs. product-specific issue breakdown, prioritizing template fixes.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A template-level PDP fix (e.g., moving reviews above the fold sitewide) has catalog-wide leverage that a single-product fix never will.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix template-level issues first through the PDP template/theme, not product-by-product
- Address product-specific gaps (missing images, no reviews yet) for top-spend SKUs next

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No recommendation for fabricated urgency or scarcity

COMMON MISTAKES

- Spending review effort product-by-product before checking whether the same issue is actually a template-wide problem

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

PDP review connects directly to Category 3 — a weak PDP can undo the benefit of a well-optimized product title that earned the click in the first place.

---

63 Lead Generation Landing Page Review

OBJECTIVE

Apply the landing page scoring framework specifically to lead-gen pages, focused on the elements that most affect form completion and lead quality.

WHEN TO USE IT

For Search/PMax traffic landing on lead-gen forms rather than an ecommerce checkout.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Lead-gen page content
- Form field list
- Trust assets available

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Lead-gen page screenshot/content
- Form field list
- Trust assets

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Review the page against lead-gen-specific factors: what happens after submission being clear, form friction, trust for data-sharing, alternative contact paths.
2. Ask Claude to score and prioritize fixes.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached lead-generation landing page against factors specific to form-based conversion: (1) is it clear what happens after submission (a call, an email, a demo scheduling link) — ambiguity here increases hesitation to submit personal information; (2) form friction per our field audit (cross-reference Skill 60 if available); (3) trust signals specifically relevant to data-sharing hesitation (privacy assurance, no spam commitment, real testimonials from similar customers); (4) whether an alternative contact path (phone, chat) is offered for visitors who prefer not to fill a form, and whether that dilutes or complements the primary form CTA. Score each factor and prioritize fixes by likely impact on completion rate.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A lead-gen-specific page scorecard with prioritized fixes.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

'What happens next' clarity is a frequently overlooked lever specific to lead-gen — visitors are more willing to submit information when they know exactly what to expect afterward.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add or clarify post-submission expectation-setting first if missing
- Route field-level fixes through Skill 60

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendations account for the specific hesitation profile of sharing personal data, distinct from an ecommerce purchase decision

COMMON MISTAKES

- Applying ecommerce PDP conventions (urgency, stock counters) to a B2B lead-gen context where they can feel mismatched or untrustworthy

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Pair this with Skill 57 (trust signals) — data-sharing hesitation responds especially well to real, specific trust signals like a named privacy policy or a 'no spam' commitment stated plainly near the form.

---

64 Landing Page Conversion Readiness Score

OBJECTIVE

Produce a single, structured 10-dimension score for a landing page, synthesizing Skills 53-63 into one comparable output across pages.

WHEN TO USE IT

As the closing synthesis after running multiple Category 5 diagnostics, or as a fast standalone check on a new page.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- All available Category 5 outputs for this page, or the raw page if running standalone

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Landing page content/screenshots
- Any prior Category 5 Skill outputs for this page

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather any available prior diagnostics for the page.
2. Ask Claude to score the page across all 10 dimensions using the standard framework.
3. Identify the lowest-scoring dimensions as the priority fix list.
4. Use the score as a comparable baseline across multiple pages.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Score the attached landing page across these 10 dimensions, 1-5 each, using our standard framework: Message Match, Intent Alignment, Value Proposition, Offer Strength, Trust, Clarity, Friction, CTA, Mobile UX, Conversion Readiness (an overall gut-check combining the above). If prior diagnostic outputs for specific dimensions are attached (from message match, trust, form friction, or mobile UX reviews), use those scores directly rather than re-deriving them from scratch. For any dimension without prior analysis, score it now with a one-sentence justification. Output a scorecard table, a total score, and a ranked list of the 3 lowest-scoring dimensions as the priority fix order. This score should be directly comparable to scores generated for other landing pages in this account using the same framework.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A 10-dimension scorecard with total score and a top-3 priority fix list.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Use this score comparatively across the account's pages, not as an absolute quality bar — a 32/50 page that's the best-performing page in the account tells you something different than a 32/50 page that's the worst.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix the top 3 lowest-scoring dimensions before re-scoring
- Track score changes over time in 10-TESTING-LOG.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Scores for dimensions with prior detailed analysis are pulled from that analysis, not re-guessed

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating the total score as the goal itself rather than as a tool for finding and fixing the lowest dimension

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is the Category 5 equivalent of Skill 14 and Skill 40 — every category with multiple diagnostic Skills gets more useful with one synthesis Skill that forces a single, comparable, prioritized output.

CATEGORY 6

Bidding, Budget and Scaling Decisions

"High ROAS" and "increase the budget" are not the same sentence, even though accounts treat them that way constantly. This category forces every budget and scaling decision through the same lens: marginal return, not average return. A campaign's average ROAS tells you how it has performed; its marginal ROAS tells you what the next dollar will actually do — and only the second number should drive a scaling decision.

---

65 Budget Allocation Review

OBJECTIVE

Assess whether current budget distribution across campaigns matches where marginal return is actually highest, not just where spend has historically sat.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, or whenever total account budget changes and needs redistribution.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign performance with impression share lost to budget
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance CSV
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export campaign-level performance including impression share lost to budget.
2. Ask Claude to identify campaigns where marginal ROAS (estimated from budget-constrained performance) exceeds account average.
3. Model a reallocation scenario shifting budget from lower-marginal-return campaigns to higher ones.
4. Cap any single reallocation to avoid destabilizing Smart Bidding.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached campaign performance, including impression share lost to budget. For each campaign, estimate marginal ROAS — the return on the next incremental dollar, not the average ROAS on dollars already spent — using budget-constrained campaigns' recent conversion rate and CPC as your basis for the estimate, and note where the estimate is more speculative for unconstrained campaigns since we can't observe their marginal return as directly. Using our break-even ROAS from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md, model a reallocation: which campaigns should receive more budget (constrained, above-break-even marginal return) and which should receive less (spending well past their efficient point or below break-even). Cap any single campaign's budget change at 30% in one move to avoid destabilizing its bid strategy, and phase larger reallocations across multiple cycles.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A reallocation model (Campaign / Current Budget / Recommended Budget / Marginal ROAS Basis) with capped, phased changes.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Marginal ROAS is inherently an estimate, not a precise figure — treat this as directional guidance for reallocation, and validate with real results after the change, not just the model.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Implement the largest, most confident reallocation this cycle; phase the rest over subsequent cycles
- Re-run this monthly as performance shifts

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No single campaign's budget changes by more than the stated cap in one move

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reallocating based on average ROAS instead of estimated marginal ROAS — this is the single most common budget allocation error

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the foundational Skill for this whole category — nearly every other Skill in Category 6 either feeds into or depends on getting this marginal-vs-average distinction right.

---

66 Marginal ROAS Estimation

OBJECTIVE

Build a defensible estimate of marginal ROAS for a specific campaign to answer the question: what would the next incremental dollar actually return?

WHEN TO USE IT

Before any individual budget increase decision, especially for high-spend campaigns.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign performance trend as budget/spend has varied historically
- Impression share data

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign daily performance with spend, conversions, and impression share over time

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export daily campaign performance including any historical periods where budget was increased or constrained.
2. Ask Claude to look for a natural experiment — periods of budget change — and estimate how ROAS moved with volume.
3. Where no natural experiment exists, use impression share and auction data to build a reasoned estimate.
4. State confidence level explicitly.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Estimate marginal ROAS for this campaign — the expected return on the next incremental dollar of budget, as distinct from its historical average ROAS. Attached is daily performance data. First, look for a natural experiment: any period where the budget was increased or decreased and volume changed in response — use the ROAS during that period as more direct evidence of marginal return than a strict average. If no such period exists, build a reasoned estimate using current impression share lost to budget/rank and the auction competitiveness implied by average position and CPC trends, being explicit that this is a modeled estimate rather than observed. State your confidence level (high/medium/low) in the estimate based on how much real evidence versus modeling assumption it relies on, and give both a point estimate and a plausible range.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A marginal ROAS estimate with a stated confidence level, a range, and the evidence basis used.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A low-confidence estimate is still useful for prioritization between campaigns, but should not be the sole basis for a large, irreversible budget commitment — pair it with a controlled test where the stakes are high.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- For high-confidence estimates, act directly on Skill 65's reallocation
- For low-confidence estimates, run a small controlled budget increase test first and observe the real result

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Confidence level is genuinely tied to the strength of the evidence used, not asserted uniformly

COMMON MISTAKES

- Presenting a modeled estimate with the same confidence as an observed natural experiment

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The cleanest natural experiments usually come from a campaign that was recently budget-constrained and then unlocked — always check for this pattern in the account's history before building a purely theoretical model.

---

67 Campaign Budget Rebalancing Plan

OBJECTIVE

Turn a marginal-ROAS-based reallocation model into a phased, monitored implementation plan.

WHEN TO USE IT

After Skill 65/66 produce a reallocation recommendation, before executing it.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Reallocation model from Skill 65
- Marginal ROAS estimates from Skill 66

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Skill 65 and 66 outputs

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Take the reallocation targets.
2. Ask Claude to sequence the changes into phases with monitoring checkpoints.
3. Set rollback triggers per phase.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Turn the attached budget reallocation model into a phased implementation plan. Sequence changes so no campaign receives more than a 30% budget change in a single phase, and space phases at least one full conversion-lag cycle apart (reference our typical conversion lag from 06-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS or account history) so each phase's results are trustworthy before the next begins. For each phase, state: which campaigns change and by how much, the expected disruption window, the specific checkpoint metric and threshold that would trigger a rollback (e.g., 'if CPA rises more than 20% above target for 5 consecutive days, revert this phase's change'), and who should review the checkpoint before the next phase proceeds.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A phased rebalancing plan with rollback triggers and checkpoint owners per phase.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The rollback trigger is what makes this safe to execute — without one, a bad reallocation can run for weeks before anyone notices.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Execute phase 1 and hold at the checkpoint before proceeding
- Log actual results against the plan in 10-TESTING-LOG.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every phase has an explicit, numeric rollback trigger, not a vague 'monitor performance' note

COMMON MISTAKES

- Executing all phases back-to-back without waiting for each checkpoint, collapsing the plan back into one big, unmonitorable change

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is what separates a good reallocation model from a good reallocation outcome — the model is only half the work.

---

68 Bidding Strategy Review

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate whether the current automated bidding strategy per campaign matches its data volume, goal, and maturity — or was chosen once and never revisited.

WHEN TO USE IT

Quarterly, or when a campaign's performance has been inconsistent despite stable targeting.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Bid strategy per campaign
- Conversion volume per campaign
- Campaign objective

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign settings export
- Conversion volume history

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export bid strategy and monthly conversion volume per campaign.

2. Ask Claude to check whether each strategy fits its data volume (per Skill 3's threshold) and stated objective.
3. Recommend a strategy change only where there's a clear mismatch, not preference.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached bid strategy and monthly conversion volume per campaign. For each campaign, assess whether the current strategy (Manual CPC, Maximize Clicks, Maximize Conversions, Maximize Conversion Value, Target CPA, Target ROAS) fits its data volume and stated objective. Flag: campaigns on Target CPA/ROAS with too few monthly conversions (below roughly 30/month) to bid reliably, which are candidates for Maximize Conversions instead while they build volume; campaigns still on Manual CPC or Maximize Clicks with strong, stable conversion volume that are likely leaving performance on the table by not using a conversion-based automated strategy; and any Target CPA/ROAS campaign whose target appears to have never been revisited despite meaningfully changed unit economics. Recommend a change only where there's a clear data-backed mismatch — do not recommend switching strategies as a default 'try something new' move.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A bid-strategy fit assessment per campaign with change recommendations only for clear mismatches.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Switching bid strategy resets the learning phase — the bar for making a change should be a real, evidenced mismatch, not a hunch.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Change strategy only for clearly mismatched campaigns, one at a time, monitored via Skill 69's learning phase guidance

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No recommended change lacks a specific data-backed reason

COMMON MISTAKES

- Chasing the newest bidding feature or strategy name without checking whether it fits this campaign's actual data profile

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Target CPA/ROAS values themselves need periodic revisiting too, independent of the strategy type — a target set a year ago against different margins is a common source of quietly poor performance.

---

69 Target CPA Diagnostic

OBJECTIVE

Determine whether a campaign's Target CPA is set at a level consistent with current margins and realistically achievable given the account's competitive position.

WHEN TO USE IT

When a Target CPA campaign is chronically under-delivering volume, or margins have changed since the target was last set.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current Target CPA
- Actual achieved CPA trend
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md break-even CPA

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance with target vs. actual CPA over time
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export target vs. actual CPA trend for the campaign.
2. Compare the target against break-even CPA from unit economics.
3. Ask Claude to diagnose whether the target is too aggressive (causing volume suppression) or too loose (leaving profit on the table).

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Diagnose this campaign's Target CPA setting. Attached: the target vs. actual CPA trend over time, and our break-even CPA from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md. Assess: is the target set meaningfully below what the campaign can realistically achieve given its competitive auction landscape, which would suppress volume as the algorithm holds back spend to hit an unrealistic target; or is the target set well above break-even with room to tighten it and capture more profit per conversion, potentially at some volume cost. Recommend a specific new target value with reasoning, and note the expected volume/CPA trade-off direction (tightening a loose target typically reduces volume somewhat while improving CPA; loosening a too-aggressive target typically increases volume at a higher CPA, still within acceptable bounds).*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A Target CPA diagnostic with a specific recommended new value and the expected volume/CPA trade-off.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A Target CPA set too aggressively doesn't just fail to hit its number — it actively suppresses the campaign's total volume and revenue, which is easy to miss without checking impression share alongside the target.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Adjust the target incrementally (10-15% at a time) rather than in one large jump
- Monitor for 2 full conversion-lag cycles before adjusting again

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommended target respects break-even CPA as a hard floor unless there's a stated strategic reason to accept short-term unprofitability (e.g., new customer acquisition value beyond first purchase)

COMMON MISTAKES

- Loosening a target to chase volume without checking the resulting CPA against break-even first

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This diagnostic and Skill 70 (Target ROAS) share the same underlying logic — use whichever matches the campaign's actual bid strategy, and never analyze CPA and ROAS as if they were interchangeable across campaigns using different strategies.

---

70 Target ROAS Diagnostic

OBJECTIVE

Determine whether a campaign's Target ROAS is set at a level consistent with real margin requirements and realistically achievable given current auction dynamics.

WHEN TO USE IT

When a Target ROAS campaign is chronically under-delivering volume, or margins have shifted since the target was last set.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current Target ROAS
- Actual achieved ROAS trend
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md break-even ROAS

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance with target vs. actual ROAS over time
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export target vs. actual ROAS trend.
2. Compare against break-even ROAS.
3. Ask Claude to diagnose whether the target is suppressing volume unnecessarily or leaving margin uncaptured.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Diagnose this campaign's Target ROAS setting using the attached target vs. actual ROAS trend and our break-even ROAS from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md. Determine whether the target is set meaningfully above what's realistically achievable at scale given current auction competitiveness — which suppresses volume as the algorithm restricts spend to protect the ratio — or whether it's set close to break-even with room to raise it and capture more margin, accepting some volume trade-off. Note that ROAS targets should generally sit meaningfully above bare break-even ROAS to account for costs not captured in the Google Ads platform itself (payment processing, returns, overhead) — check whether 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md's break-even figure already accounts for this before using it as the floor. Recommend a specific target value with the expected volume/margin trade-off.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A Target ROAS diagnostic with a specific recommended value and the expected trade-off.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The gap between platform break-even ROAS and true business break-even ROAS (accounting for all costs) is a common source of accounts that look profitable in Google Ads but aren't at the P&L level — always confirm which break-even figure is being used.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Adjust incrementally and monitor over full conversion-lag cycles, same discipline as Skill 69

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Confirms whether the break-even figure used includes all real costs, not just cost of goods

COMMON MISTAKES

- Setting Target ROAS equal to bare product margin break-even, leaving no room for non-ad-platform costs

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is one of the most consequential numbers in the whole account, and one of the easiest to set once and forget — tie its review cadence to the business's own margin review cycle, not just to ad performance.

71 Maximize Conversions / Conversion Value Review

OBJECTIVE

Assess whether a campaign on Maximize Conversions or Maximize Conversion Value (without a target) has enough budget discipline and margin protection given it has no CPA/ROAS ceiling.

WHEN TO USE IT

For any campaign on an unconstrained Maximize strategy, especially during the early data-building phase before adding a target.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign performance on Maximize strategy
- Budget cap
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance CSV
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export performance for campaigns on unconstrained Maximize strategies.
2. Ask Claude to check whether the achieved CPA/ROAS is drifting toward or past break-even as budget increases.
3. Recommend whether the campaign has enough data maturity to add a Target CPA/ROAS constraint now.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review performance for the attached campaign(s) running on Maximize Conversions or Maximize Conversion Value without a target. Since these strategies have no CPA/ROAS ceiling and will spend the full budget seeking the most conversions/value possible, check whether the achieved CPA/ROAS is comfortably within our break-even bounds from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md or drifting toward/past it as spend has increased. Assess whether the campaign has now accumulated enough conversion volume (roughly 30+ conversions/month, our standard threshold) to reliably add a Target CPA or Target ROAS constraint, or whether it's still in a legitimate data-building phase where an unconstrained strategy is appropriate. Recommend: keep unconstrained, add a target now, or reduce budget cap if it's already spending past an acceptable CPA/ROAS.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A readiness assessment for adding a target, or a budget-cap warning if the campaign is already spending past break-even.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Maximize strategies without a target are appropriate for a defined data-building window, not indefinitely — leaving a high-spend campaign unconstrained long after it has enough data is a common source of margin erosion nobody notices because CPA/ROAS isn't being actively monitored against a target.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Add a Target CPA/ROAS once volume threshold is met, set initially close to the recently achieved actual performance
- Cap budget immediately if performance has already drifted past break-even

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Volume threshold used is consistent with the account's own Skill 3 conversion-volume standard

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaving a high-spend campaign on an unconstrained Maximize strategy indefinitely without ever revisiting whether a target should be added

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the natural bridge between launch (Maximize, no target) and mature management (Target CPA/ROAS) — make sure someone owns the decision point instead of letting it happen by default or never.

---

72 Learning Phase Interpretation

OBJECTIVE

Correctly read a campaign's status during Google's Learning Phase after a significant change, avoiding premature panic or premature declarations of success.

WHEN TO USE IT

Immediately after any bid strategy, budget, or major targeting change, for roughly 1-2 weeks.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Daily performance since the change
- Nature and date of the change made

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Daily campaign performance since the change date

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Note the exact date and nature of the change (bid strategy, major budget shift, conversion action change).
2. Export daily performance since then.
3. Ask Claude to assess whether the volatility observed is consistent with a normal learning phase or signals a genuine problem.
4. Recommend whether to hold, extend monitoring, or intervene.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *We made this change to the campaign on [date]: [describe change — e.g., switched from Maximize Conversions to Target CPA at $X]. Attached is daily performance since then. Assess whether the volatility we're seeing (CPA/ROAS swings, spend fluctuation) is consistent with a normal Google Ads learning phase — which the platform states typically takes about 1-2 weeks and roughly 15-50 conversions to stabilize, depending on volume — or whether it looks like a genuine problem requiring intervention before the learning phase would naturally resolve (e.g., a technical tracking issue, a target set so far from reality that the algorithm is starving the campaign of spend entirely). Recommend: hold and continue monitoring, or intervene now with a specific reason why waiting isn't appropriate.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A hold-vs-intervene recommendation with the reasoning for how the current volatility compares to a normal learning phase.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The most common and costly mistake here is reversing a sound change too early because early results look noisy — but the second most common mistake is ignoring a genuine problem by assuming it's 'just the learning phase.'

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- If holding, set a specific re-check date rather than checking daily and being tempted to react to noise
- If intervening, address the specific technical/target issue, not the strategy choice itself

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Volatility assessment is compared against the platform's own typical learning phase parameters, not a generic patience recommendation

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reverting a bid strategy change after 3 days because CPA looked high, without checking whether that's within normal learning phase variance

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Set the re-check date before the change goes live, not after seeing the first few volatile days — deciding the review cadence in advance removes the temptation to react emotionally to noise.

---

73 Budget-Limited Campaign Analysis

OBJECTIVE

Build a business case for exactly how much additional budget a constrained, high-performing campaign deserves, and what it would return.

WHEN TO USE IT

When requesting incremental budget from stakeholders, or deciding where net-new budget should go.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Impression share lost to budget
- Recent CPA/ROAS at current spend level
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance CSV
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Identify campaigns losing significant impression share to budget with strong recent performance.
2. Ask Claude to model incremental spend scenarios (e.g., +25%, +50%, +100% budget) and their likely revenue/profit return.
3. Build a stakeholder-ready business case.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

Build a budget-increase business case for this campaign. It's attached with recent performance and impression share lost to budget data. Model three incremental budget scenarios (+25%, +50%, +100%) and estimate the likely revenue and profit return for each, using the campaign's current CPA/ROAS as the base case and noting that returns typically diminish somewhat as spend increases and the campaign reaches into less efficient auction inventory — apply a reasonable, stated diminishing-returns discount to the higher scenarios rather than assuming flat marginal returns at every scale. Use our break-even figures from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md to show the profit margin at each scenario, not just revenue. Present this as a concise business case: current state, the opportunity, the three scenarios with their modeled return, and a recommended scenario to pursue.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A three-scenario budget business case with modeled revenue/profit return and a recommendation, ready to present to stakeholders.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Always show profit, not just revenue or ROAS, in a budget request — a stakeholder approving budget needs to see the bottom-line case, not just the ratio.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Present the recommended scenario with the full model attached for scrutiny
- Track actual results against the modeled scenario once approved (feeds Skill 74)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Diminishing returns are explicitly modeled, not ignored, in the higher-spend scenarios

COMMON MISTAKES

- Presenting only the best-case scenario without the diminishing-returns caveat, setting up an unrealistic expectation

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill turns Skill 66's marginal ROAS estimation into a decision-ready document — the estimation work and the business case are two different outputs the guide separates on purpose.

---

74 Scaling Readiness Assessment

OBJECTIVE

Determine whether a campaign is actually ready to scale — not just performing well today, but structurally capable of absorbing more budget without breaking.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before committing to a significant, sustained budget increase, distinct from the one-time modeling in Skill 73.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Conversion volume stability
- Impression share headroom
- Inventory/fulfillment capacity
- Landing page/offer readiness

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance history

- Inventory/capacity notes from 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Check conversion volume trend stability, not just level.
2. Check remaining impression share headroom in the broader market, not just budget-constrained share.
3. Check whether the business can fulfill increased demand (inventory, sales capacity, support capacity).
4. Ask Claude to give a go/no-go/go-with-caveats readiness verdict.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Assess whether this campaign is truly ready to scale, not just currently performing well. Consider four factors using the attached data: (1) STABILITY — is conversion volume and CPA/ROAS stable over the recent period, or has it been volatile in a way that makes current performance a less reliable base for scaling; (2) HEADROOM — beyond current budget constraint, is there genuine remaining market impression share available (check Auction Insights / impression share metrics), or is the campaign already reaching most of its addressable auction; (3) FULFILLMENT CAPACITY — per our business context notes, can the business actually handle a meaningful increase in orders/leads without service quality degrading; (4) DOWNSTREAM READINESS — is the landing page/offer solid per our Category 5 diagnostics, since scaling budget into a weak page just scales the weak conversion rate too. Give a clear go / no-go / go-with-caveats verdict, naming the caveats explicitly if applicable.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A four-factor scaling readiness verdict (go/no-go/go-with-caveats) with named caveats.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A campaign can have excellent Google Ads metrics and still not be ready to scale if the business behind it can't fulfill the resulting demand — this factor is outside the ads platform but decisive.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Resolve any 'no-go' factor before proceeding, even if the ads-platform metrics look ready
- Re-run before each major scaling step, not just once

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Fulfillment capacity is checked against real business constraints, not assumed unlimited

COMMON MISTAKES

- Scaling budget purely based on strong recent ROAS without checking fulfillment capacity or downstream page readiness

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill exists because Google Ads performance data alone cannot answer a business-capacity question — always pull in 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md for this one specifically.

---

75 Scaling Risk Assessment

OBJECTIVE

Identify the specific ways a scaling decision could go wrong, so risk is managed proactively rather than discovered after the fact.

WHEN TO USE IT

Alongside Skill 74, before a significant, less-reversible scaling commitment.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Scaling plan under consideration
- Historical volatility of the campaign/market

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Proposed scaling plan
- Campaign performance history

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Take the proposed scaling plan.
2. Ask Claude to enumerate specific risk scenarios: auction inflation from increased competition, algorithm relearning disruption, seasonality timing, inventory risk.
3. Assign a rough likelihood and impact to each risk.
4. Recommend mitigations.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *For the attached proposed scaling plan, enumerate the specific ways it could underperform expectations. Consider: (1) auction inflation — will increased spend from us alone, or combined with likely competitor reactions, push CPCs up enough to erode the modeled return; (2) algorithm relearning disruption from the scale of the budget change itself; (3) timing risk — is this scaling push aligned with or against a known seasonal pattern in our historical data; (4) inventory/fulfillment risk if this is ecommerce, or lead capacity risk if this is lead-gen. For each risk, give a rough likelihood (low/medium/high) and potential impact (low/medium/high) and a specific mitigation — for example, phasing the budget increase over weeks instead of days, or setting a stricter monitoring checkpoint. Do not present risks generically; ground each one in this account's actual history or context.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A risk register (Risk / Likelihood / Impact / Mitigation) specific to this scaling plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The value of this Skill is forcing explicit consideration of downside scenarios before committing, not predicting the future precisely.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Build the highest-priority mitigations directly into the phased rollout plan (Skill 67)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every risk is grounded in this account's actual history or stated business context, not a generic risk checklist

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating this as a formality rather than genuinely adjusting the scaling plan based on what it surfaces

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Run this and Skill 74 together as a single go/no-go review before any scaling decision above a meaningful threshold — the readiness assessment answers 'can we,' this one answers 'what could go wrong if we do.'

76 Budget Decrease / Reallocation Decision

OBJECTIVE

Determine when reducing a campaign's budget is the correct call, distinct from simply pausing underperformers — and where that freed budget should go.

WHEN TO USE IT

During any budget reallocation cycle, or when a campaign's performance has structurally declined.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign performance trend
- Reason for potential decline (seasonal, competitive, structural)

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance CSV
- Auction insights if competitive decline is suspected

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Identify campaigns with declining performance or below-break-even economics.
2. Ask Claude to diagnose the likely cause of decline before recommending a budget cut.
3. Recommend a specific reduced budget level, not just 'reduce,' and where the freed budget should be redirected.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached campaign's declining performance trend. Before recommending a budget decrease, diagnose the likely cause: seasonal (expected to recover — a decrease now may be premature), competitive (a new entrant or price change from auction insights — may or may not recover depending on our response), or structural (a genuine, durable decline in demand or fit). For confirmed seasonal declines, recommend holding budget with a note to revisit at the expected recovery point rather than cutting. For competitive or structural declines, recommend a specific reduced budget level (not just 'lower it') based on the campaign's current break-even-consistent spend capacity, and recommend where the freed budget should be redirected using our reallocation logic from Skill 65.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A cause diagnosis (seasonal/competitive/structural) with a specific budget recommendation and redirection target.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Cutting budget on a seasonal decline can mean missing the recovery entirely if nobody revisits the decision at the right time — always pair a seasonal hold with an explicit revisit date.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Set a calendar revisit date for any seasonal hold decision
- Redirect freed budget from structural declines immediately rather than letting it sit idle

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Cause diagnosis is checked against real evidence (seasonality pattern in historical data, auction insights competitor activity) before deciding

COMMON MISTAKES

- Cutting budget reactively on a temporary dip without diagnosing cause first

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is the mirror image of Skill 73 — same underlying discipline (diagnose before acting, model the specific number, redirect deliberately) applied to reduction instead of increase.

---

77 Campaign Pause Decision Framework

OBJECTIVE

Apply a consistent, defensible standard for deciding when a campaign should be paused entirely rather than adjusted.

WHEN TO USE IT

When a campaign has been underperforming for a sustained period despite prior optimization attempts.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign performance history
- History of prior optimization attempts on this campaign
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance CSV (6+ months if available)
- 10-TESTING-LOG.md history for this campaign

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Review the campaign's full performance history and what's already been tried.
2. Ask Claude to check whether the underperformance is due to an untried fix or genuinely exhausted options.
3. Apply a clear pause-or-continue standard tied to break-even economics and time invested.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Assess whether this campaign should be paused. Attached: its performance history and our testing log showing what's already been tried on it (from 10-TESTING-LOG.md). Before recommending a pause, check whether there's a genuinely untried, evidence-backed fix available from any category in this system (structure, keywords, feed, creative, landing page, bidding) that hasn't yet been attempted — if so, recommend that fix first, not a pause. Only recommend pausing if: the campaign has been below break-even per 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md for a sustained period (state the period), multiple reasonable fixes have already been tried per the testing log without recovering it to break-even, and there's no clear remaining lever left to pull. State your reasoning explicitly either way — 'pause' and 'one more fix first' both need a clear justification, not a default.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A pause-or-try-one-more-fix recommendation with explicit reasoning, referencing the testing history.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A pause decision should be the last step in a documented process, not a first reaction to a bad month — that's exactly why the testing log matters here.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- If pausing, redirect the freed budget per Skill 65/76
- If recommending one more fix, specify exactly which Skill/fix and set a review date

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation explicitly references what's already been tried, not just current performance in isolation

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pausing a campaign that's never actually had a real optimization attempt, only left to run unmanaged

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is the reason 10-TESTING-LOG.md matters as an ongoing file, not a one-time exercise — without a record of what's been tried, every pause decision is being made with amnesia.

---

78 Portfolio-Level Budget Prioritization

OBJECTIVE

Rank every campaign in the account by a consistent priority framework, synthesizing marginal return, scaling readiness, and business priority into one view.

WHEN TO USE IT

At the start of each budget planning cycle (monthly or quarterly).

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Outputs from Skills 65, 66, 74 for each active campaign
- 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md strategic priorities

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Prior Category 6 Skill outputs
- 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather marginal ROAS estimates, scaling readiness verdicts, and budget-constraint status for every active campaign.
2. Ask Claude to rank the full portfolio using a combined score of financial return and strategic priority.
3. Produce a single ranked budget-planning document for the cycle.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Synthesize our marginal ROAS estimates, scaling readiness assessments, and budget-constraint status for every active campaign (attached) into one ranked portfolio priority list for this budget cycle. Combine financial return (marginal ROAS, profitability relative to break-even) with strategic priority from our business context (some product lines matter more to the business than pure short-term ROAS would suggest — reflect that explicitly where stated). Produce a single ranked table: Campaign / Marginal ROAS / Scaling Readiness / Strategic Priority / Recommended Budget Direction (increase/hold/decrease) / Recommended Magnitude. This should be the one document that drives this cycle's budget conversation, replacing the need to review each campaign's individual analysis separately.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A single ranked portfolio budget-priority table combining financial and strategic factors for the whole account.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This is the account-wide view that individual campaign analyses (Skills 65-77) all feed into — it should be the actual document used in a budget planning meeting.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Use this as the primary input to the monthly/quarterly budget conversation (see Part 5)
- Re-run every planning cycle, not ad hoc

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Strategic priority weighting is grounded in explicit statements from 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md, not an unstated assumption

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting pure marginal ROAS override every stated strategic priority without acknowledging the trade-off being made

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the Category 6 capstone, playing the same role Skill 14, 40, and 64 play for their categories — one synthesis output that turns many diagnostics into a single decision-ready document.

CATEGORY 7

Reporting and Profit Math

A Google Ads dashboard can tell you what happened. It cannot, on its own, tell you whether it mattered, why it happened, or what to do next. This category is about building that second layer — reports that connect platform metrics to real profit, explain the causes behind a number's movement, and give a specific, financially grounded recommendation rather than just a chart.

79 Weekly Executive Report

OBJECTIVE

Produce a short, decision-focused weekly report that highlights what changed, why, and what needs a decision — not a full metrics dump.

WHEN TO USE IT

Every week, as the standing internal or client-facing summary.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Weekly campaign performance vs. prior week
- Any notable account changes made that week

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Weekly performance export
- Change log for the week

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export this week's performance vs. last week and vs. the same week last month.
2. Note any changes made to the account this week.
3. Ask Claude to write a short report: what changed, why (tie to a specific cause), and what decision (if any) is needed from the reader.
4. Keep it under one page.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write a weekly executive report from the attached performance data (this week vs. last week, and vs. the same week last month) and change log. Structure: (1) one headline sentence on overall account direction; (2) the 2-3 most significant changes in performance, each with a specific cause where identifiable (a change we made, a seasonal pattern, a competitive shift) rather than just restating the number moved; (3) anything that needs a decision from the reader this week, stated as a clear question or option set, not buried in narrative. Keep the whole report under one page. Do not include every metric — only what changed enough to matter or what requires action. Write for someone who has 90 seconds to read this.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A one-page weekly report: headline, 2-3 causally-explained changes, and any decisions needed.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

If nothing meaningfully changed this week, the report should say that in one line — padding a quiet week with restated metrics trains readers to stop reading.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Send consistently on the same day/time each week to build a reliable rhythm
- Escalate any 'decision needed' item outside the report if it's time-sensitive

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every 'cause' stated is a real, checkable cause, not a guess dressed as an explanation

COMMON MISTAKES

- Turning this into a full metrics dashboard export instead of a curated, causal narrative

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The discipline of forcing a cause for every significant change, every week, is what makes this report valuable — it builds the habit of investigation into the reporting cadence itself instead of treating reporting and analysis as separate steps.

---

80 Monthly Performance Report

OBJECTIVE

Provide a comprehensive but still curated monthly view connecting Google Ads performance to broader account health and business context.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, as the standing deeper-dive report beyond the weekly summary.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Monthly performance vs. prior month and prior year
- Key changes/tests run during the month
- Business context updates

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Monthly performance export
- 10-TESTING-LOG.md for the month
- 01-BUSINESS-CONTEXT.md

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export monthly performance with prior-month and prior-year comparisons.
2. Gather the month's tests and changes from the testing log.
3. Ask Claude to write a structured monthly report covering performance, what drove it, what was tested and learned, and what's planned next.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write a monthly performance report using the attached monthly performance data (vs. prior month and prior year), our testing log for the month, and business context. Structure: (1) Performance Summary — key metrics with both prior-month and prior-year comparison, since month-over-month alone can be misleading given seasonality; (2) What Drove It — the 3-5 factors that explain the month's results, tied to specific changes, tests, or external factors, not a generic narrative; (3) What We Tested and Learned — summarize tests run this month and their outcomes per the testing log, including tests that didn't work, since those are also learnings; (4) What's Next — the top priorities for next month based on this month's findings. Keep the tone factual and specific throughout — this report should read as an honest account of what happened, not a highlight reel.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structured monthly report: performance summary, causal drivers, tests and learnings, next month's priorities.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Including tests that didn't work is what makes this report trustworthy over time — a report that only ever shows wins loses credibility and stops surfacing real problems.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Use the 'What's Next' section to directly set next month's weekly workflow priorities

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Prior-year comparison is included wherever seasonality could otherwise mislead a month-over-month read

COMMON MISTAKES

- Omitting failed tests or underperforming periods to make the report look better, which erodes trust and hides real learning

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This report should be boring to write if the weekly reports and testing log have been kept up — it's a synthesis exercise, not a fresh analysis from scratch.

---

81 Agency Client Report

OBJECTIVE

Translate account performance into a client-facing report that demonstrates value clearly without requiring platform expertise to understand.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly or per the agency's client reporting cadence.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Monthly performance data
- Agreed client KPIs
- Work completed this period

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Monthly performance export
- Client KPI agreement
- Work log for the period

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather performance against the specific KPIs this client cares about.
2. List work actually completed this period.
3. Ask Claude to write a client-facing report in plain language, explaining results without jargon and tying work done to results achieved.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write a client-facing monthly report using the attached performance data, our agreed KPIs for this client, and the work completed this period. Write in plain language a non-expert client can follow — avoid unexplained platform jargon (define any technical term you must use, like 'impression share,' in one plain clause). Structure: (1) how we performed against the specific KPIs this client cares about, not a generic metrics list; (2) what we did this period and, where possible, tie each significant action to a specific result — 'we did X, which contributed to Y' rather than presenting work and results as separate, unconnected lists; (3) what we're focused on next period and why. Be honest about any KPI that underperformed — explain why and what we're doing about it, rather than omitting or glossing over it.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A plain-language, KPI-focused client report connecting work done to results achieved, including honest treatment of underperformance.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The action-to-result connection is what separates a report that builds client confidence from one that just lists activity — always make that link explicit.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Review the draft against the client's actual stated priorities before sending, not just the account's own priorities

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No unexplained jargon
- [ ] Underperforming KPIs are addressed honestly, not omitted

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reporting vanity metrics (impressions, clicks) as headline results when the client's actual KPI is a conversion or revenue metric

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

The best agency reports read like a running narrative building client understanding month over month, not a series of disconnected snapshots — where possible, reference last month's stated plan and report against it directly.

---

82 CMO / Founder Summary

OBJECTIVE

Distill account performance into the handful of numbers and decisions a senior stakeholder with limited time actually needs.

WHEN TO USE IT

For board updates, leadership syncs, or any audience with high-level decision authority and low platform familiarity.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Monthly/quarterly performance
- Budget and profitability context
- Any decision requiring leadership sign-off

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Performance summary
- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md profitability figures

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Identify the 3-5 numbers that actually matter at this level (spend, revenue, profit contribution, trend direction).
2. Ask Claude to write a half-page summary in business terms, not platform terms.
3. Include exactly one clear ask or decision point if one exists.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write a half-page CMO/founder-level summary from the attached performance and profitability data. Include only the numbers a senior leader actually needs: total spend, revenue generated, estimated profit contribution (using our margin data, not just ROAS), and the trend direction versus last period. Skip platform-specific metrics (CTR, Quality Score, impression share) entirely unless one of them is the direct cause of a number the leader does care about, in which case reference it briefly in plain language. If there is a decision requiring leadership input or sign-off (e.g., a budget increase, a strategic trade-off), state it as one clear, specific ask with the financial stakes attached — do not bury it in narrative. If there's no decision needed this period, say so plainly rather than manufacturing one.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A half-page summary with 3-5 key numbers in business terms, and one clear decision ask if applicable.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Profit contribution, not ROAS, is the number this audience actually cares about — always translate ROAS into a profit figure using real margin data for this report.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Send ahead of any meeting where sign-off is needed, not during it

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] No platform jargon without immediate plain-language translation
- [ ] Profit figure uses real margin data, not an assumed one

COMMON MISTAKES

- Reporting ROAS as the headline number to an audience that needs to know dollars of profit, not a ratio

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the report most likely to actually get read in full — keep it disciplined about length every single time, even when there's a temptation to add more detail because more happened that period.

---

83 Anomaly Detection

OBJECTIVE

Catch a meaningful, unexplained performance shift as early as possible, before it compounds into a costly trend.

WHEN TO USE IT

As a standing daily or every-few-days check, especially for high-spend accounts.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Daily performance vs. a trailing baseline
- Recent account changes log

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Daily performance export

- Recent change log

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the last 7-14 days of daily performance against a trailing baseline (e.g., prior 30-day average).
2. Ask Claude to flag any metric moving beyond normal day-to-day variance.
3. Cross-check against the change log for an obvious cause.
4. Flag anything unexplained as needing investigation today, not this week.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached daily performance for the last 7-14 days against the trailing 30-day baseline. Flag any metric (spend, CPA, ROAS, conversion volume, CTR) moving beyond what looks like normal day-to-day variance — use the baseline's own volatility range as your reference for 'normal,' not a fixed generic percentage, since accounts vary widely in natural noise. For each flagged anomaly, check the attached change log for an obvious cause (a change we made, a known seasonal event). Anomalies with a clear cause need no further action beyond noting it. Anomalies with no clear cause should be flagged as needing same-day investigation, ranked by dollar impact — do not let an unexplained anomaly sit in a weekly report queue if it's actively costing money right now.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A same-day anomaly flag list (unexplained, ranked by dollar impact) plus a list of explained anomalies needing no action.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

The whole value of this Skill is speed — an anomaly caught on day 2 costs a fraction of the same anomaly caught on day 10.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Investigate the top unexplained anomaly immediately, even outside the normal reporting cadence
- Common root causes to check first: conversion tracking break, a paused/expired promotion, a competitor auction shift, a landing page error

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] 'Normal variance' is calculated from this account's own historical volatility, not assumed

COMMON MISTAKES

- Waiting for the next scheduled weekly report to investigate an anomaly that's actively costing money in real time

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Conversion tracking breaks are one of the most common causes of a sudden, severe anomaly (see Skill 91) — always check tracking health first when a metric moves sharply and suddenly.

---

84 Spend Change Explanation

OBJECTIVE

Explain why total account or campaign spend moved between two periods, decomposing the change into its actual drivers.

WHEN TO USE IT

Whenever spend has shifted meaningfully and needs a clear explanation for a report or stakeholder question.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Spend by campaign for two comparison periods

- CPC, click volume, and budget cap changes

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance for both periods with CPC and clicks broken out

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export spend, CPC, and click volume by campaign for both periods.
2. Ask Claude to decompose the spend change into: CPC change, click volume change, budget cap change, and new/paused campaign effects.
3. Rank drivers by their dollar contribution to the total change.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Decompose the change in total spend between the two attached periods into its actual drivers, using the campaign-level CPC, click volume, and budget data provided. Separate the change into: (1) CPC changes (auction became more/less competitive) multiplied by volume; (2) click volume changes independent of CPC (more/fewer clicks at a similar price); (3) budget cap changes we made deliberately; (4) new campaigns launched or old campaigns paused during the period. Show each driver's dollar contribution to the total spend change, ranked largest first, so the explanation is quantified, not just descriptive. If the drivers don't fully explain the total change, say so explicitly rather than forcing a tidy narrative.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A quantified decomposition of the spend change by driver, ranked by dollar contribution.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A quantified decomposition is far more useful and credible than a narrative explanation — 'CPCs rose' means something different depending on whether that's 80% or 10% of the total change.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Feed the dominant driver into the relevant category's diagnostic Skill (e.g., rising CPC → Skill 68/69/70 bidding review)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Drivers are quantified, not just listed qualitatively
- [ ] Any unexplained residual is stated honestly, not forced to fit

COMMON MISTAKES

- Presenting a single narrative cause when the real change was driven by multiple factors of varying size

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Use this same decomposition method for Skill 85 (revenue change) — the two Skills together let you explain almost any performance report question with real precision instead of hand-waving.

---

85 Revenue Change Explanation

OBJECTIVE

Explain why revenue moved between two periods, decomposing the change into volume, conversion rate, and average order value effects.

WHEN TO USE IT

Whenever revenue has shifted meaningfully and needs a clear explanation.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Conversions, conversion rate, and AOV/deal size for two comparison periods

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign/account performance with conversions, CVR, and AOV for both periods

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export conversions, CVR, and AOV for both periods.
2. Ask Claude to decompose revenue change into: traffic volume effect, conversion rate effect, and AOV effect.
3. Quantify each driver's dollar contribution.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Decompose the change in revenue between the two attached periods into its component drivers: (1) traffic/click volume effect — how much of the revenue change is explained purely by more or fewer clicks, holding conversion rate and AOV constant; (2) conversion rate effect — how much is explained by CVR improving or declining, holding volume and AOV constant; (3) average order value / deal size effect — how much is explained by AOV changes, holding the other two constant. Use a standard decomposition approach (sequential substitution) and show your work. Quantify each driver's dollar contribution to the total revenue change, ranked largest first. If AOV or CVR moved meaningfully, flag it as worth a deeper investigation via the relevant category (Category 5 for CVR, a pricing/offer conversation for AOV) rather than treating the number as self-explanatory.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A quantified volume/CVR/AOV decomposition of the revenue change with follow-up flags.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This decomposition often reveals that a 'good' revenue month was actually driven by an AOV spike unrelated to ads performance, or that a 'bad' month masked a genuine CVR improvement offset by a volume drop — the headline number alone hides this.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Route the dominant driver to the appropriate diagnostic category for deeper investigation

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Decomposition math is shown, not just asserted

COMMON MISTAKES

- Attributing a revenue change entirely to ad performance when AOV (often driven by factors outside the ads account, like a pricing change or a bundle promotion) was the real driver

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Run this alongside Skill 84 for any month with a surprising revenue result — together they usually explain 90%+ of what happened with real precision.

---

86 CPA / ROAS Decomposition

OBJECTIVE

Break down a change in blended CPA or ROAS into its underlying campaign-mix and within-campaign performance effects.

WHEN TO USE IT

When account-level CPA or ROAS shifts but individual campaigns don't seem to have changed much — often a mix-shift effect.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Campaign-level CPA/ROAS and spend share for two periods

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Campaign performance for both periods

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export campaign-level CPA/ROAS and spend share for both periods.
2. Ask Claude to separate the blended metric change into a mix-shift effect (spend moved toward/away from campaigns with different underlying CPA/ROAS) versus a within-campaign performance effect (individual campaigns' own CPA/ROAS changed).
3. Quantify each.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *The blended account CPA/ROAS changed between the two attached periods. Decompose how much of that change is a MIX-SHIFT EFFECT — spend moved toward or away from specific campaigns that have a structurally different CPA/ROAS than the account average, changing the blend even if no individual campaign's own performance changed — versus a WITHIN-CAMPAIGN EFFECT — individual campaigns' own CPA/ROAS genuinely improved or worsened. Show the campaign-level spend share and CPA/ROAS for both periods to support your decomposition. This distinction matters because a mix-shift-driven blended metric change requires a completely different response (a budget allocation conversation) than a within-campaign change (a campaign-specific optimization conversation).*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A mix-shift vs. within-campaign decomposition of the blended CPA/ROAS change, quantified.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A worsening blended CPA that's entirely a mix-shift effect (e.g., a low-CPA campaign got budget-capped, shifting spend to naturally higher-CPA campaigns) is not the same problem as individual campaigns genuinely degrading — don't respond to the two the same way.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Route mix-shift findings to Skill 65 (budget allocation)
- Route within-campaign findings to the specific underperforming campaign's diagnostic Skills

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] The decomposition is quantified, showing the arithmetic, not just asserted

COMMON MISTAKES

- Diagnosing a blended metric change as a performance problem and starting a campaign-level optimization effort when it was actually a mix-shift effect all along

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This decomposition is one of the most common 'aha' moments in an account review — a scary-looking blended ROAS decline often turns out to be entirely explained by budget reallocation decisions already made deliberately elsewhere.

---

87 Break-Even and Contribution Margin Report

OBJECTIVE

Produce a standing reference showing exactly what CPA/ROAS the account needs to hit break-even and target profit, by product line if margins vary.

WHEN TO USE IT

Whenever margin data changes, and as a standing reference document reviewed quarterly.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Product/service margin data
- Fixed and variable cost inputs
- Target profit margin

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md
- 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md margin data

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather margin, average order value, and cost data by product line if it varies.
2. Ask Claude to calculate break-even CPA, break-even ROAS, and target CPA/ROAS (including desired profit margin) per product line.
3. Present as a clean reference table.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Using our margin, AOV, and cost data (attached from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md and 03-PRODUCTS-AND-OFFERS.md), calculate and clearly show your work for: break-even CPA (the maximum we can spend per conversion before losing money, per product line if margins vary meaningfully), break-even ROAS (revenue needed per ad dollar to break even), and target CPA/ROAS that includes our desired profit margin, not just break-even. State the formulas used explicitly (e.g., Break-even ROAS = 1 / Gross Margin %) so the numbers can be independently verified and updated as margins change. Present as a clean reference table by product line, and flag any product line where current or planned ad spend appears to already be operating below break-even.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A break-even/target CPA-ROAS reference table by product line, with formulas shown, and a below-break-even flag where relevant.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This document should be the single source of truth every other Skill in this guide references for break-even figures — keep it current in 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Update whenever margins, costs, or product pricing change meaningfully
- Cross-check every bidding target (Skills 69, 70) against this reference

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Formulas are shown and correct, not just final numbers presented

COMMON MISTAKES

- Calculating break-even from revenue margin alone without accounting for non-COGS costs that also need to be covered (payment processing, fulfillment, overhead) — see the same caution in Skill 70

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the foundational financial document the whole guide's Category 6 and 7 Skills lean on — get it right once, keep it current, and every downstream bidding and reporting Skill becomes more reliable.

---

88 Product-Level Profit Analysis

OBJECTIVE

Calculate actual profit contribution per product from paid traffic, not just revenue or ROAS, to identify which products are genuinely worth their ad spend.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly for ecommerce accounts, especially alongside Shopping feed tiering (Skill 7).

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Product-level ad spend and revenue
- Product-level margin

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Shopping product performance
- Product margin data

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export product-level ad spend and revenue.
2. Combine with margin data to calculate profit contribution per product.
3. Ask Claude to rank products by profit contribution, not revenue or ROAS alone.
4. Flag products with strong ROAS but weak or negative profit due to thin margin.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Calculate profit contribution per product using the attached product-level ad spend, revenue, and margin data: Profit = (Revenue x Gross Margin %) - Ad Spend. Rank products by this profit figure, not by revenue or ROAS alone. Specifically flag any product with strong-looking ROAS but weak or negative actual profit due to thin margin — this is the case a ROAS-only view completely misses. Also flag any product with modest ROAS but strong profit contribution due to healthy margin, which a ROAS-only view might underrate. Present a ranked table: Product / Ad Spend / Revenue / ROAS / Margin % / Profit Contribution, sorted by profit contribution descending.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A product-level profit-ranked table exposing ROAS/profit divergence.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This report routinely reverses the 'winner' product from what a ROAS-only Shopping report would suggest — treat it as a required cross-check before any Shopping budget decision.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Use this ranking, not ROAS ranking, to inform Skill 7's tiering and Skill 34's exclusion decisions

- Run monthly and track profit-contribution trend, not just a single snapshot

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Margin data is real and current per product, not an assumed blended average

COMMON MISTAKES

- Continuing to scale a high-ROAS, thin-margin product because the ROAS number looks good in the standard Shopping report

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is arguably the single most important report in the whole guide for ecommerce accounts — it's the direct, practical answer to the core promise stated in Part 1: waste hides underneath a seemingly acceptable ROAS.

---

89 Budget Waste Estimation

OBJECTIVE

Consolidate all identified waste sources across the account (search terms, low-margin products, fatigued creative, weak landing pages) into one total monthly waste figure.

WHEN TO USE IT

Quarterly, as a capstone synthesis of findings across every category.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Outputs from Skills 15, 34, 46, and relevant Category 5 diagnostics
- Overall account spend

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Relevant prior Skill outputs across categories

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather waste estimates already produced by individual Skills (search term waste, structural low-margin liability, fatigued-creative spend, weak-landing-page-attributable spend).
2. Ask Claude to consolidate into one total, avoiding double-counting overlapping issues.
3. Express as both a dollar figure and a percentage of total spend.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Consolidate the attached waste findings from across our account audits — search term waste, structural low-margin product exclusions, fatigued creative spend, and weak-landing-page-attributable spend — into one total monthly waste estimate. Check carefully for double-counting where the same dollars might be flagged by more than one finding (e.g., a search term waste dollar that's also counted in a weak-landing-page estimate for the same click) and net those out, showing your reasoning. Express the final total both as a dollar figure and as a percentage of total monthly account spend, and break it down by category so it's clear where the largest waste sources are. Compare this percentage against the commonly cited industry range (roughly 25-40% of budget wasted on non-converting clicks in unmanaged accounts) as a rough external reference point only, not a claim about this specific account beyond what our own data shows.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A consolidated, de-duplicated total monthly waste estimate, broken down by category and expressed as a % of spend.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This number is the single most powerful figure for justifying continued investment in the audit-and-optimize process — treat it as a running total that should shrink over successive quarters as fixes are implemented.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Track this figure quarter over quarter as the primary measure of the operating system's impact
- Present it alongside the specific fixes implemented to close the gap

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Double-counting is explicitly checked and reasoned through, not just assumed absent

COMMON MISTAKES

- Simply summing every category's waste estimate without checking for overlap, inflating the true total

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the natural companion figure to Part 3's Money Leak Audit — use this Skill to produce the headline number that audit builds toward.

---

90 Opportunity Cost and Forecasting Report

OBJECTIVE

Model what performance could look like under a specific set of proposed changes, to support prioritization and stakeholder buy-in.

WHEN TO USE IT

When deciding between multiple possible initiatives with limited implementation capacity.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current performance baseline
- A list of candidate initiatives with their individual estimated impact (from relevant Skills)

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Current performance baseline
- Impact estimates from relevant prior Skills

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather estimated impact for each candidate initiative from the Skill that diagnosed it (e.g., Skill 10's budget unlock estimate, Skill 15's waste-elimination estimate).
2. Ask Claude to forecast combined impact if all, or a prioritized subset, were implemented.
3. Account for implementation capacity constraints (can't do everything at once).
4. Recommend a prioritized sequence maximizing impact per unit of effort.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *We have several candidate initiatives with individually estimated impact (attached, from prior audit Skills): [list initiatives and their individual estimated dollar/percentage impact]. Given limited implementation capacity, model the combined forecast impact of implementing a prioritized subset rather than everything at once, being careful not to simply add every individual estimate together — some initiatives may have overlapping impact (e.g., a budget reallocation and a bid strategy fix on the same campaign shouldn't both claim the full independent upside). Recommend a priority sequence that maximizes total impact relative to implementation effort, and forecast expected account performance (spend, revenue, profit) over the next quarter under that sequence versus a 'do nothing further' baseline. State your assumptions explicitly.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A prioritized initiative sequence with a combined-impact forecast versus baseline, assumptions stated explicitly.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Treat this forecast as a planning tool to guide sequencing and stakeholder expectations, not a guarantee — the value is in the relative prioritization it produces, not the precision of the absolute forecast number.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Use the priority sequence to build next quarter's execution roadmap
- Revisit the forecast against actuals in the following quarter's Skill 89 waste-tracking update

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Overlapping impact between initiatives is explicitly addressed, not double-counted

COMMON MISTAKES

- Presenting a forecast as a guarantee to stakeholders rather than a planning estimate with stated assumptions

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill closes the loop between diagnosis (most of this guide) and planning (Part 4/5) — it's the bridge from 'here's what's wrong and what's possible' to 'here's what we're doing next and in what order.'

CATEGORY 8

Measurement, Tracking and Experimentation

Every Skill in this guide assumes the numbers feeding it are trustworthy. That assumption is worth checking explicitly, on a schedule, rather than discovering a tracking gap only after months of decisions were quietly made on bad data. This closing category covers the measurement foundation itself, plus the experimentation discipline that turns Claude's recommendations into verified, not just plausible, improvements.

91 Conversion Tracking Audit

OBJECTIVE

Verify that every conversion action firing in the account is accurate, non-duplicated, and correctly valued before trusting any performance number built on top of it.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before any major analysis or decision, and as a standing quarterly check regardless.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Conversion action list with settings
- Recent conversion volume by action
- Known business conversion volume from CRM/order system for cross-check

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Conversion action settings export
- CRM or order system volume for the same period

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export all conversion actions with their settings (counting method, attribution model, value).
2. Cross-check Google Ads-reported conversion volume against real business records (CRM leads, actual orders) for the same period.
3. Ask Claude to flag discrepancies and configuration red flags.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Audit our conversion tracking setup. Attached: the full conversion action list with settings (counting method — one vs. every, attribution model, assigned value), and our real business conversion volume from CRM/order records for the same period as a cross-check. Flag: (1) any conversion action counted as 'Every' that should logically be 'One' (e.g., a lead form, where counting every submission from the same person could inflate reported volume) or vice versa; (2) any meaningful gap between Google Ads-reported conversions and our real business records — quantify the gap and its likely direction of bias (over- or under-reporting); (3) any conversion action whose assigned value looks stale relative to current AOV/deal size data; (4) any conversion action that appears to be a duplicate of another, double-counting the same real-world event. This audit's finding should be treated as more urgent than any performance optimization finding, since inaccurate tracking undermines every other analysis in the account.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A conversion tracking discrepancy report with configuration flags and a quantified gap vs. real business volume.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Any meaningful gap here should pause other optimization work until resolved — every Skill in this guide that touches CPA, ROAS, or conversion volume inherits whatever error exists here.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix configuration issues immediately, especially counting method mismatches
- Re-run this audit before trusting results from any major account change

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Real business volume cross-check uses genuinely comparable, same-period data

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating tracking review as a one-time setup task rather than an ongoing check, especially after any website, CRM, or checkout platform change

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the highest-priority Skill in the entire guide if it hasn't been run recently — no bidding, budget, or creative optimization is trustworthy on top of broken tracking.

---

92 Primary vs. Secondary Conversion Action Review

OBJECTIVE

Verify that bid strategies are optimizing toward the conversion action that actually represents revenue-driving value, not an easier-to-trigger proxy metric.

WHEN TO USE IT

When multiple conversion actions exist and it's unclear which one bid strategies are actually weighting.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Conversion action list with primary/secondary designation
- Bid strategy conversion goal settings

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Conversion action settings
- Campaign bid strategy goal settings

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the primary/secondary designation for every conversion action and which goal each campaign's bid strategy is optimizing toward.
2. Ask Claude to check whether the primary designation matches actual business value.
3. Flag any bid strategy quietly optimizing toward a soft/secondary action.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached conversion action list and each campaign's bid strategy goal setting. Check whether conversion actions marked PRIMARY (which automated bidding optimizes toward by default) are genuinely the actions with real business value (a purchase, a qualified lead), and whether any soft or low-value action (a newsletter signup, a page-view-based engagement conversion, a call that wasn't verified as qualified) is incorrectly marked primary and quietly steering bidding. Flag any campaign whose bid strategy is optimizing toward a goal that doesn't match the account's actual revenue driver. Recommend the correct primary/secondary configuration per conversion action.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A primary/secondary configuration review with specific reclassification recommendations.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A bid strategy quietly optimizing toward newsletter signups instead of purchases will happily find more newsletter signups — and can look like it's 'working' by its own flawed goal while actual revenue suffers.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix any misconfigured primary designation immediately — this affects live bidding, not just reporting

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation reflects genuine business value, not just conversion volume ease

COMMON MISTAKES

- Marking a high-volume, low-value action as primary because it 'gives the algorithm more data,' without checking whether that data is steering it toward the wrong outcome

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is one of the most consequential and least visible misconfigurations possible — it doesn't throw an error, it just quietly optimizes for the wrong thing, indefinitely, until someone checks.

---

93 Duplicate Conversion Detection

OBJECTIVE

Identify conversion actions or tracking setups double-counting the same real-world event, inflating reported performance.

WHEN TO USE IT

When reported conversion volume seems higher than plausible relative to real business volume, or after adding a new tracking tag/pixel.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- All active conversion actions and their sources
- Recent conversion volume by action

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Conversion action list with source/tag details

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. List every active conversion action and its tracking source (website tag, imported from CRM, phone call tracking, etc.).
2. Ask Claude to identify pairs of actions likely tracking the same underlying event.
3. Recommend which to keep as the source of truth and which to deactivate or mark secondary.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached list of active conversion actions and their tracking sources. Identify any pair or group of conversion actions that likely track the same real-world event from different sources — for example, a website purchase conversion firing alongside an imported CRM 'order confirmed' conversion for the same transaction, or a call tracking conversion overlapping with a website form conversion for the same lead. For each identified overlap, recommend which single action should serve as the source of truth for bidding (typically the most direct, real-time, and accurate source) and which should be deactivated, marked secondary, or clearly labeled to avoid being summed into total conversion counts.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A duplicate-conversion overlap list with a source-of-truth recommendation per overlap.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Duplicate conversions inflate reported CPA/ROAS favorably, which is dangerous precisely because it looks like good news — always verify total conversion volume against real business records (Skill 91) as the check on this.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Deactivate or reclassify the redundant action promptly
- Re-verify reported vs. real business volume after the fix

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation identifies genuine duplication of the same event, not two related but distinct events

COMMON MISTAKES

- Deactivating a conversion action that's actually tracking a distinct, valid secondary event rather than a true duplicate

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill and Skill 91 should be run together — duplication is one of the most common specific causes of the volume discrepancy Skill 91 is built to catch.

---

94 Enhanced Conversions Implementation Review

OBJECTIVE

Confirm Enhanced Conversions (or equivalent first-party matching) is correctly implemented to recover conversion visibility lost to browser privacy restrictions.

WHEN TO USE IT

When conversion tracking coverage seems to be declining over time, or during any tracking infrastructure review.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current Enhanced Conversions implementation status
- Conversion tracking coverage trend over time

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Enhanced Conversions diagnostics from Google Ads
- Conversion volume trend

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Check Enhanced Conversions implementation status per conversion action.
2. Ask Claude to assess whether missing or partial implementation could explain any declining tracking coverage trend.
3. Recommend implementation priority.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review our Enhanced Conversions implementation status (attached diagnostics) alongside our conversion volume trend over time. Assess whether gaps or partial implementation in Enhanced Conversions could plausibly explain any declining tracking coverage we're seeing, given the broader industry trend of browser privacy restrictions reducing standard cookie-based tracking accuracy. Prioritize which conversion actions most need Enhanced Conversions implemented or fixed, based on their spend and business importance. Note that Enhanced Conversions implementation is a technical, first-party-data-matching setup task, not a Google Ads settings change alone — flag if it likely requires development resources to fully implement correctly (e.g., server-side tagging, hashed customer data passthrough).*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

An Enhanced Conversions coverage assessment with an implementation priority list.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Declining tracking coverage over time, even with a stable real business conversion rate, is often a signal-loss problem rather than a performance problem — always check this before concluding performance has genuinely declined.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Prioritize implementation for the highest-spend conversion actions first
- Loop in development resources early given the technical implementation requirement

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Recommendation distinguishes a genuine performance decline from a tracking-coverage decline

COMMON MISTAKES

- Diagnosing a coverage-driven reported decline as a genuine performance problem and chasing the wrong fix in bidding or creative

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is a good pairing with Skill 83 (anomaly detection) — a gradual, account-wide decline in reported conversions with no single clear cause is a classic signature of a tracking coverage problem, not a performance one.

---

95 Attribution Model Review

OBJECTIVE

Confirm the account's attribution model reflects the actual customer journey, and understand how switching models would change reported campaign performance.

WHEN TO USE IT

When channels or campaigns further up the funnel seem to be getting little credit despite plausibly contributing to conversions.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Current attribution model setting
- Multi-touch conversion path data if available

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Attribution settings export
- Conversion path/assisted conversion report

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Review the current attribution model and the typical length/complexity of conversion paths.
2. Ask Claude to assess whether the current model fits the actual customer journey.
3. Model how campaign-level performance would look different under an alternative model, using assisted conversion data.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review our current attribution model setting against the attached conversion path data (showing typical path length and touchpoints before conversion). Assess whether the current model fits our actual customer journey — a data-driven or position-based model is generally more appropriate than last-click for longer, multi-touch paths, while last-click can be reasonable for short, simple paths. Using the assisted conversions report, estimate how campaign-level 'credit' would shift under an alternative model — specifically flag any upper-funnel or brand-awareness campaign that appears to be under-credited by the current model despite showing up meaningfully in assisted conversion paths. Recommend whether a model change is warranted, and if so, note that changing models will shift reported historical comparisons, which should be flagged to stakeholders in advance.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

An attribution model fit assessment with an estimated before/after campaign-credit comparison and a change recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

An upper-funnel campaign that looks weak under last-click attribution but shows strong assisted-conversion presence may be underfunded for the wrong reason — this is a common, costly misreading.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- If changing models, communicate the reporting discontinuity to stakeholders before it appears in the next report
- Re-run Skill 65 budget allocation with the new attribution view

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Estimated credit shift is grounded in real assisted-conversion path data, not a generic assumption about attribution models

COMMON MISTAKES

- Cutting an upper-funnel campaign's budget based on weak last-click performance without checking its assisted-conversion contribution first

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Attribution model choice interacts directly with Skill 65's marginal ROAS estimation — always confirm which attribution lens is being used before comparing marginal return across campaigns at different funnel stages.

---

96 Conversion Lag Analysis

OBJECTIVE

Quantify the typical time between click and conversion so performance reads and testing windows account for it correctly, instead of judging recent days prematurely.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before setting any test's minimum runtime, and when evaluating very recent performance changes.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Historical conversion path data with time-to-conversion

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Conversion time-lag report (Google Ads provides this by conversion action)

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export the conversion lag report by conversion action.
2. Ask Claude to summarize the typical and long-tail lag window.
3. Translate this into a minimum reliable reporting window for each conversion action.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Summarize the attached conversion lag data by conversion action: what share of conversions happen same-day, within 3 days, within 7 days, and within 30 days of the initial click. Translate this into a practical guideline: what is the minimum number of days after a change or test launch before performance data for each conversion action can be considered reasonably complete and reliable, rather than still accumulating delayed conversions that would understate true performance. Flag any conversion action with an unusually long lag tail (common for high-consideration B2B or big-ticket purchases) that requires special caution in short-window reporting or testing.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A per-conversion-action lag summary with a recommended minimum reliable reporting window.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

Judging a bid strategy change, a new ad, or a landing page test on data from the last 2-3 days is one of the most common sources of a false negative or false positive read, especially for longer-consideration purchases.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Apply the recommended minimum window to every future test plan (Skill 37, 52) and reallocation phase (Skill 67)

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Guideline is based on this account's own real lag data, not a generic assumption

COMMON MISTAKES

- Declaring a test result or reacting to a performance dip using only the most recent 2-3 days of data when the account's typical lag is a week or more

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is a foundational input other Skills should reference — once calculated, treat the minimum reliable window as a standing account parameter, not something to re-derive every time.

---

97 Offline Conversion Import Review

OBJECTIVE

Verify offline conversions (phone sales, in-person purchases, closed-won CRM deals) are being imported accurately and completely, closing the loop between ad clicks and real revenue.

WHEN TO USE IT

For any business with a meaningful offline or delayed sales cycle component.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Offline conversion import settings and volume
- CRM closed-deal volume for the same period

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Offline conversion import log
- CRM export for the same period

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export offline conversion import volume and settings.
2. Compare against real CRM closed-deal volume for the same period.
3. Ask Claude to identify gaps — deals that should have imported but didn't, or import lag issues.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review our offline conversion import setup. Attached: the import log and our real CRM closed-deal data for the same period. Compare imported conversion volume and value against actual CRM closed-deal volume and value, and quantify any gap. Investigate likely causes for gaps: GCLID capture failures at lead intake (the click ID not being stored and passed through to the CRM), import timing/frequency issues, or deals closing through a channel that doesn't capture the GCLID at all (e.g., phone leads without call tracking). Recommend specific fixes prioritized by the dollar value of deals currently not being reflected back into Google Ads, since incomplete offline import directly starves Smart Bidding of the very high-value conversion signal it needs most.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

An offline conversion import gap analysis with a quantified dollar impact and prioritized fixes.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

This gap is especially costly because it's invisible in Google Ads reporting by definition — the missing conversions never show up to trigger a red flag; they just quietly never get counted.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Fix GCLID capture at the point of lead intake first, since it's usually the root cause
- Backfill historical offline conversions where possible once the pipeline is fixed

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Comparison uses genuinely matched CRM data for the same period and deal-close definition

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming offline import is working correctly because it was set up once, without periodically reconciling against real CRM volume

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

For B2B and high-consideration sales accounts, this is arguably as important as Skill 91 — bidding strategies are only as good as the revenue signal they're given, and offline conversions are often the majority of real value for these businesses.

---

98 Experiment Design and Prioritization

OBJECTIVE

Turn a backlog of testing ideas from across every category into a prioritized, properly designed experimentation queue.

WHEN TO USE IT

Monthly, to plan the next testing cycle from accumulated ideas.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Testing ideas generated by other Skills throughout the month
- Available testing capacity/bandwidth

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- 10-TESTING-LOG.md backlog section

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather all pending test ideas logged during the month.
2. Ask Claude to score each by expected impact and design confidence.
3. Sequence into next cycle's testing queue given available bandwidth.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Review the attached backlog of test ideas accumulated this month from across our account work. For each, assess: expected impact (how much could this plausibly move the needle, based on the evidence that generated the idea), design confidence (is there a clear, testable hypothesis and success metric, or does the idea need more definition before it's ready to test), and estimated effort/bandwidth required. Score and rank the backlog, then recommend which tests to run next cycle given our stated available bandwidth [state capacity, e.g., '2 tests per month']. For lower-confidence ideas not ready yet, note what additional definition they need before they can be prioritized.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked, bandwidth-constrained testing queue with clarity flags for underdeveloped ideas.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A prioritized queue prevents the common failure mode where whoever's loudest or most recent gets tested next, regardless of actual expected value.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Commit to the ranked queue for the cycle rather than reordering ad hoc
- Move underdeveloped ideas back to the relevant diagnostic Skill for more definition before re-submitting

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Ranking reflects both impact and design confidence, not impact alone — a huge but poorly-defined idea shouldn't jump the queue over a well-designed, moderate one

COMMON MISTAKES

- Running whichever test is easiest to implement rather than the one with the best expected value

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This Skill is what makes 10-TESTING-LOG.md a living planning tool rather than just a historical record — review and re-prioritize the backlog every single month.

---

99 Statistical Confidence Check

OBJECTIVE

Determine whether a test result has reached a reliable enough sample size to act on, before declaring a winner or reverting a change.

WHEN TO USE IT

At every test review checkpoint, before making a keep/revert/extend decision.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Test variant performance data (conversions, sample size per variant)

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Test results export with per-variant conversion counts

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Export conversion counts and rates per test variant.
2. Ask Claude to assess whether the observed difference is likely to be a real effect or could plausibly be noise given the current sample size.
3. Recommend extend, conclude, or inconclusive-stop.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Assess the statistical reliability of this test result. Attached: conversion counts and rates per variant. Given the sample sizes involved, evaluate whether the observed difference between variants is large enough, relative to typical variance at this sample size, to be reasonably confident it reflects a real effect rather than random noise — explain your reasoning in plain terms rather than just citing a p-value without context. State clearly whether: the result looks reliable enough to conclude and act on; the test needs more time/volume to reach a reliable read, and estimate roughly how much more; or the effect size is small enough that even with more data it may not be practically meaningful even if statistically detectable. Recommend the specific next action.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A plain-language statistical reliability assessment with a clear next-action recommendation.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A test that 'looks like it's working' after a few days at low volume is the single most common way accounts convince themselves of a false positive — this check exists specifically to prevent that.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- Follow the recommendation mechanically — extend if the data says extend, even if the early trend looked exciting
- Log the final, confidence-checked result in 10-TESTING-LOG.md

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Explanation is in plain terms an account manager can actually use to make a decision, not raw statistical jargon

COMMON MISTAKES

- Concluding a test as soon as one variant is nominally ahead, without checking whether the sample size supports that conclusion

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

Pair this Skill with Skill 96's conversion lag findings — a technically large-enough click sample can still be an unreliable conversion-rate read if not enough time has passed for lagged conversions to arrive.

100 Test Postmortem and Learning Documentation

OBJECTIVE

Capture what was actually learned from every concluded test — including failed ones — in a form future analysis can reuse, instead of letting the learning evaporate.

WHEN TO USE IT

Immediately after every test reaches a confidence-checked conclusion.

REQUIRED INPUTS

- Test hypothesis and design
- Final confidence-checked result from Skill 99

FILES / REPORTS NEEDED

- Test design record
- Skill 99 output

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Gather the original hypothesis and the final result.
2. Ask Claude to write a short postmortem: what we expected, what happened, why (best available explanation), and what this changes going forward.
3. Log it in 10-TESTING-LOG.md in a consistent, searchable format.

CLAUDE PROMPT (copy-paste ready)

> *Write a short test postmortem for the attached concluded test (original hypothesis, design, and confidence-checked final result). Structure: (1) What we expected and why; (2) What actually happened, stated factually; (3) Best available explanation for the result, including if the explanation is 'we're not sure why' — don't force a just-so story if the data doesn't clearly support one; (4) What this changes going forward — a specific action, a new hypothesis for a follow-up test, or an explicit 'no further action, this line of testing is closed.' Write this the same way whether the test succeeded, failed, or was inconclusive — the format and rigor should not depend on whether the result was good news.*

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structured, consistently-formatted test postmortem ready for 10-TESTING-LOG.md.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE OUTPUT

A documented failed test has real value — it prevents the same idea from being re-tested from scratch a year later by someone who's forgotten it was already tried.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- File in 10-TESTING-LOG.md immediately, don't let it sit undocumented
- Reference this postmortem the next time a related idea surfaces in Skill 98's prioritization

VALIDATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] Explanation for the result is honest about uncertainty rather than forcing a confident narrative the data doesn't support

COMMON MISTAKES

- Only documenting tests that succeeded, leaving failed tests undocumented and vulnerable to being repeated

ADVANCED EXPERT NOTES

This is the Skill that makes the entire weekly/monthly operating system compound over time rather than reset every cycle — treat a consistently maintained testing log as one of the most valuable long-term assets this whole system produces.

PART 3

The Google Ads Money Leak Audit

A structured diagnostic across every area where budget quietly disappears.

The Google Ads Money Leak Audit is a single, structured diagnostic pass across every area where budget commonly disappears without showing up as an obvious problem. It is not a replacement for the 100 Skills in Part 2 — it is the map that tells you which Skills to run first, and it is the framework behind Skill 1 (Full Account Audit) and Skill 89 (Budget Waste Estimation).

Every area below uses the same structure: what to check, the warning signals that indicate a leak, the data required, how Claude should analyze it, how to estimate the financial impact, and how to prioritize the finding using the P0–P3 system.

Priority System - P0 — Immediate financial risk. Actively losing money right now; fixable within days. Examples: a disapproved bestseller, a broken conversion tag, brand cannibalization. - P1 — High-impact optimization. Clear, quantifiable upside; fixable within 1-2 weeks. Examples: search term waste, a budget-constrained high-ROAS campaign, weak message match on a high-spend ad group. - P2 — Medium-term opportunity. Real value, but requires more structural work or cross-functional coordination. Examples: a full account restructure, a feed taxonomy overhaul, a pricing/offer strength gap. - P3 — Testing opportunity. Worth exploring, unproven. Examples: a new creative angle, an unvalidated audience expansion, a speculative keyword theme.

Traffic Quality

What to check: Whether the clicks arriving are the right clicks — matching real purchase or lead intent for what you sell.

Warning signals:

- High CTR but low CVR across multiple ad groups
- Search terms with recurring low-intent language (free, DIY, jobs, definitions)
- Growing spend with flat or declining conversion volume

Data required: Search term report, Keyword performance by intent

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 19 (Low-Intent Traffic Detection) and Skill 20 (Intent Classification) together to quantify spend by intent tier.

Estimated financial impact: Sum of spend tied to confirmed low-intent patterns over a 30-day window.

Priority: P1 for confirmed patterns with clear evidence; P2 if patterns are ambiguous and need more data.

Keyword Waste

What to check: Whether the keyword portfolio itself is bloated, redundant, or under-competing.

Warning signals:

- Many keywords with near-zero impressions
- Duplicate keywords across ad groups/campaigns
- Chronically paused keywords never cleaned up

Data required: Full keyword list with 90-day history

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 27 (Portfolio Pruning) and Skill 22 (Cannibalization Check).

Estimated financial impact: Estimated CPC inflation from cannibalization, plus management-time cost of clutter (qualitative).

Priority: P2 — real but rarely urgent; schedule quarterly.

Search Term Waste

What to check: Whether spend is going to search terms that never had, or have stopped having, any real relevance to what you sell.

Warning signals:

- Search term report shows unreviewed terms accumulating spend with zero conversions
- No negative keyword list update in the last 30+ days

Data required: Search term report, 30-60 days

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 15 (Waste Audit) directly — this is the fastest, highest-confidence P0/P1 finding available in most accounts.

Estimated financial impact: Total spend on terms classified irrelevant, projected monthly.

Priority: P0 if the irrelevant-term total exceeds roughly 5% of monthly spend; P1 otherwise.

Campaign Structure

What to check: Whether the account's architecture supports clean budget control and bid signal quality, or fragments both.

Warning signals:

- Many campaigns under the Smart Bidding conversion-volume threshold
- Brand and non-brand not separated
- No clear logic behind campaign groupings

Data required: Full campaign list, structure export

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 1 (Full Account Audit) and Skill 3 (Complexity Audit).

Estimated financial impact: Harder to quantify directly — estimate via the CPA improvement typically seen after consolidating underpowered campaigns (reference the campaign's own historical CPA at higher volume periods, if any).

Priority: P2 — structural fixes take longer but compound.

Budget Allocation

What to check: Whether budget sits where marginal return is highest, or just where it has historically sat.

Warning signals:

- Strong-performing campaigns showing meaningful impression share lost to budget
- Weak-performing campaigns fully funded with no impression share loss

Data required: Campaign performance with impression share lost to budget

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 10 (Budget Fragmentation) and Skill 65 (Budget Allocation Review).

Estimated financial impact: Modeled incremental revenue/profit from unlocking constrained, high-marginal-ROAS campaigns (Skill 65's output).

Priority: P1 — usually one of the fastest, highest-confidence wins in the whole audit.

Bidding

What to check: Whether bid strategies and their targets match the account's real data volume and current margins.

Warning signals:

- Target CPA/ROAS campaigns with fewer than ~30 conversions/month
- Targets that haven't been revisited despite a known margin change
- Manual CPC on high-volume, stable campaigns

Data required: Bid strategy settings, conversion volume history

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 68 (Bidding Strategy Review) and Skill 69/70 (Target CPA/ROAS Diagnostics).

Estimated financial impact: Volume suppression estimate for over-tight targets; margin-capture estimate for over-loose targets.

Priority: P1 for confirmed mismatches on high-spend campaigns.

Creative

What to check: Whether ad copy and visual assets are fatigued, generic, or misaligned with the intent of the traffic they serve.

Warning signals:

- Declining CTR with no external explanation
- RSAs dominated by redundant headline angles
- Creative unchanged for 90+ days on high-spend ad groups

Data required: Ad-level performance trend, asset performance ratings

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 46 (Ad Fatigue Detection) and Skill 41 (RSA Diagnostic).

Estimated financial impact: Spend on fatigued, high-decline ads over the trailing 30 days.

Priority: P1 for high-spend fatigued ads; P3 for proactive refresh testing.

Shopping Feed

What to check: Whether the product feed is accurate, complete, and optimized for how customers actually search.

Warning signals:

- Merchant Center disapprovals or warnings on top-tier products
- Generic or truncated titles
- Products missing from the feed entirely

Data required: Merchant Center diagnostics, product feed export, full catalog for comparison

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 28 (Feed Audit) and Skill 35 (Feed Gap Detection).

Estimated financial impact: Estimated visibility/revenue impact of disapproved or missing tier-1 products.

Priority: P0 for disapprovals on tier-1 products; P1 for title/description quality gaps.

Landing Pages

What to check: Whether the destination experience matches the promise and intent of the ad that generated the click.

Warning signals:

- Weak CVR despite strong CTR and reasonable traffic quality
- High-spend ad groups routing to a generic page
- Mobile CVR meaningfully below desktop

Data required: Landing page performance report, screenshots

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 53 (Message Match) and Skill 64 (Conversion Readiness Score).

Estimated financial impact: CVR gap between the flagged page and a comparable well-matched page, applied to the flagged page's traffic volume.

Priority: P1 for high-spend, low-scoring pages.

Offer

What to check: Whether the underlying deal is competitive enough to convert well-matched, well-targeted traffic.

Warning signals:

- Strong page score but still weak CVR
- Offer meaningfully weaker than named competitors for a comparable ask

Data required: Offer details, competitor offer comparison

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 59 (Offer Strength Assessment).

Estimated financial impact: Difficult to quantify directly; treat as a strategic flag requiring cross-functional input rather than a Google Ads fix.

Priority: P2 — escalate to pricing/product stakeholders.

Tracking

What to check: Whether the numbers driving every other finding in this audit are themselves accurate.

Warning signals:

- Google Ads conversion volume diverges from real CRM/order data
- No Enhanced Conversions implementation
- Primary conversion action doesn't match real business value

Data required: Conversion action settings, CRM/order volume for cross-check

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 91 (Conversion Tracking Audit) — always run this first, before trusting any other finding in this audit.

Estimated financial impact: Quantified gap between reported and real conversion volume/value.

Priority: P0, unconditionally — every other finding in this audit inherits this risk.

Profitability

What to check: Whether apparent performance (ROAS, revenue) translates into real profit given actual margins.

Warning signals:

- Strong ROAS on thin-margin product lines
- Blended account ROAS relies heavily on brand traffic
- No current break-even reference documented

Data required: Product/campaign-level margin data, break-even figures

Claude analysis method: Run Skill 87 (Break-Even Report) and Skill 88 (Product-Level Profit Analysis).

Estimated financial impact: Gap between reported revenue-based performance and true profit-based performance.

Priority: P0 for any product/campaign found operating below break-even; P1 otherwise.

PART 4

Weekly Google Ads Operating System

One folder. One structure. One repeatable workflow. Used every week.

A Google Ads account does not stay optimized — it drifts. Search terms accumulate, creative fatigues, budgets stay pinned to where they were last quarter. The weekly operating system exists to catch drift early and cheaply, before it compounds into a quarter of quietly wasted spend. Below are four versions of the same weekly rhythm, scaled to the time you actually have.

The Standard Weekly Schedule

Day	Focus	Skills Used	Why
MONDAY	Performance and Anomaly Review	Skill 83 (Anomaly Detection), Skill 79 (Weekly Executive Report draft)	Catch anything that moved unexpectedly over the weekend before it compounds through the week.
TUESDAY	Search Terms and Keyword Waste	Skill 15 (Search Term Waste Audit), Skill 16 (Negative Keyword Creation), Skill 17 (Keyword Expansion)	The highest-frequency, highest-ROI recurring task in the whole system.
WEDNESDAY	Creative and Landing Page Analysis	Skill 46 (Ad Fatigue Detection), Skill 53 (Message Match Audit) as needed	Check whether the messaging and destination experience are still earning their spend.
THURSDAY	Bidding and Budget Decisions	Skill 65 (Budget Allocation Review), Skill 68/69/70 (Bid Strategy/Target Diagnostics) as needed	React to the week's data with deliberate, phased changes — never same-day panic edits.
FRIDAY	Reporting and Experiment Planning	Skill 79 (Weekly Executive Report, finalized), Skill 98 (Experiment Prioritization)	Close the loop: report what happened, and queue next week's tests.

15-Minute Version

Who it's for: Solo operators or founders managing their own account alongside everything else.

Focus: Search term waste review only, every week, without exception. Everything else runs on a lighter monthly cadence instead of weekly.

Claude Prompt:

> *Run a fast search term waste check. Attached: this week's search term report and our break-even CPA. In under 15 minutes of my time, give me only the terms with spend above break-even CPA and zero conversions, grouped into negative keyword themes ready to upload. Skip everything else — no full audit, no commentary, just the actionable negative list and the total dollar amount it will stop from leaking.*

30-Minute Version

Who it's for: A marketer managing 1-3 accounts with modest time per account per week.

Focus: Search term waste plus a fast anomaly check. Budget/bidding/creative reviewed every other week rather than weekly.

Claude Prompt:

> *Run our standard 30-minute weekly check. Attached: this week's search term report, daily performance for anomaly detection, and last week's change log. First, give me the search term waste list per our standard classification. Second, flag any metric moving outside normal variance with no clear cause from the change log. Keep the whole output to what I can act on in the next 30 minutes — prioritize by dollar impact, cut anything below a meaningful threshold.*

60-Minute Version

Who it's for: A dedicated in-house Google Ads manager running the full weekly schedule above.

Focus: The complete Monday-through-Friday schedule, compressed into roughly 60 minutes of total Claude-assisted work spread across the week (not 60 minutes in one sitting).

Claude Prompt:

> *This is our Wednesday creative and landing page check as part of the full weekly schedule. Attached: this week's ad-level performance trend and landing page performance for our top 5 ad groups by spend. Run the ad fatigue check and flag any landing page whose CVR has dropped notably from its own recent baseline. Keep this focused — this is a weekly maintenance check, not a full Category 4/5 audit; flag anything that looks like it needs a deeper Skill run and note which one.*

Advanced Agency Version

Who it's for: Agencies managing multiple client accounts needing a scalable, standardized weekly process.

Focus: The full weekly schedule run per account, with an added Friday step: a client-ready summary using Skill 81, plus a cross-account pattern check for the agency's own operational learning.

Claude Prompt:

> *Run our full agency weekly workflow for [Client Name]. Attached: this week's full performance exports across all the standard categories, our change log, and our client's specific KPI agreement. Execute the standard Monday-Friday sequence (anomaly check, search term review, creative/landing page check, bidding/budget review), then produce the client-facing weekly summary per our Skill 81 format. Separately, note anything from this account's findings that might be a useful pattern to check across our other client accounts this week.*

PART 5

Monthly Strategic Review

Zoom out from weekly maintenance to portfolio-level strategy.

The monthly review operates at a different altitude than the weekly workflow. Weekly work catches drift; the monthly review checks whether the account's overall strategy is still the right one — whether budget is flowing to the right places at the portfolio level, whether the testing program is actually compounding, and whether it's time for a bigger structural move than any single week's maintenance would surface.

Component	Skills Used	Purpose
Account Trend Review	Skill 80 (Monthly Performance Report)	Zoom out from weekly noise to the month's real trend, with prior-year context.
Profitability Review	Skill 87 (Break-Even Report), Skill 88 (Product-Level Profit Analysis)	Confirm reported performance still translates into real profit under current margins.
Campaign Portfolio Review	Skill 78 (Portfolio-Level Budget Prioritization)	Rank the full account by marginal return and strategic priority for the coming month.
Search Term Trend Review	Skill 26 (Search Term Trend Analysis)	Catch emerging or declining demand patterns before they show up as a surprise next month.
Creative Trend Review	Skill 46/47 (Fatigue Detection, text and visual)	Plan the next creative production cycle proactively rather than reactively.
Feed Performance Review	Skill 40 (Feed Prioritization Framework)	Consolidate the month's feed findings into one resourced action plan.
Landing Page Performance Review	Skill 64 (Conversion Readiness Score)	Re-score any page that received a fix this month and compare against baseline.
Budget Reallocation	Skill 65/67 (Allocation Review and Rebalancing Plan)	Execute the month's phased budget moves based on the portfolio review.
Testing Roadmap	Skill 98 (Experiment Prioritization)	Set next month's testing queue from the accumulated backlog.
Scaling Opportunities	Skill 73/74/75 (Budget-Limited Analysis, Scaling Readiness, Scaling Risk)	Identify and vet the strongest scaling candidate for the coming month.

PART 6

Advanced Workflows

How this system changes across business models.

Ecommerce

Shopping and Performance Max typically carry the majority of spend, which makes Category 3 (Shopping Feed and Product Titles) and product-level profit analysis (Skill 88) the highest-leverage recurring work. Prioritize the feed audit and product tiering (Skills 7, 28, 33) before deep Search copy work. Landing page diagnosis centers on the PDP (Skill 62) rather than a lead-gen form. Break-even math should be calculated per product line, not account-wide, since margin varies significantly across most ecommerce catalogs.

SaaS

Conversion often happens in stages (trial signup, then paid conversion, then expansion) — make sure the primary conversion action (Skill 92) reflects the stage that actually represents committed revenue, not just a top-of-funnel signup. LTV (from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md) matters more here than almost any other vertical, since first-touch CAC is frequently well above a single month's revenue and only makes sense against a longer payback period. Offline/CRM conversion import (Skill 97) is often essential if sales-assisted deals close outside the website.

Lead Generation

Form friction (Skill 60) and lead-gen landing page review (Skill 63) are typically the highest-leverage Category 5 work. Lead quality, not just lead volume, needs to feed back into bidding — if possible, import a lead-quality or closed-won signal via offline conversions (Skill 97) so Smart Bidding optimizes toward qualified leads, not just form fills. Objection-handling copy (Skill 50) is especially valuable given the personal-information hesitation inherent in any form-based conversion.

Agencies

Standardize the weekly and monthly workflows across every client account using the same ten context files and the same Skill sequence, so the system scales with account count instead of requiring bespoke process per client. Client reporting (Skill 81) should run from the same underlying account work as the internal reports, translated for the audience rather than rebuilt from scratch. Cross-account pattern recognition (noting a finding from one account that might apply to others) becomes a genuine efficiency advantage at scale.

High-Ticket Services

Conversion lag (Skill 96) is typically longer and more consequential here than in any other vertical — sales cycles can run weeks or months, so testing windows and performance reads need to account for a much longer lag tail than the platform default assumption. Trust signal strength (Skill 57) and offer clarity around what happens after a lead converts (Skill 63) carry outsized weight given the size of the commitment being asked. Break-even math should typically be built around LTV/deal value rather than a single transaction, since one high-ticket close can justify a CPA that would look unreasonable evaluated on ad spend alone.

PART 7

Master Prompts

Large, exceptionally detailed prompts for the most common high-value sessions.

1. Full Google Ads Account Audit — Master Prompt

You are conducting a complete Google Ads account audit for [Business Name]. I am attaching: 90-day campaign performance (daily), ad group performance, keyword performance, the search term report, conversion action settings, and our business context, product/offer, and conversion economics files (01, 03, 05). Do not assume the account is well-managed — verify everything. Work through this sequence: (1) Conversion tracking sanity check — does reported conversion volume look plausible given the business context provided; flag anything suspicious before proceeding, since every subsequent finding depends on trustworthy data. (2) Spend concentration and structure — is spend distributed in a way that maps to business priority and margin; flag any structural fragmentation issue. (3) Search term waste — total spend on non-converting, irrelevant search terms over the last 30-60 days, with a ready-to-upload negative keyword list. (4) Budget allocation — any high-performing campaign meaningfully constrained by budget, with a modeled upside. (5) Bidding strategy fit — any campaign whose bid strategy or target doesn't match its data volume or current margins. (6) Profitability check — using our margin data, identify any campaign or product line operating below break-even despite acceptable ROAS. For every finding, state the estimated monthly dollar impact and assign a priority using this system: P0 = immediate financial risk, fixable within days; P1 = high-impact optimization, fixable within 1-2 weeks; P2 = medium-term structural opportunity; P3 = testing opportunity, unproven. Output a single ranked findings table (Finding / Evidence / Est. Monthly $ Impact / Priority / Recommended Action), followed by a 5-item maximum list of what to do this week. Do not pad the list with minor findings to make it look thorough — a short, high-confidence list is more valuable than a long one.

2. Weekly Google Ads Optimization — Master Prompt

Run our standard weekly optimization pass. Attached: this week's daily performance, this week's search term report, the current negative keyword list, and last week's change log. Execute in this order: (1) Anomaly check — flag anything moving outside normal variance with no explanation in the change log; (2) Search term waste — classify non-converting terms above our break-even threshold into irrelevant / relevant-but-unprofitable / under-tested, and produce a ready-to-upload negative keyword list for the irrelevant bucket, checked against our existing negatives for duplicates; (3) Keyword expansion — any converting search term not yet added as its own exact-match keyword, ranked by conversion volume; (4) One-paragraph summary for our weekly report: what changed this week, why, and what (if anything) needs a decision. Keep total output focused and actionable — this is a maintenance pass, not a full audit.

3. Search Term Waste — Master Prompt

Analyze the attached search term report (last 30-60 days) against our break-even CPA from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md. For every search term with spend above 1.5x break-even CPA and zero conversions, classify as: IRRELEVANT (unrelated to what we sell — exclude outright), RELEVANT BUT UNPROFITABLE (matches real intent but isn't converting — flag for landing page/offer review, do not exclude), or UNDER-TESTED (too little spend to conclude yet). Group irrelevant terms into negative keyword themes with recommended match type and application level (shared list vs. campaign-level), checked against our existing negative list for duplicates. Sum total monthly waste in the irrelevant bucket. Do not classify a term as irrelevant solely because it failed to convert — intent and profitability are different questions, and conflating them either over-excludes legitimate traffic or under-excludes genuine waste.

4. Ecommerce Shopping Optimization — Master Prompt

Run a complete Shopping/Performance Max optimization pass for our ecommerce catalog. Attached: Merchant Center diagnostics, the current product feed, Shopping/PMax product-level performance, and our margin data. Sequence: (1) Feed health — any disapprovals or warnings affecting our top-revenue products, prioritized by impact; (2) Product tiering — segment the catalog into bestseller/steady/long-tail/liability tiers using performance AND margin data together, not revenue alone; (3) Title quality — for the top 20 products by spend, compare current titles against their own search term report and flag any clear mismatch between title language and actual query language; (4) Profit ranking — recalculate profit contribution (not just ROAS) per product and flag any high-ROAS, low-margin product that looks better than it actually is, and any moderate-ROAS, high-margin product that looks worse than it actually is. Output one consolidated action list ranked by estimated dollar impact, distinguishing quick feed fixes from larger structural/taxonomy work.

5. Budget Allocation and Scaling — Master Prompt

Build this cycle's budget allocation and scaling recommendation. Attached: campaign performance with impression share lost to budget, our break-even figures, and business context notes on any capacity constraints. For every campaign, estimate marginal ROAS (the return on the next incremental dollar, not the historical average) using budget-constrained campaigns' recent conversion rate and CPC as the basis, and state your confidence level in each estimate. Rank the full portfolio combining marginal return with any stated strategic priority from our business context. For the top scaling candidate, run a readiness check: is performance stable, is there genuine remaining auction headroom beyond the budget constraint, and can the business fulfill the resulting demand per our capacity notes. Recommend a specific, phased budget reallocation plan — no single campaign's budget should change by more than 30% in one move — with a rollback trigger for each phase.

6. Monthly Executive Reporting — Master Prompt

Write this month's performance report for [audience: CMO/founder/client — specify]. Attached: monthly performance vs. prior month and prior year, this month's testing log, and our margin data. Structure: a one-sentence headline on overall direction; the 3-5 most significant changes in performance with a specific, checkable cause for each — a change we made, a seasonal pattern, a competitive shift — not a restated number; profit contribution (using real margin data), not just revenue or ROAS, as the primary financial metric; a brief, honest summary of what we tested this month, including anything that didn't work; and any specific decision that needs stakeholder input, stated as a clear, financially-quantified ask. Match length and jargon level to the stated audience — a CMO/founder version should fit on half a page with no unexplained platform-specific terms; a client version should explain any necessary jargon in plain language on first use.

7. Profitability Analysis — Master Prompt

Run a full profitability analysis, separate from a standard performance review. Attached: campaign and, if ecommerce, product-level spend and revenue, and our full margin data from 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md. Recalculate true profit contribution for every campaign and product (Profit = Revenue × Gross Margin % – Ad Spend, adjusted for any non-COGS costs we've documented). Rank by profit contribution, not ROAS or revenue. Explicitly flag: any campaign or product with strong-looking ROAS but weak or negative actual profit due to thin margin; any with modest ROAS but strong profit due to healthy margin, which a ROAS-only view would underrate; and any operating below documented break-even. State the gap between what a standard ROAS-based report would conclude and what this profit-based analysis actually shows, since that gap is the core finding this analysis exists to surface.

PART 8

Implementation Checklists

From Day 1 setup through ongoing monthly operation.

Day 1 Setup

- ■ Create a dedicated Claude Project (or persistent folder) for this account
- ■ Create and populate all ten context files (01 through 10) — even a partial first pass is better than none
- ■ Export the core Data Checklist items: campaign performance, ad group performance, keyword performance, search term report, conversion action settings
- ■ Run Skill 91 (Conversion Tracking Audit) before anything else — confirm the data can be trusted
- ■ Run Skill 1 (Full Account Audit) to establish a baseline

First Account Audit

- ■ Confirm conversion tracking is accurate (Skill 91) before drawing conclusions from any other Skill
- ■ Run Skill 1 (Full Account Audit) and Skill 89 (Budget Waste Estimation) together for the headline findings
- ■ Walk through the Money Leak Audit (Part 3) area by area, running the referenced Skill for each
- ■ Compile findings into a single P0-P3 ranked list — cap the P0 list at what can realistically be fixed this week
- ■ Log the baseline findings in 10-TESTING-LOG.md for future comparison

First Week

- ■ Fix all P0 findings from the initial audit
- ■ Upload the first negative keyword list from Skill 15/16
- ■ Fix any Merchant Center disapprovals on tier-1 products (Skill 28), if ecommerce
- ■ Set up the weekly workflow version that matches your available time (Part 4)
- ■ Schedule the first monthly review date

First Month

- ■ Complete at least one full pass through the P1 findings list
- ■ Run the full Money Leak Audit a second time and compare against the baseline — confirm findings are shrinking, not static
- ■ Run the first Monthly Performance Report (Skill 80)
- ■ Populate 09-PERFORMANCE-BENCHMARKS.md with the first month of real data
- ■ Review and prioritize the accumulated testing backlog (Skill 98)

Ongoing Weekly Workflow

- ■ Run the Monday-Friday schedule (Part 4) at the depth matching available time
- ■ Update 10-TESTING-LOG.md with any test launched or concluded this week
- ■ Send the weekly executive report (Skill 79)
- ■ Never let more than 7 days pass without a search term waste review (Skill 15)

Ongoing Monthly Workflow

- ■ Run all ten Monthly Review components (Part 5)
- ■ Update 05-CONVERSION-ECONOMICS.md if margins or costs have changed
- ■ Update 09-PERFORMANCE-BENCHMARKS.md with the new month's data
- ■ Re-run the Money Leak Audit and track the trend in Skill 89's total waste estimate quarter over quarter
- ■ Review and refresh context files (01-08) for anything that's changed since the last update

Become the brand AI trusts and recommends.

Your next customer may discover you through AI before visiting your website.

Klaym AI helps brands track, analyze, and improve how they appear across AI search and answer engines — so they can earn more mentions, citations, recommendations, and qualified traffic.

JOIN THE WAITLIST